



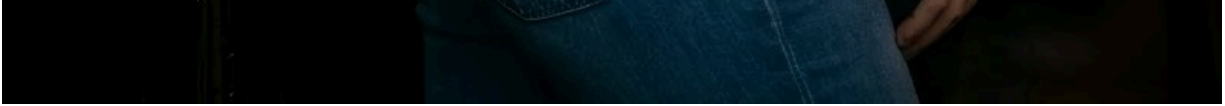
KENNY WRIGHT

WHILE
WE WERE APART
hotwife

A woman with long, wavy brown hair is the central figure. She is wearing a black sleeveless crop top and blue denim jeans. She is looking back over her right shoulder towards the camera with a slight smile. The background is a dark, out-of-focus interior, likely a bar or restaurant, with warm, golden light from candles and other lights creating a bokeh effect. The overall mood is intimate and romantic.

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WHILE WE WERE APART: HOTWIFE

KENNY WRIGHT



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PREFACE

When I started writing the story about Morgan and Nathan, I had not intended for it to be a trilogy. It was just a fun, low-pressure exercise to write a hotwife origin story, starting at the *very* beginning. I needed content for Patreon in case I was between major projects, so each vignette was written to fill in those gaps.

The thing that I'm sure many of you have realized about me over the years and over my many books is that I end up going all in on everything that I write. It happened with Morgan and Nathan, and the more I wrote, the more vested I got with the couple. The scope of this story was always large—from college to later in life—it's just that my pacing slowed way down, because I didn't want to miss the finer details of what makes this couple a couple. Believe it or not, I'd originally had the *second* vignette (that's right, the one right after Senior Year) skip to them being married for several years.

Glad I didn't do that, and hopefully you are all glad, too.

And yet here we are, the third book completing the initial arc of this couple's lives. Hopefully we all knew that we'd end up here, with a book titled, "Hotwife." I just didn't think it would be so much longer.

This one's different from the other two, though. The first two had been collections of the shorter vignettes, tied together by theme or phase in their lives. When I sat down to write this "vignette," it just got longer and longer,

until I realized that this story deserved its own full-length novel. It's one of the most important moments in their story. Why would I ever squeeze it into a 15-20k novella?

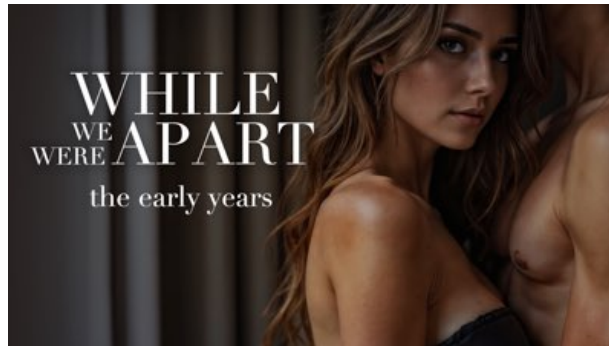
But this isn't the end for Morgan and Nathan. If anything, this is just the beginning. There are still stories to tell, both in Morgan's past and definitely in the couple's future. Like I said, when I do a thing, I do it all the way. This couple deserves the room to breathe, and I already have some very fun, very naughty ideas for what comes next.

If you'd like to join me on my adventure, visit my website (kennywriter.com) or find me on Discord. I'd started publishing *While We Were Apart* as a serial online for folks to follow week-after-week, and that's the goal for the next phase of Morgan and Nathan and the whole crew.

In the meantime, enjoy *Hotwife*!

OTHER WHILE WE WERE APART BOOKS

WHILE WE WERE APART: THE EARLY YEARS



She came back changed, but could he handle it?

When Morgan returns from her year abroad, Nathan expects to pick up where they left off. But the woman who comes back isn't the girl he remembers. She's bolder. More confident. And she has stories to tell—stories Nathan isn't sure he wants to hear.

Part *hotpast* novel, part *hotwife* origin story, *While We Were Apart: The Early Years* is a slow-burn romantic erotica series tracing three pivotal moments in Morgan and Nathan's relationship. It begins with a year of secrets and separation—and unspools into a sensual journey of jealousy, longing, and the raw ache of love strained by time, distance, and desire.

They were meant to be—just not the way they expected.

WHILE WE WERE APART: THE ENGAGEMENT



He used to be jealous of men flirting with his fiancée, then she teased a story. Now he can't stop fantasizing about their time apart.

Nathan and Morgan's relationship was always complicated, so it was inevitable their engagement would be, too. They survived years of jealousy and years apart, they survived med school, and came out stronger as a couple. But as their wedding approaches, the ghosts of Morgan's wild time abroad refuse to stay buried.

Three vignettes chart their time from engagement to matrimony—the bachelorette party in New Orleans, a holiday party in their new home town of Portland, and finally the wedding itself, where all worlds collide. Through it all, Nathan discovers that the images that once tortured him now turn him on. The stories that once broke them serve to bring them closer together. His journey from jealous boyfriend to willing hotwife husband has only just begun.

The Engagement is the second book in the While We Were Apart series, a provocative exploration of modern relationships, where sometimes you need to dive back into the past to forge a path into the future.

PART VII: HOTWIFE

Life was good. In many ways, life was no different before and after the wedding, we just had official papers now. Morgan was still in the midst of one of the most rigorous residencies in the country, on her way to becoming a surgeon. I was teaching at a high school within walking distance of our Portland duplex.

Because of her long shifts at the hospital, there were times when we saw each other briefly—I'd go to bed alone, only to wake with her at my side, sound asleep. When I came home from school, she'd be gone again.

That was no different than before the wedding, though, and unlike Baltimore, caused no drama. I was with her. I could help her manage her stress levels.

It also wasn't just work and stories about Morgan's sex life. One and a half years in, we'd finally started to get acclimated to Portland life. We stopped carrying umbrellas and followed the local habit of adopting Columbia three-in-one jackets with the light rain-resistant outer shell. We started skiing, mostly at Mt. Hood Meadows, but sometimes night-skiing at the Skibowl. Morgan, who'd been doing it since she was a little girl, was very good, me not so much. We went hiking whenever we could, exploring the parks and trails that were everywhere around us. Tracy, our neighbor,

talked us into joining a climbing gym. Morgan loved it. I tried, but turned out I really didn't like heights.

We made plans for the future. Morgan had three years left in her residency. We wanted to start a family a few years after that, which meant saving for a house in a good neighborhood with good schools. There was a lot of responsible stuff ahead of us, so now, with me at 27 and Morgan just 26, was the time to have fun.

I was finally ready for the fun. I now had a solid partner in this adventure we called life.

I was still buffeted by the old insecurities. She was surrounded by hot doctors and hot patients. At the climbing gym, Tracy and Morgan attracted as much male attention as they did on their girls nights out. And then there were those actual girls nights out, where the two would go out, drink and dance and get hit on, only to come home horny and raring to go.

These men, these incidents, no longer felt like gut punches. I was no longer crippled with jealousy. I could see them now for their potential. These were opportunities, brushes with temptation and excitement.

We were primed for the next step in our journey.

I WAS in bed when I heard her come in the front door, but certainly not asleep. I never slept when she was out with Tracy, and made sure I was fully hydrated for what was always a good time.

Tonight, they were meeting up with a couple of Tracy's friends, Serena and Annabel, who I'd never met but was assured by Trip that they were 'a lot of fun.'

By this point Morgan knew that I liked it when she went out, and she made sure to tease me with the preparation. Maybe she got the idea from Tracy, I don't know, but I liked it.

Tonight, she wore a pair of tight, frayed jeans and a white, leather halter vest. She looked as amazing as I'd imagined when she first told me that story—hair pinned up, leaving her neck and shoulders exposed. She could wear a bra with this one, but all it did was hoist her tits into the plunging V of the vest.

"This was close to what I wore that first night with Lorenzo," she said. "That one showed even more skin."

"Hard to believe," I said, staring at her as she swiveled this way and that in front of a mirror. The jeans sat low enough and the vest high on her midriff to leave a band of creamy skin bare, right up to her belly ring. "You should have gone with a miniskirt to complete the look."

"Ha. I don't think so. Those days of wearing something like that are behind me, I'm afraid."

"They don't have to be."

She kissed me. "Goodbye, Nathan." She winked. "I'll see you when I get home."

And now she was home. I heard her on the steps, her heels clacking along the hardwood floor, and the blood rushing through my body throbbing right along with those steps. I was hard when she finally opened the door.

"You're still awake."

"I'm always awake on nights like these." I put a hand behind my head. "Have fun?"

"Probably a little too much." She was giggly drunk, exaggerating the sway in her hips as she crossed to the dresser. She looked sexier now than when she left earlier, and I knew it was largely because I imagined how she looked to all the other men out there.

"I learned a few things." She unbuttoned her vest and tossed it onto the dresser she was leaning on. Beneath, she wore a killer push-up bra that made her tits look huge. "You paying attention?"

I took my eyes off of her chest and found her smiling at me. “I’m sorry, did you say something?”

“I was *going* to tell you about our neighbors. You know how we kind of suspected that Trip and Tracy had some kind of open relationship? Well, tonight confirmed it.”

“No.”

“Yes. Oh yes.”

“They’re swingers?”

“Not exactly. Well, yes, maybe that, but Tracy used another term. ‘Hotwife.’ Like, one word. It means that she’s free to...” Morgan lowered her voice, like she was sharing a secret. “...sleep with other guys.”

“I think I’ve heard about this.” I was hedging, because I definitely had read about this lifestyle. “Trip is a... cuck? That didn’t seem right.”

Trip was a man’s man. The kind of guy who’d solve a problem with a fist fight just as easily as he’d hug it out.

“She called him a ‘stag.’ Like he’s cool with it, as long as these guys don’t cause trouble.”

“That’s...” Relatable? Understandable? Envidable? “That’s wild. She just tell you?”

Morgan popped open the front of her jeans and shimmied them over her hips. Beneath, she wore a beige thong that matched her bra.

“She didn’t take the Uber home with me, but she definitely left the bar at the same time.”

Tonight, her navel piercing was a bar with two clear stones on either end, the lower larger, with a flower petal casing.

“Get over here,” I said. “I’m tired of just looking.”

Morgan giggled. “Okay, but first, I need to tell you something.”

A drip of fear rolled down my spine.

“I did... something.” She sauntered closer, her bikini model body oozing sex. “I was a little bit naughty.”

“Okay.” My mouth was dry. My heart beat ratcheted up.

“There was alcohol around. Guys were there. Tracy’s friends, Serena and Annabel, are almost as bad as she is.” Morgan crawled into the bed. “So I apologize in advance, and hope you’re not too mad...”

“What... what did you do?”

“I had a cigarette.” With that, she kissed me, and she did taste like an ashtray. I used to hate that back when she smoked all the time. Now, it mostly turned me on because it meant she was being naughty.

“I’ll forgive you,” I said, pulling her into the bed. “After you tell me more.”

I opened her bra with one hand, kissing her neck. She was wearing perfume tonight, and that scent mixed with cigarette smoke was like the smell of sex. I ran my other hand down her body, into her panties. She was soaking wet.

She gasped as I pushed a finger inside of her and brushed my thumb along her clit. Something had her worked up. Or someone.

“So start talking.”

“Right... mmm... so we went to... to this total meat market in Southeast. I’d never been there, but you know the kind of place... young people looking to hook up.”

I really didn’t know of those kinds of bars personally. It was never my scene in the brief time that I was single, but it sounded like Morgan was familiar, and that was angsty hot.

“You meet anyone there?” I pushed a second finger into her, drawing a moan.

“There were some guys from the... climbing gym. I think... pretty sure Trace told them we’d be there.”

“You knew them?”

“Mmm hmm. Good climbers. Like, they’re pushing 13s.”

“I don’t know what that means.”

“Means they’re really good, and Tracy likes them because they usually take their shirts off when projecting something.”

“Just Tracy?”

“I only have eyes for you, sweetheart—OH!”

“Liar.” I nipped at her neck. “How many were there?”

“Four.”

“How convenient.”

“So they come over, say hi. Invite us to their table. We don’t go right away. No reason to seem too easy. But when they’re out of earshot, Tracy leans in and tells us that Leo, one of the guys, has a nice, big dick. Annabel and Serena don’t react to that, but I’m like, ‘How do you know that?’”

“And that’s when they fill you in on the hotwife thing.”

“They’re all hotwives, Nathan. I guess it’s how they met? Serena and her husband haven’t had sex in three years. She gets all her action from other men.”

“Sounds horrible.”

“Tracy has been fucking Leo for the last three months. I had no idea—don’t stop. Keep doing... that.”

I’d slowed my fingering, mesmerized by this story. Apparently something about it had Morgan excited, too.

“It’s so crazy, Nathan...”

“We always kind of knew something was up with them.”

“But to actually *verify* it? To... to see it?”

“What did you see?”

“Oh, nothing crazy. But... they did look like a couple. She sat in his lap. She’d kiss him... right there. He had his hands... all... over her... oh...”

“Keep going,” I whispered, moving down her body. She rolled onto her back as I dipped beneath the sheets and tugged at her thong.

“It was like the old days,” she said between moans and whimpers. “Hanging out like that, everything so cas... casual... Oh, Nathan, that feels

so... good..."

I feasted on her pussy, enjoying the smooth skin beneath that tight little landing strip.

"Did you flirt?"

"Yes," she said in a rush.

"Was it fun?"

"Please, don't stop."

I backed off, denying her some pleasure. "Was it fun?" I repeated.

"It... was. Ahh!"

I gave her everything, licking and fingering, rubbing my lips over her clit, sucking with my whole mouth. I wanted to reward her for her answer. I wanted to prove to her that I was okay with this now.

And I was okay. I was more than okay. 'Hotwife.' That's what Tracy was. Was that what I wanted Morgan to be, too? I tried it on, a thought experiment to myself—Morgan flirting with some climber dude, laughing at his jokes, running her fingers through her hair, touching her neck.

"Who did you flirt with? What did he look like?" I said.

Her eyes were shut, her head buried in the pillow, dark hair spilling everywhere.

"He had a shaved head. And... haaa... a full sleeve of tattoos up his right arm, over his shoulder, of... of mountains, topos, climbing stuff."

I was back to eating her out, my ears burning at the description of a man so different from me.

"He had plugs in his ears. I... I asked him about it. If it hurt. How long it took. He... he let me put my finger in them—mmm..."

The image was oddly intimate, in a way that I'd never considered before. I wouldn't be able to look at a guy with plugs the same way again.

"And he's strong?" I prompted.

"Yeah. Stringy muscle. Broad shoulders. Eight pack or something. Super... strong..."

“And he hit on you?”

“Sort of just paired off that... that way... yeah...”

I moved up over her, needing to sink my dick in her. Pushing my PJ pants down just enough, I freed my cock and pushed inside her. There was almost no friction, she was so wet—or maybe this dude had already fucked her in the bathroom.

“Oh, Morgan!” I actually came before I could stop myself, that image of the two of them going at it, her leaning on the sink, him behind her, their eyes locked in some grimy mirror. It was all too much.

“Yes, Nathan! Oh! Oh!”

She fucked up into me, clinging to my neck as she raced to her own orgasm with my premature one. She squeezed the hairs at the base of my skull so hard it hurt. I gritted my teeth, fought back that pain, and kept fucking into her as my balls emptied.

In the afterglow of the hard sex, I wanted to ask her more about the hotwife thing, about the guy with the plugs, about the rest of the night. But she was sleepy drunk and well fucked. These moments never lasted long. I basically knew I’d get one question in.

And so I wasted it. Probably on purpose. “Did you get his number?”

“Of course not, honey.” She snuggled against me, her voice all sleepy. “I see him all the time at the gym.”

Despite my own tiredness, I didn’t fall asleep for a long time.

“Tell me about the first guy you slept with in London.”

Conversations about Lorenzo were saved for the bedroom. That had become the unspoken norm. But he wasn't the only thing that I was curious about during her time abroad. The tamer ones—funny to consider that talking about sex with other men were tamer—were saved for moments like this, out in nature in safe situations that didn't require a lot of eye contact. She could be open.

We were hiking at Silver Falls State Park on a typical Oregonian day: little rain, mid-50s, damp. Made everything smell wonderful. Moss on the trees.

“Not much to tell,” she said.

“Oh come on, you went from being a student there to having sex with the first new guy since dating me.”

“Okay, well, sure. But it's not really that exciting.” Despite that, she seemed more focused on the trail ahead than glancing over at me. Which I was okay with. “His name was Pierre. He was French—part of the group of Europeans that I mentioned. I remember that he liked smoking his own rolled cigarettes and thinking, ‘This guy's so *French*.’ He was cute in a scruffy, artsy kind of way. Perpetual five o'clock shadow, hair always looking like he'd just rolled out of bed, nice and tall.”

Over the years, I'd come to realize that Morgan liked tall guys. If there was one constant in her men, it was that. I wondered if she was aware of this.

"Everything at that point was so novel. Even hanging out in a pub or bar without worrying about being carded was new. So when Pierre started flirting with me one night, I looked at him and thought that he could be a new experience, too."

"Just like that?"

"Well, a couple of pints helped."

"It only took you two weeks and a French guy who forgot his razor to forget about me?" It was a joke, of course. Or so I told myself. I wasn't that jealous guy, but looking at it objectively, I don't think my question was wrong, either.

Morgan stopped along the trail and turned to me. She'd put her hood up now that the rain had picked up. I could hear it pattering against the Gortex. She surveyed me with those wide, empathetic eyes. "Oh, Nathan, I never forgot about you. Never once, during the whole year." She took my hands and stepped close. "But we agreed to take a break, and one of the reasons that I went to London was to try new things. The French guy who forgot his razor was just one of them."

Old me would have twisted that statement into something angsty. Evolved me was just curious. "So how was he?"

"He was okay. I won't lie, it was fun, and I hadn't had sex since we said goodbye, so that was nice. But it didn't blow my mind or anything."

"Unlike Lorenzo a little later," I said.

She blushed but smiled at me before turning away and starting back down the trail. "So what about you? What was your first time with someone else like?"

I stood there, watching her walk through the light rain for a moment. Her raincoat was orangy yellow, setting her out from the greenery around

her. I grinned to myself and followed.

“Even less of a story. I got drunk at a house party and hooked up with another drunk girl there.”

I saw Morgan nod out of the corner of my hood, taking it in. I wondered how she was processing it. “Anyone I knew?”

“No.” I took her hand and squeezed it. “This is going to sound horrible, but I don’t even remember her name, or much of anything anymore.”

I did remember that it was only two days after Morgan had left. I was a real asshole back then, newly ‘single’ and ready to get laid. What I did remember was that she was a petite girl with short blond hair, kissed without ever fully opening her mouth to me, and made me finally realize what I’d given up in Morgan.

“I do remember comparing her to you,” I admitted. “I compared them all to you.”

“That’s not very fair to those girls,” she said.

“You think very highly of yourself. That’s not very like you.”

“Oh, no, that’s not what I meant.” She sounded flustered. “I just mean that you should have been fully present with them. Give yourself 100% to each new experience.”

“That’s what you did?”

“Of course.” I could see her smile peek out. We walked behind a waterfall, mist kicking up around us, the roar of the water drowning everything out. Morgan stepped close enough that I could hear her. “That year taught me to live in every moment. I sometimes forget to, but I try.” She kissed me. “This is us living, right here.”

IT WASN’T her casual attitude towards sex that I thought about long after that hike. It was more about the sentiment behind it—about giving

everything to each experience. I always knew that about her—it was how she approached school, her residency, even her hobbies. I'd only ever thought about that approach to relationships through me, but she must have been the same with Pierre, with her other casual hookups. With Will. Certainly with Lorenzo.

What did giving herself 100% to a man like that mean? It was a very erotically charged question, and one that I'd jerked off to a few times with only vague answers.

I could have asked her directly what it was like. Morgan had stopped being fully cagey about that time. We talked about Lorenzo. She'd shared some fun stories, and now knew that it turned me on to hear them. But I found that I didn't want to hear them all at once. I wanted to savor each story, enjoy them, contemplate them.

Later that week, on a rare evening when both of our schedules matched up and we were in bed, naked and enjoying the afterglow of good, newlywed sex, we brought up Lorenzo again. Or at least I did, and Morgan obliged my curiosity.

"Lorenzo liked to play games with me," she said. Candles burned around us, the soft light casting a sexy sheen across Morgan's bare skin.

"What kind of games?"

"He'd kind of... dare me to do something. And I'd do it."

"Always?"

"Almost always, yeah." Morgan was gently stroking my dick, one leg draped over mine. I could feel her closely cropped landing strip brush against my skin.

"You liked following his instructions," I said.

"Yeah."

"So what's something he told you to do?"

Morgan kissed my shoulder. "Okay, a story then." She smeared my pre-come down my shaft as she casually jerked me. "Hmm..."

She either had so many stories to tell that she couldn't pick one, or she was nervous that some would be too much to share. Either way, her hesitation was my excitement.

"One of Lo's favorite things was to push me to wear things I never would. I blame Cass and that no panties thing the first time Lo and I... you know."

"Hooked up," I helped her out. It was a story that I often fantasized about: Morgan going out to a club with her friend, Cassidy, in London, without any panties on because of VPLs.

My heart rate picked up. "Go on, it's okay."

Morgan stroked me faster. "More than okay, it seems." She was still getting used to the fact that I wasn't flipping out, even after all these months of reassurance. "Anyway, there was this time when we went to see the opera in Madrid."

"Wow, fancy. So he wasn't just about clubs?"

"He mostly was, and honestly, I don't think he was very interested in the opera itself. More about dressing me up and taking me."

I was getting harder. "And how did he dress you up?"

I could tell by the way she buried her face against my shoulder as she laughed that this part of the story embarrassed her. "I still can't believe I went along with this." She took a breath, and when she looked back up at me, her cheeks were red. "He got this *crazy* dress for me. Designer. Very expensive, but very..."

"Crazy?"

"See-through. It was see-through. Well, mostly. It was a long, tight maxi-dress that was entirely made up of this see-through floral lace, so it kind of masked that I was naked underneath, but, I mean, also not really.

"You were naked underneath?"

"Yeah. He told me I wasn't allowed to wear anything. That it would 'break the lines' of the lace. He was so full of shit." She laughed. "But yeah,

I wore that—to an opera—without anything else but heels.”

“Did people notice?”

“Oh yeah. No one said anything, but they looked. My nipples are pale, but not *that* pale.”

“No panties either?”

She shook her head, then buried her face in my arm again. “I was already shaving it all by this time, but if I wasn’t, I’d have had to for that dress.”

“Wow.” I wasn’t sure what else to say. It both sounded crazy that Morgan would agree to something like that, but also so fucking hot. “How did it make you feel?”

“Embarrassed, for sure. Wondering why I was doing it, oh yeah. But also, after a while, after I got over the stares, it was like I was someone else in that dress. I just thought, ‘Fuck it. I’ll never see these people again.’ And then I played a new part. I could be the kind of person that walked around naked in high society.”

Kind of an analogy for your whole time in London, I thought. And then, because I was trying to be better about actually sharing my thoughts, I said, “Kind of an analogy for your whole time in London.”

“Being naked all the time?”

“Well, I mean the part about being able to act like someone else.”

“Yeah, I know what you mean.” She laughed. “Although also, there’s probably something there about allowing myself to be so exposed.”

“God, I wish I was at that opera. I bet you made the night for a lot of guys.”

“And I got more than a few dirty looks from their wives.”

“Jealous bitches.”

“It was so crazy. I wanted to leave all night, yet Lo made me stay. He knew what it was doing to me.”

“What was he doing to you?”

“Winding me up. Turning me on. By the time we finally left the theater, I was so aroused that I wanted to scream.”

“And I bet you did.” She felt my dick jump when I said it. She knew this wasn’t a test. We were so far beyond those now.

Morgan moved down between my legs.

“All night long.” She swallowed my cockhead, swirling it as she watched me watch her. “He fucked me with the dress on.” She sucked more of my dick, all the way down to the root before popping off. “By the end, it was shredded.”

I came. Morgan was there, clamping her lips around my dick so she could swallow my load. She made even that look beautiful and elegant—cheeks caving, large, brown eyes expressive below her long lashes, her dark hair spilling in rich waves that caught the light just so. I thought of the dress, I knew that even naked, she had carried herself like she belonged.

“I picked up some barbecue on the way home,” I said as I walked into the house. Morgan was already in her scrubs. She had the evening shift again, which meant that we had about thirty minutes before she had to leave.

“You’re the best,” she said, opening the bag and breathing it in. “Brisket?”

“And the crispy brussel sprouts. *And* mac and cheese. Figured you could use some more calories.”

She smiled as she started pulling plastic containers from the bag. I went and fetched the plates, setting them out on the island counter in front of us. This had become more routine than we’d hoped, stealing a quick meal together between jobs, but it was only temporary, and it was still one of my favorite times of the day.

I watched as she forked some of the mac and cheese into her mouth, closing her eyes. “Oh my god, that’s so good.”

I reached out and brushed a strand of chestnut brown hair from her cheek. “You always had a thing for carbs.”

We ate efficiently, trying not to hurry, trying to enjoy the moment together and still catch up on your days. “Oh, Prithya called,” she said.

Prithya was Morgan's best friend from high school, and had been a bridesmaid in our wedding. She was a fun, outgoing and friendly girl, super smart, but the thing that I most associated with her was the fact that I'd caught her with Lorenzo at the tail end of our wedding reception. The image of her naked and on her knees, blowing that large black man, was forever burned into my brain.

I'd told Morgan after, and she'd been shocked, but obviously they had a lot more history together.

Morgan was going on, and I had to force myself to pay attention again. "...is playing at the Royal Albert Hall next month." Judging by her excited tone, this must have been a big deal.

"Wow, impressive. I didn't know she played. I thought she worked at a brokerage on Fleet Street or something."

Morgan laughed. "Really? I know I've mentioned it, like, a bunch of times. She's been playing strings since before we were friends."

"But never this seriously."

"Not since 'University.'" Whenever Morgan said "university" when referring to British people going to college, she said it in an erudite English accent. "She's been playing second violin in the North London Symphonic Orchestra, and now they're going to play at the Royal Albert."

The excitement for her friend was back, and it was infectious.

"You should go," I said. "You *need* to go."

She looked at her watch, realizing the time, she hopped up. "I really do need to go!"

"Also to London?" I suggested as she gathered her bag.

"I'll think about it." And she was out the door.

While I'd suggested it, I also did my fair share of thinking about it while she was on her shift. Everything had started to be considered through the lens of this hotwife thing, now that the term was on the table. This trip

would be an innocent one, most likely. Morgan would go and visit her friend, watch her play, have a drink in celebration and come home.

But then again, this was the same friend who'd waited for a man *naked* in a grotto just a few minutes away from the entire reception party because she was told to. What if the two of them shared that story? What if Morgan then shared that our neighbor was a hotwife? Maybe Prithya would tell her that she should be one, too, that maybe I'd be okay with it, that maybe this would be a great opportunity to do it.

And that didn't even account for the fact that Prithya lived in *London*, the place where all of this began. The place where Morgan decided to experiment, to try new things, to be someone else. It was returning to the scene of the crime, and I was now ready for her to do that.

When Morgan came home from her night shift, waking me up around 6 am, she roused me from a dream that must have involved sex, but I couldn't recall any of the details. When I made a move on her, I was happy when she reciprocated. In that hazy moment between waking and dreams, I sometimes imagined that she was horny because some hot doctor had pulled her into an empty hospital room and started to make out with her before she came to her senses.

I kept those thoughts to myself, but it wasn't just morning wood that kept me stiff.

Her breathing slowed against my chest. She'd be asleep in minutes. Her shift had been a long one, and not just in terms of hours. I held her there, tracing slow circles on her arm, but my mind didn't quiet down.

The house was still, the first gray light of morning sliding through the blinds, and all I could think about was London. About her and Prithya laughing over drinks, about the way curiosity might follow her there the same way it had started to follow me here.

"I really do think you should go."

"Go?" she asked, yawning.

“To London. For Prithya’s thing.”

“I think so, too.” So she had been thinking about it. I felt relief, right alongside the old anxiety that accompanied all things from her past. It was wonderful.

I traced her arm, listening to her breathing as it slowed. “And when you go, you know you have the same freedom that you did in New Orleans.” I’d been practicing this speech as I fell asleep—or maybe in my dreams?—but still my body trembled as I stumbled over my words.

Morgan half turned, like she was going to face me, but decided against it. “Is that so?” She didn’t sound very tired anymore. “You’re so thoughtful.”

“Thanks. I try.”

She giggled. “I know you think it’s sexy and all, but you know I’m not really ‘into’ girls, right? Like, to call myself bisexual would be disrespectful to the LGBTQ community.”

“Explain that to me.” My carefully prepared conversation to lead into some kind of hotwife confession went out the window as I dug in. “So you didn’t have fun when you were with other women?”

“I did.”

“It turned you on when you went down on Cassidy and made her scream an orgasm.”

“Well, yesss...” I knew it turned her on. I could feel how she squirmed and wiggled at the memory.

“And when they are kissing you? Touching you? Pressing their soft skin against you?” I kissed her neck between questions. “You liked that.”

“Mmm, yes.”

“Sounds like you’re into girls,” I concluded.

Morgan groaned, this time more out of frustration than pleasure. “There was almost always another guy there.”

“Almost?”

She said, “You’re thinking about this the wrong way. You like to think of sexuality on a spectrum—straight to gay—and we all fall somewhere on that range. But that’s an oversimplification. It fails to consider the totality of the situation.”

Now she was talking with her medical brain, logical and diagnostic. “Okay, so what am I missing then?”

“Hedonism, pleasure? Fun for fun’s sake? That scrambles the scenario. I’ve never hooked up with a girl because I wanted to date her. But same goes with guys.”

“Like with Pierre.”

“Yeah, they were all experiences. Like traveling to a new place, or skydiving, or...”

“Having public sex in a sex club?” I helped out.

I could almost hear her blush. “Yeah, like that. It’s all just different from what you and I have.”

“So if Prithya asked you out?”

“Are you and I together in this hypothetical?”

“Let’s say no.”

“I’d probably tell her politely that I wasn’t into girls.”

“And if Lorenzo told you to hook up with her?” I said. Even saying his name aloud like that was still thrilling.

“I’d hook up with her.” She rubbed her ass against my dick and grinned at me. “And I’d enjoy it.”

“I want you to enjoy your time in London.”

“And I will. But that doesn’t mean I need to hook up with my best friend.”

“What if it wasn’t limited to her?” I heard the passive voice in my question, but it was the best I could do. This was already scary enough to admit.

“I told you, not really into girls.”

“What if it wasn’t limited to just girls? What if you went to London like you did the last time—open to new experiences. Only this time, you share them with me. So they become *our* experiences.”

I almost had her. “Is this about what Trip and Tracy are doing?” she asked.

“Maybe a little, but forget about them. This is about you and me. It’s like putting that see-through dress back on, only this time, you need to bring back photos of it.”

Morgan laughed. “You’re a goof, Nathan.”

“But a lovable one?”

“Always.” She yawned again, settling back into her pillow, ready to settle back down.

I attempted one last time. “And I’m also serious, Morgan. I know every experience is different, but it would be fun to share one.”

“I’ll keep that in mind.”

And at last, she fell asleep, and I got out of bed to start my day.

“I heard Morgan’s going to London,” Trip said. He flicked his fishing rod, casting his spinner into the lake with a satisfying zip. “To visit that hot Indian chick from the wedding?”

“Prithya, yeah. She’s playing violin in an orchestra there. Big deal.”

“And you’re not going?” He was nonchalant, eyes out on the water, looking for fish, slowly reeling in his line. Still, I could hear more.

I’d never fished until moving out here, but it had become a semi-regular thing between my neighbor Trip and I. Morgan had a long weekend shift following our conversation about Prithya, I didn’t have much to do, so the next thing I knew, we were floating in Trip’s little row boat in some fishing hole in Washington State.

I turned to him, considering his question. “You don’t think that’s a good idea?”

Trip chuckled. “That depends on what your goal is.”

“For... Morgan to support her high school friend?” Even as I said it, I thought about my suggestion to her about new experiences. Then I wondered if she’d talked to Tracy about those suggestions. Then heat flooded through me in embarrassment.

“What do you know?” I mumbled.

“I know that you like hearing about Morgan’s past. That true?”

Trip didn't look over at me, or put me on the spot. Instead, he reeled in his line. No bites. He squinted at the lure he had on the end of the line, a bright green spinner, adjusting it, then with a flick, cast it back out.

Swish. Splash. Click, click, reel.

This wasn't a subject that I talked about with *anyone* other than Morgan, and that in itself was a recent development. I didn't even confide in this turn on with my best friend, Dan, who'd been with me from the beginning of this wild journey. But there was something disarming about Trip. That, plus the calm of the water, the gentle bob of the boat, the clicking of our reels, loosened my tongue.

"Yeah, it's true." I tried casting my own line off the other end of the boat, but it didn't travel nearly as far. "I kind of blame you."

"Blame me? Brother, how about thanking me." He chuckled. "But also, what do I have to do with this?"

"I'm just kidding. But I do think you and Tracy are kind of..."

"What? Rubbing off on you?" He chuckled. "Because I'd be into that."

"Tracy told Morg that she's a... a hotwife." This was a lot more awkward than I'd anticipated, but I kept my eyes on the water. It was out there now.

Trip didn't seem to care. He just laughed good naturedly and said, "So that's out there then. Yeah, she goes out and fucks other guys, then comes home and I get to fuck the hell out of her, too. It's called reclamation sex, and it fucking rules."

Just like that. So casual, like we were talking about the proper way to build muscle at the gym. I shook my head. "I don't get it."

"My friend, you do. You're like me in that way, you just like hearing about her past while secretly hoping that some of that past comes into the present."

Swish. Splash. Click, click, reel.

"I don't..." I couldn't even fully deny it.

Trip heard the hesitation and turned to me. “Oh, please. Tell me it’s not hot as hell hearing about how her black, Spanish boyfriend fucked her in the ass while on the deck of his yacht in the Mediterranean.”

I nearly dropped my fishing rod. “What?”

And yet my dick leapt to attention. This time, when I whipped the rod, the cast soared through the air.

“Oh, she hasn’t told you that one yet? Sorry.”

Spanish boyfriend... fucked in the ass... yacht... It took a long time to recover from that revelation. I did know that there were more stories. I figured that I’d hear them all eventually, and knew that it wasn’t so much about Morgan keeping things from me. I *liked* that there was more to discover.

“I... I didn’t know she’d ever had anal sex.”

“Well, um, you didn’t hear it from me. But whatever. How did it make you feel, hearing that?”

“Other than shocked?” I slowly reeled in my line. “Excited.”

“And that’s what I love about the hotwife thing. It’s always fucking exciting. And yes, I get jealous, but like I said before, the jealousy is part of it. Wouldn’t be so exciting if I didn’t feel that way.”

We sat in the boat, quietly casting our lines and reeling them in. It was one of those rare days in the Pacific Northwest where it actually got sunny and stayed that way for a while, and it was actually hot in that boat.

Trip broke the silence, of course. “Tracy told me about how you told her to ‘enjoy’ London, the way she did before.”

“Of course she did.”

“Oh, don’t be like that,” Trip said. “Morgan needs someone to talk to about this shit. She’s got a lot going on, a lot of stress with the residency. You should be happy she’s got Trace as an outlet.”

“I know. And I am. I’m just being a...”

“Jealous husband.”

I winced. “Ouch. Okay, you’re right. So yes, I said those things, but Morgan didn’t really seem to acknowledge it.”

“She did, in her way. She went and talked to Tracy after, freaking out about how this is some kind of test again.”

“Shit. Hadn’t thought of that,” I said. “It’s not a test, by the way.”

“I know. And so does Tracy. I think she convinced your wife that you were for real. But I have to ask, why aren’t you going along?”

I looked out across the water, the sunlight flashing off the little ripples where my line cut through. I decided to go with honesty. If Morgan could open up to Tracy about this, then I could do the same with Trip. “Because if she goes alone, and is back in London where everything... happened... then maybe something *will* happen.”

Trip’s rod twitched in the water. He gave it a quick flick, but nothing bit. “Look, if this were me and Trace,” he said, “I’d tell her to go and have a blast. Come back with stories. But for you two—especially if this is the first time anything may happen—I really think you need to be there together.”

I raised an eyebrow. “Together? You mean, like...?”

He grinned, but there was no teasing in it. “Yeah, man. Together. Same page. Same energy. If not the same *room*, then nearby. I know you two have got this whole ‘while we were apart’ vibe going, but let me tell you, when it happens, you’ll want to be right there.”

“I still don’t—hey!” Something started to tug on my line. “I think I’ve got a bite.”

We’d been out there for close to two hours already and neither of us had so much as a nibble. Trip was the fish guy. I was the total amateur.

“No fucking way,” he said, shifting his large body over to my side enough that the boat rocked uncomfortably.

I ignored him, reeling in what turned out to be a huge trout, much to Trip’s grumbling dismay. “Beginner’s luck.” He patted my shoulder. “Maybe your wife’ll get her own kind of beginner’s luck, eh?”

I chuckled, tickled that I'd actually caught a fish. That felt great. Turning, I said, "Nothing's going to happen."

"Probably not, but maybe something will. And trust me, my man. If she *does* do something, it's not the doing that'll mess with you—it's feeling like you weren't part of it."

I sighed. He made a lot of sense, yet a part of me was resistant to the idea. Like, if I was there, nothing would happen. Liked the only way this *could* happen was if she was alone and tempted.

"Hey, I've got an idea," Trip said as he cut my trout off the line and dumped it into a small cooler. "I'll get Trace to take Morgan out tonight. Impromptu girls night. And we can go watch."

"Watch?"

"Watch them flirt. Come on, brother, there's nothing quite like a dose of reality."

He was already sending a text off to Tracy with his plan. Not that I did much to stop it. I liked the idea. I liked it a lot.

Trip's thumbs moved fast over his phone, the smirk never leaving his face. "Done," he said. "Tracy's in. She said she'll drag Morgan out for a drink after her shift. Just make sure we stay out late enough for her to get home alone."

"Sounds like a thing the old me would have done," I said.

"Nah. Old you would have done this just to go in there and get all angsty. This is the new you."

"The new me does what?"

"Go in there, get all angsty, and then fuck the hell out of your hot and *loyal* wife."

We didn't end up getting back into Portland until close to 9, having gotten snarled in some terrible traffic. We also stopped to grab a bite at a diner along the way—all in order to eat up the hours.

Morgan texted as we made the long journey back, informing me that she and Tracy were going out for dinner. And then later, after dinner, she texted to inform me that they were getting drinks.

[Nathan]: Have fun! If you know what I mean.

[Morgan]: I have no clue what you're talking about, my husband.

Trip and I were home long enough to drop the fish off in the fridge and change out of our clothing. Then we were back out in the night, taking an Uber out to the bar where the girls last reported.

I'd never been to Desi's, but I'd heard of it. The bar gave off an upbeat Latin vibe and had a salsa night, although that wasn't tonight. It was already packed and buzzing by the time we arrived, the line at the door check slowing us down.

My heart raced at the possibility of what I'd find inside. My scalp prickled with heat. We hadn't told them that we were coming, and because of that, anything was possible.

I thought about our past and how I sometimes thought that I'd be forever stuck there as Trip and I stood in line. I remembered driving up to

Baltimore early in the morning, wondering if I'd walk in on Morgan with her doctor-mentor Mikael. I remembered walking through the vineyard, towards Morgan's familiar moans. I remembered the hallway at Jeremy's house and his closed door.

Each moment burst behind my eyes, moments of anxiety now stepping stones to this moment. Before, I'd worried about what I'd find. Now, it seemed I wanted that which I had so often dreaded.

"Relax, man," Trip said, a hand on my back once we'd finally arrived at the front of the line and made it into the bar. "Enjoy."

It was packed inside. Packed and loud. I didn't do bars all that much these days, and this was a reminder why. How did anyone talk in here? It was all too much.

Despite the crowd, though, I picked out Morgan and Tracy almost right away. They were on the far end of the bar, the soft amber light catching in their hair and off the skin of their bare shoulders. Morgan wore a simple white tank top and a beaded necklace. Tracy's beige blouse was sexier, draping suggestively off her body with boho sex appeal.

They weren't alone, either. Of course they weren't. Two guys flanked them, dividing their attention, both looking like they'd walked off of a GQ photoshoot. One of them, the taller of the two—easily six-three, broad shouldered, one too many buttons on his shirt undone—had positioned himself close to Morgan. He carried himself with easy confidence, holding both a beer and Morgan's gaze as they talked over the music.

I knew that they wouldn't just be out there drinking by themselves. A part of me thought they'd be out with the other women, though, a little circle of laughing femininity. But this was actually what I was *hoping* to find, and my heart raced as Trip guided me to a table where we could observe.

Morgan leaned toward the guy as he said something, getting close to hear over the noise, her hand resting on his arm. Her touch was brief, but I

caught the way the guy glanced at her hand, registering it, processing it, being encouraged by it. My stomach tumbled end-over-end.

“Here,” Trip said, “drink this.” Somehow, he’d produced a couple of pints of beer. I took it and glanced, my eyes still laser focused on Morgan—the way she tilted her head to listen, the way her lips curved when she smiled. She was... flirting. She was in the moment, right then, her guard down and so comfortable in her own skin.

The tall man leaned in, said something that drew Morgan’s eyes to his, her lips parting in surprise. Whatever the question was, it hit me low in the chest—an ache, a rush, a need.

Trip grinned. “See? Reality.”

”This is... intense,” I said, not sure my voice carried over the crowd.

I swallowed hard, trying to be introspective in the moment without missing a moment of the flirtation. I wasn’t jealous. Or... I *was* jealous, but not in the way that I used to get. The room felt smaller, hotter, so much more crowded and yet the only people I really saw were Morgan and the smirky tall guy.

The guy leaned in again, saying something that made Morgan laugh. I couldn’t hear it with my ears, but my imagination filled it in. It was a real laugh, a full laugh. A laugh that I loved hearing, that always encouraged anyone who heard it to want to hear more. The guy seemed affected the same way, leaning close, saying more.

She raised her left hand between them, her ring catching the light.

I couldn’t hear the words, but I knew that gesture: a polite line drawn. *I’m married.*

That she even had to explain that rocked me. He must have propositioned her. He must have asked her out. He must have... and had she... was she... tempted?

I was rock hard and happy that I was sitting down. I was also surprised to find my beer empty. I turned to Trip, who was already ordering a second.

He looked at me and gave a grin that said, *Having fun yet?*

The man with Morgan didn't seem deterred. He didn't leave her alone. He didn't give up. Why should he? She wasn't running away, instead still staring at him with her big, brown and dancing eyes. He smiled at her, nodded, and said something in return that made her laugh again.

That's when she glanced past him, scanning the room, seeing... me.

For a heartbeat, neither of us moved. Her lips parted just slightly, a knowing curve forming there. She saw me. She knew exactly what I'd seen. I braced for anger, for her jaw to tighten, for her to march over and demand why we were there.

Instead, she just turned back to the tall man, her body language shifting just enough—closer, lighter, her hand brushing the edge of his sleeve as she spoke. The playful spark in her eyes had turned into something else now, like she'd decided, *You came for a show? I'll give you a show.*

Trip seemed to notice, too. "This is a good sign," he said. "This is a *really* good sign."

I couldn't look away. My pulse quickened. Now that it was all in the open, this was less me-looking-into-the-gazebo, and closer to what a healthy... hotwife?... couple would share. But more than that, watching Morgan flirt openly with this guy was like seeing a glimpse of the Morgan from before with all the confidence and freedom that came with those times.

And I was handling it. I was managing it. I was *enjoying* it.

My wife's glance once again found me from across the crowded bar. Only for an instant, a secret shared in plain sight, like she knew exactly what I was thinking. It felt amazing.

I could handle this. We could do this. We could enjoy this *together*. It was electric.

While Morgan was dancing and flirting with subtlety, Tracy was all about it. She held court beside my wife, a drink in one hand and a thousand-

watt smile lighting up the room—or more specifically, her guy. He was shorter than Morgan’s man, clean-cut, his sleeves rolled up enough to show off thick forearms and large hands. The blonde leaned toward him, one palm resting on the bar, showing off the deep cleavage down the front of her blouse.

She glanced over at us, and I realized that she’d known the plan all along. She didn’t seem surprised for a moment. She gave us a quick, knowing wink and turned back to her companion, saying something that made both of them laugh bodily.

A moment later, she clinked her glass against Morgan’s, leaned in close, and whispered something in her ear. Whatever she said worked. Both women laughed, and the two men suddenly waved for the bartender.

Four shot glasses appeared on the bar, clear liquid catching the light.

Trip chuckled. “There it is. Trace is running the show.”

I watched as the men handed out the shots. They all raised them in a mock toast. I watched, feeling simultaneously outside of it and intimately included. It was like an out-of-body experience, particularly when Morgan looked my way just before tipping her glass up and swallowed the shot.

Why was that gesture so fucking hot?

Morgan didn’t cough. She didn’t react like the liquid was fire in her throat. She was a woman who knew how to do shots, and that too was such a turn on.

Beside me, Trip echoed my thought with a cruder: “I just love watching Trace swallow things.”

We settled in and watched them hit it off with the guys. Morgan seemed even more at ease to flirt now that she knew that I was there. I was pretty sure that it was mostly a show for me, but I couldn’t be certain. She was definitely in her element—talking easily, laughing, brushing her hair behind her ear as she leaned toward the tall stranger. None of it looked forced. It looked *real*.

“You think they have a chance?” I asked. I tried to be casual about it, but my heart was all up in my throat. It was a wild thing that I was witnessing. I wanted to both rush in there and stop it all, while at the same time I was rooting for the other man.

“Maybe,” Trip said. “With Tracy, they always have a chance. That’s what makes it exciting, eh?”

I nodded. Not so with Morgan. At least not with this version. Maybe the other one, the London one, before the long shifts and the harsh dose of adulthood, she would have chased this moment without hesitation.

I thought about her comments about hedonism, now thinking about it outside of the context of her heteronormative theory. If she had been without me, would she go for this guy? Now that she was with me and knew that I had a hotwife fantasy, did this man suddenly have a chance?

Every laugh, every small gesture between her and the man beside her drew him further in. I wasn’t sure if it was jealousy or desire—or both—but I couldn’t look away.

Trip leaned back in his chair like he was settling in for a show. Which was exactly what this was, although I always just assumed that it would last a few minutes, we’d have a laugh, and be reunited.

I tried to match his calm, but my pulse just wouldn’t calm down. So I tried conversation instead.

“Do you always just... watch?” My face went hot at the question, but I held my voice steady.

“Sometimes I don’t watch at all. Most of the time I don’t,” he said. “Trace usually likes playing alone.”

“And you’re okay with that?”

“I am, yeah. She makes sure I’m included in other ways.”

I swallowed, glancing over at Morgan and Tracy. They were laughing as a group now, yet each woman was standing even closer to their man. I

watched Morgan's hand briefly touch her guy's arm again as she leaned in to say something. My stomach squirmed.

"And that's enough? You don't ever... get to play?"

"We've done that, too. Tracy's brought home a hot friend or two to play."

I remembered something he'd said at our wedding once, about "two blondes."

"Another woman?"

Trip chuckled. "Yeah. And yes, they went down on each other, if that's your next question."

It wasn't something that I was going to ask, but I was grateful that he'd supplied the answer.

"But honestly, and you might get this or not, but I get more out of just the idea of her getting drilled by some new dick than getting some of my own new pussy."

I had to laugh at how direct Trip could be.

"What?" he asked.

"Just... you sometimes remind me of my buddy, Dan, only with even less of a filter."

"The priest?" Trip asked.

That made me laugh even more. Dan had officiated our wedding, which was the only time Trip had met him, but he was about as far from a priest as a man could be. "He's definitely not a man of the cloth, no."

My phone buzzed on the table. Flipping it over, I saw the text from Morgan.

[Morgan]: Enjoying the show?

I looked over at the women again. Morgan was sneaking glances my way from across the bar, that sly, knowing smile tugging at the corners of her lips.

[Nathan]: I love you so much!

She read his response, her smile growing wider before she tucked her phone away and turned back to her companion.

I kept on watching, the noise of the pub fading into the background, caught between fascination and anticipation.

Morgan leaned closer to the tall man, her hand grazing his chest as she said something that made him laugh. I couldn't hear him, but I could imagine the low, rumbling sound and it made me squirm, and I could read her body language. It told a story right out of my fantasies, from the tilt of her chin, the bat of her lashes, the way she twirled a lock of her hair around her finger before brushing it over her shoulder.

"She's got that guy well and truly hooked," Trip said.

I nodded faintly, unable to look away. The tall man leaned in, whispering something against Morgan's ear. She smiled, and for a second, I thought she might pull back. Instead, she rested her hand on his forearm and murmured something back, close enough that her lips nearly brushed his skin.

My pulse thudded in my throat. I knew this was innocent—innocent enough, anyway—and all for my benefit, but it still hit me with the same thrill that I got whenever I thought about Morgan's past. Only this wasn't the past anymore. This was now. And I was right there.

As if sensing me watching and what I was thinking, Morgan glanced my way across the room. That same mischievous smile was there, the subtle flare of her eyes.

Trip's phone buzzed. I was vaguely aware of it, but when he started to laugh, I looked over at him.

"She texted me, too," he said, holding up his phone. "Tracy says, '*Don't wait up.*'"

"So this is how it goes? Tracy meets a random guy in a bar and just... goes home with him? Isn't that kind of risky?"

Trip chuckled. “That’s always the fantasy, but you’re right. You can never be too careful these days. No, she knows those guys. Or, at least, she knows the guy who’s hitting on her. That’s Jamie. Don’t know his friend, though, but he looks like he’s about to know your wife a lot more.”

I was so turned on, but so scared, too. I glanced over at them, and they were definitely close. Tracy was pressed up against Jamie, and he had his arms around her as he laughed.

“Way back in the day, she hooked up with strangers, but it’s just so much more convenient to arrange these things online. There are all these fucking sites, man. Ashley Madison, AdultFriendFinder, Debauch. There’s a whole industry, and it’s kind of fun browsing. Like hunting for sex toys, if those sex toys were attached to real people.”

I just stared at him like he was talking another language. I got what he was saying, and I knew those things existed. I’d certainly heard of Ashley Madison after that big leak, but even still, it was just a whole world that I had no idea existed.

I thought about Morgan visiting the sex club in London, and wondered if Trip had ever done that with Tracy. But that wasn’t at the very top of his mind.

“You ever worry about losing her? Or of one of these guys stealing her away?”

I expected Trip to laugh, or maybe flex, or toss out something cocky like, *She’s too addicted to me for that to happen.*

Instead, he just stared at his beer for a silent moment, his thoughts somewhere else. I wasn’t even sure that he’d heard my question until his eyes flickered with something. He picked up his pint and finally said, “Losing her... it’s kind of a funny phrase, right? Implies possession, and one thing I’ve learned over the years, that’s not how relationships work.”

He didn’t look at me as he spoke, his thumb tracing the rim of his glass.

I kept quiet, waiting for a story from him, because there *was* a story here. Things weren't so easy, it seemed. Their journey into the lifestyle was more complex than I'd assumed.

Trip smirked faintly, that mask of confidence slipping back into place. "Anyway," he said, swirling the beer in his glass, "Tracy is definitely not a woman who likes to be 'owned,' and holding on too tight just makes her want to wriggle free."

He glanced towards the bar. I kept watching him, wondering what the story was, but the moment passed. "Besides," he said, the swagger returning to his voice, "she's too addicted to me for her to leave me."

There it was. I almost laughed as he said the exact thing I was expecting. Instead, I pondered how it felt to finally get a glimpse beyond the macho hotwife husband stag caricature that I'd formed of him.

I looked over towards Morgan, only to realize that she was gone. The stool was empty. The tall guy, Tracy, Jamie, they were all... gone. So was the air in my lungs. My vision narrowed in that one panicked moment.

Trip was saying something, but I barely heard it over the pounding in my ears. "Relax," he said. "They're probably just—"

But I was already standing, scanning the room, the back hallway, the door. "Yeah," I mumbled. "Probably."

Probably. Probably. Adrenaline coursed through my blood. I took a step, the room lurching around me. How much had I had to drink? How long had we been at this bar?

Outside, the night hit me like a slap. It was so cold. But of course it was cold. It was February in the Pacific Northwest and I'd come out here with only a fleece. Streetlights glared off the wet pavement. My heart raced. I was back at the end of Jeremy's hallway. I was walking down the path at Suncrest Valley.

She wouldn't. She wouldn't just...

But this time, a part of me was excited that she *would*. I was still hard. I was still buoyed by my fantasy.

Then I saw her.

Morgan stood under the awning, arms folded, the faintest smirk curling her lips. Alone. Her hair caught the glow of the streetlight. She'd slipped her own puffy coat over her tank top, and she was wearing tight jeans that hugged her shapely calves.

"Took you long enough," she said softly.

I stopped a few feet away, caught between relief and something that felt, oddly, like disappointment. "You... I thought you left."

"I mean, I did." She seemed to float over to me, her large brown eyes wide and dancing. This night was far from over, but the next chapter would be all about the two of us. "If only to see how you'd react."

"A test, then. Thought we weren't doing that anymore."

"Says the guy who came to the bar to spy on me."

"Touché."

The sounds of the bar spilled out into the night, music, laughter, the clink of glasses and people going about their day.

"Where's Tracy?"

Morgan shrugged. "She left with Jamie."

"And your guy?"

"Wes?" she asked. Hearing her say the other man's name sent a jolt through my gut. "He wanted me to go with them. When I declined, he went home."

I swallowed. "Were you tempted?"

She was right up against me, close enough that her perfume drifted between us, close enough that I could see the flush in her cheeks. "I was."

I gasped. She ran her hand down between us, smiling as she found me hard. "And you? Enjoy the show?"

My throat tightened. "You have no idea."

She squeezed my cock. “I have *some* idea.” She kissed me softly, turning and slipping her hand into mine. “Take me home?”

“Let’s get out of here.”

I don't remember much about that Uber ride home other than that it felt like it took *forever*. We sat close, Morgan's hand on my thigh, tracing slow, lazy circles through the denim. I remained hard the whole time, shooting glances at the driver in the front. Not that he was paying us much mind. He was in the middle of a murmured conversation with someone on his phone in a language that I couldn't place.

When the car pulled up outside of our house, Morgan slipped out and stretched. It was just cool enough that her laughter made a plume of smoke around her, her hair tumbling around her shoulders.

"Our home," she announced. The lights were all off on Trip and Tracy's side. I wondered what they were up to. I didn't even remember saying goodbye to Trip.

Morgan caught hold of my hand, lacing her fingers in mine, and drew me along to the front door. "Come on, I *need* you."

I laughed as I went, happy to be pulled inside. We were all over each other as soon as the door clicked shut. She shucked out of her coat, tossing it to the floor as my arms went around her, my hands encircling her narrow waist before sliding higher.

"So you're not mad?" I asked between kisses. "That we showed up like that?"

“Tracy let me in on Trip’s plan.”

“Okay, good. It was definitely Trip’s plan. I wasn’t testing—”

She silenced me with a kiss. “I know, honey. But if it was, how would you grade me?”

I ran my hands down over her ass. “A fucking Plus.”

“Teacher’s biased.”

“I may have my favorite students, but I’m trained not to let it affect how I grade.” I nuzzled my forehead along hers. “And you definitely got an A+ for tonight.”

“I liked performing,” she said through her smile.

I thought of the story with the dress, of Lorenzo, of her past. “Oh, I know.”

She giggled and pulled away, taking me by the hand and leading us towards the bedroom upstairs. We didn’t bother with lights. It felt more intimate that way, like we were sneaking around in each other’s imaginations.

I wondered if she was thinking about Wes pulling her top off as I was doing it. When she released her bra, I saw her through another man’s eyes, and she saw the look.

“God, the way you’re staring...” she said.

“—is the way any man would stare.”

“Wes would,” she added, and again the other man’s name off of her lips was nuclear. She crawled back on the bed, her eyes glittering in the dark, watching as I pulled my shirt off and tossed it aside. Was she seeing another man? God, I hoped so.

She unbuttoned her jeans, wiggling out of them as I dropped my own. She was left in her thong, me in my tight, black boxer-briefs. Both of us panting in anticipation of what came next.

I moved in between her thighs, running my lips along her smooth, taut skin. I wanted to eat her out as she talked dirty. Morgan had other plans,

guiding me up her body. “I need you, Nate,” she said. “I need to feel you inside me. Now.”

Even before I could nod, she was dragging my boxer-briefs down, her hand encircling my dick. “I need *this*,” she said insistently.

We didn’t bother removing her thong. She just pushed it to the side as I slotted into her. She was so wet, so smooth, so ready for a cock. Any cock?

“Fuck, baby,” I groaned.

“Yes, fuck me.”

“Think of him,” I gasped.

She didn’t say anything, but I felt her pussy clamp around my dick as I started to drive into her. Her fingers gripped my shoulder blades—nails cut short for climbing, otherwise they’d break skin. She wrapped one leg around my waist, then the other, digging her heels into my lower back.

“Uh! Uh! Uh!” Morgan didn’t need foreplay. The whole night had been foreplay. She was ready to go, and I was ready to give it to her.

“Watching you flirt with that guy was... fuck... mmm...”

“I liked... that you... were there... but right now, just... fuck me!”

No more talk. She pressed her heels into me, urging me on, and I *fucked*. I thrust until my abs hurt, until my arms burned from holding myself over her, until my imagination was so full of images of Morgan and Wes sneaking off...

What if she’d left with him, rather than wait for me?

What if she’d gone with Tracy, wherever the hell that was, and they had ended up pairing off with the men?

“Come, Nathan,” Morgan cried, her voice strangled. I loved when she ordered me to do this, but a small voice in me whispered that I wished that she’d used another man’s name.

So my imagination changed it. In that blip, I saw Wes riding her, and my world turned to fire.

“Nnngh! Fuuuck!” Morgan cried out, her orgasm hitting her as I pumped my come deep. Somehow, her shorn fingernails found purchase in my shoulders. I gasped at the pain, but kept fucking and fucking, willing her to imagine that she was with someone else, or if she’d *been* with someone else and was home for her reclamation.

I collapsed onto the bed beside her when it was done. My pulse must have been riding 200. I could feel the blood throbbing in my ears, along with the echoes of her gasps and cries.

Morgan half turned to me, snuggling close, and kissed my shoulder. “That was an unexpected turn to the weekend,” she said.

“Thanks to our neighbors.”

“They *are* fun and full of surprises.”

“I should have texted to let you know that I was coming.”

Morgan shook her head. Her chestnut brown hair was plastered to her forehead from all the sex. She was a goddess. “No, it’s okay. It was fun. And you’ll never catch me doing anything *really* inappropriate.”

“Like have anal sex on a yacht with your London boyfriend?”

Every part of that statement was triggering, which was why I said it at all. It was as much of a test for me as it was for Morgan. I felt the short intake of breath against my shoulder, and the way she flinched. “Did Trip tell you about that?”

“So that did happen?” I looked down at her, eyes meeting.

“Yeah. I was saving that story for you. I should have assumed that those two talk.”

“They seem to share everything, don’t they?” I realized how I was coming off and stopped myself. “I sound petulant—”

“You have every right to.”

“But I’m not. It’s more like... I’d like to be Trip and Tracy one day, that’s all. Did you not want to tell me because you were... I don’t know, embarrassed or ashamed?”

“I...” She hesitated. “No. I don’t regret it.”

Woosh. For a moment, I felt like I was in freefall. Our eyes met again, and she smiled shyly. All at once, I was hard. “I really did want to save the story. It’s a good one. But a few weeks ago, when I was out with the others, we just got into talking about... sex in exotic locations, and that kind of came out.”

“You were caught up in the moment.”

“Tracy and the girls have that effect.”

“I like it.” I pulled her hand to my dick. “I like it a lot.”

She giggled, closing her hand around my cock.

“Now that the cat’s out of the bag, let’s hear the story,” I said. “So Lorenzo owned a yacht?”

“His parents do. It’s pretty modest. I don’t know how many feet it is, but we’d take it out, just the two of us.”

“So that wasn’t your first time out on it?”

“Oh, no,” she said. “He liked being out on the water. We went out most times we visited Valencia, if the weather was nice. I think he liked seeing me in bikinis.”

“Let me guess, he bought them for you. And they were all thong bikinis.”

“You seem to really get Lorenzo now,” she said. “Yes. I never thought I’d wear something like that, but there was a time when I actually had a thong tan line.”

“Damn, that’s so hot,” I murmured. “But you didn’t when you came back.”

“No, during that summer...”

“You sunned naked.”

“As soon as we left the docks. Sometimes even before we got out of sight of the shore.” She was stroking me slowly as she entered her memory. “You have to understand that weekends with Lorenzo were like... I don’t

know... like I was stepping into someone else's life. Like I was living someone else's dream. Things just kind of happened."

"Tell me more of what happened." My voice was barely a whisper.

Morgan slipped out of her thong and straddled me, sinking down onto my cock as much as she sank into her memory. "We were planning on sleeping on the boat. He'd brought food. We ate it on the deck, watching the sun set. Me in this tiny white thong bikini, Lo wearing trunks.

"We anchored somewhere quiet, away from the other boats. I remember seeing the city lights on the horizon, and thinking about all the dark water between us. It was already early summer, and hot even at night."

I closed my eyes as Morgan rode me, a third person spectator in her memory—a voyeur even in our shared imagination.

"He took his time that night. It started with a massage right out on the deck, under the stars, the boat rocking gently. I remember he used so much oil, I should have known he was up to something. It dripped down the slope of my spine, pooling just at the base. His hands followed... then his mouth..."

She reached between her thighs, her fingers finding her clit as she retold the story. Her eyes were shut. My ears burned.

"He teased me between my legs, but didn't give me release. He wanted me on the edge. By the time he pressed one slick finger against my ass, I was ready for it. I remember him chuckling. Telling me to relax as he... as he climbed into place behind me."

"This wasn't the first time you two did this," I said with a realization.

She opened her eyes now. "No."

I jerked inside of her, and probably would have come if I hadn't already.

"But he's so big I... I never could get used to it. I was like a virgin every time."

"Did it hurt?"

“Yeah, it hurt. But he went slowly, letting me get used to him before he started to fuck, slow and deliberate, matching the rhythm of the sea.” She bit her lower lip, eyes closing again, getting lost in the memory. She rode me, fingers playing with herself, brow furrowing. I didn’t probe, even though I wanted to know more. I wanted to be there on the boat.

“I came so hard. I remember not being able to breathe. Then thinking, ‘Who is that screaming?’ Then realizing that it was me.” She gasped, eyes still closed, the smile forming on her mouth then disappearing, replaced by her oncoming O-face.

“He came in... inside of your...?”

“In my ass, yes.” Morgan delivered the confession through clenched teeth. “And I lost it.”

“Oh, Morgan...” I gripped her hips, helping her mouth on my dick. Her pussy clenched around me as she came. “I’m... I’m...”

She practically rubbed herself raw as she came, eyes still squeezed shut, her mind definitely still cast back on the time when another man fucked his come into her ass.

That thought did me in. That idea, that possibility, exploded through my body. I came hard, which drove Morgan’s climax even higher. “Uh! Uhhh!” Her brow was twisted, her face tight and clenched as she ground her hips into mine and took my second orgasm.

She shuddered one last time, thighs trembling around my sides as she collapsed into me, ragged breath on my neck.

“How’s that for a story?”

“Pretty intense.” My softening member throbbed one last time inside of her. We shared a laugh. “That really happened?”

“It really did.” She squinted at me. “And you’re okay with it.”

“More than okay.” As the past faded away, memories of earlier tonight returned. That wasn’t a story that she was retelling. That was our own story. “I like the idea of you letting go.”

“I know you do.”

“Like tonight. At the bar. That was pretty awesome.”

“God, the look on your face when I saw you in the bar...” She slipped off of me, and I sighed as my cock popped free. “It was like you were hungry. But also jealous. And possessive. And... happy.”

“Yes. All of that.”

We laughed. She said, “I liked that you were there tonight.”

“I thought you’d say that.”

“No,” she said, lifting her head so she could see me better. “I mean, really there. Not just in the same room, but with me.” She drew a slow breath. “I could feel you watching. And it made me feel safe. Like I could let go.”

Safe. Let go. Like she was with Lorenzo, but also different. Before I could gather my thoughts, she said, “I want you to come to London with me.”

I blinked. That wasn’t where I thought this was going, but I also really *liked* where this was suddenly going. “Oh? And what’s going to happen there?”

Morgan didn’t beat around the bush. She had an idea, and it was time to share it. “If we’re going to play with this, or explore whatever this is, I need you there. Tonight was... tonight was fucking amazing. And so much of that was because you were there.”

“I’ll need to check my schedule. It may be hard to get off on such short notice.” Even as I said it, though, I knew that I was going to make it happen. Even if that meant quitting my job, I thought with a smile.

“What’s that smile, mister?” she asked.

“Oh, just thinking about the fish that I caught.”

“Are you calling me a fish?!”

We laughed. “Sexiest trout in the fishing hole.”

“Dirty.”

“I’ll make it work,” I said. “I have some personal days banked from last year, and haven’t taken any off this year. If we factor in the weekend, I could probably swing a week off.”

Morgan practically shook with excitement. I hadn’t seen her like this in ages, but here was that giddy girl buried under all the stress of her residency. “Oh, this is going to be so fun. I can’t wait to show you around. It’ll be great to break out of this routine, you know? No hospital shifts, no lesson plans...”

“Maybe a few pints in some noisy pub where no one knows us,” I added.

“Mm-hmm.” She raised an eyebrow. “This sounds suspiciously like a setup.”

“Not a setup,” I said, grinning. “Just a fun opportunity to see what you were like back when you were ‘single.’”

“Quote-unquote,” she said.

“And maybe we can make a new story or two,” I said suggestively.

Morgan didn’t joke it away. She just smiled slyly. “Anything’s possible.”

My cock flexed.

“Seriously though, you’ve told me enough stories to know that version of you knew how to have fun. I’d kind of like to meet her.”

“You know her. She is me.”

“You know what I mean.”

“I do. I’m more into the idea of making some new stories. Of our own.”

She shifted closer, resting her head on my chest again. The quiet that followed wasn’t empty—it was full. Full of what had just happened, full of what might come next, full of this life that we had forged together.

And lying there in the dark as sleep finally started to take us, I realized that Trip had been right.

If this was going to happen—if anything was going to happen—it had to happen with both of us in it.

We took the Red Eye from Portland to London, transferring through Atlanta. It was about as brutal as that sounds.

By the time we boarded the overseas leg, Morgan had already curled up under one of those thin airline blankets, her head resting on my shoulder, earbuds in. I tried to watch a movie, but mostly I just watched her.

Every so often, she'd stir, mumble something, then drift off again. I couldn't help but smile. She looked peaceful, even in that cramped seat. The residency stress, the long shifts—it all melted away somewhere over the Atlantic.

When she finally woke up, hair a little wild, she blinked at me and smiled. “You didn't sleep?”

“I got a little,” I said. Maybe it was true. “I'm just excited, you know?”

”Mmm hmm.” She rubbed her eyes and glanced around. The flight attendants were just coming around with breakfast, which felt odd since it seemed like it was the middle of the night. “Today's going to be rough,” she said, a smile blooming across her face. “But this is going to be so much fun!”

Adrenaline fueled the last hour of the flight into Heathrow, through baggage claim, through customs. When we finally emerged into the main terminal, it was already one in the afternoon.

The plan had been to take the Tube into Central London, where Prithya had a flat in the trendy neighborhood of Clerkenwell. I was already feeling overwhelmed by what kind of transportation card to buy when someone called out, “Morgan! Nathan! Over here.”

A female voice, the up-and-down lilt of an Indo-British accent familiar. Looking up, we spotted Prithya standing there, waiting for us, a jacket draped over one arm and an excited expression on her face.

“Pri!” Morgan squealed, leaving her roller bag with me as she rushed over and threw her arms around her friend.

That reunion was worth the trip. There was nothing quite like the rush of seeing Morgan so unequivocally happy. The revisionist in me even wanted to claim that was why I was okay with her going abroad: so she could be happy. The reality, of course, was because I was a self-centered jerk at the time looking to score, but at least I knew that now.

“Nathan, I’m so happy you could make it too,” Prithya said, holding her arms out to me for a hug.

She was smaller than Morgan, her glossy black hair smelling faintly of jasmine and something warm as she hugged me. Despite the casual elegance with which she wore her sweater and jeans, I couldn’t *not* think about this same woman naked and on her knees before Lorenzo. Especially when I felt her full breasts press against me in that hug.

“Welcome to London,” she greeted. “You’re going to love Clerkenwell. Come on—I’ve got the car just outside.” Her accent made even the most ordinary things sound musical.

She grabbed Morgan’s roller bag and started to direct us towards the exits. I followed as the two friends caught up, a third wheel without actually feeling like one.

“You didn’t have to come meet us all the way out here,” Morgan said.

“Oh, please, Morg. You’re the one who flew halfway around the world just to see me play a few songs.”

“Don’t downplay it. This is amazing!”

“It is pretty cool,” Prithya admitted with a laugh. “I still can’t believe it. We used to talk about the Royal Albert when we were kids.”

“And now here you are!”

Prithya’s car was a little Kia SUV. I sat in the back and nodded off as we pulled out of the airport, the girls up front catching up. I heard snippets of the conversation—Morgan talking about how her residency was going, Prithya about her life here in London—but I was too jet lagged to follow any of it.

Next thing I knew, we were parking the car along a street that looked like it was out of a postcard showing “generic London street.” It was narrow, cobblestones, lined with Georgian townhouses with brick facades of deep red.

On the other side of the road, a small cafe sat, a few locals drinking tea and doing work on their laptops sitting at the tables along the sidewalk. Down at the corner was a pub, unmistakable with its chipped green paint and gold lettering spelling out, “The Queen’s Arms.” There were more patrons at the tables outside of that place than the cafe, all drinking from pints and talking loudly.

“This is so *cute*,” Morgan said as she stepped out and stretched.

“Thanks, we like it,” Prithya said.

My brain was still so fogged up from the long flight that I didn’t even register the “we” until Prithya’s boyfriend emerged from one of the townhomes with a smile.

“You must be Tariq,” Morgan said. “We’ve heard so much about you.”

She was being polite. I had heard exactly zero about this man. I didn’t even know that Prithya had a man.

And he was quite a man, too, about our age—late 20s—and handsome with a clipped goatee and short dark hair. He looked North African, possibly Egyptian based on the name, but his accent was English.

“And you’re the famous Dr. Morgan.” Tariq kept his eyes trained on Morgan’s face, but it still sent a thrill through me in the same way I got when men checked her out. “Prithya speaks very highly of you.”

“Stop embarrassing me, honey. Come on, help us with their bags. They must be so tired.”

Prithya’s flat was on the second floor of one of the Georgian row homes. It was surprisingly spacious, with a deck off the back and the open-concept interior completely updated and modern.

“It’s perfect,” Morgan said as we entered. “This is so you, Pri.”

“It’s small,” Prithya admitted, “but the light’s good. And it’s walking distance to everything that matters.”

She wasn’t wrong. Even through my jet-lag haze, I got the sense that we were in the heart of London, mere steps away from anything fun. It was also not the touristy side of London that I always thought about: Big Ben, double-decker buses, palaces and gardens. This was the real London, where people actually lived and worked.

“So what’s on the agenda?” Morgan asked once we’d deposited our luggage in the guest bedroom at the front of the flat. “If I sit down, I’m going to crash.”

I was already crashing, but fought it off as best as I could.

“Well, it’s already getting dark, but since it’s unseasonably warm, I thought we could show you around the neighborhood. Walking tour.”

“Sounds just about perfect,” Morgan said, although it didn’t sound perfect to me. Perfect involved flopping down into that bed that I’d just seen and shutting my eyes for the next 48 hours.

”Perfect,” I said instead.

I swear Tariq caught the dynamic between us, smiling to himself as I psyched myself up enough to head out. When we went out, I tried my best not to feel like a balloon tethered to the group—a balloon that was rapidly losing helium.

“I’ve heard that she’s a lot to keep up with sometimes,” Tariq said as we hit the street.

“I don’t know where she gets the energy sometimes,” I responded, looking ahead at the two women, linked arm-in-arm and chatting away.

“Always nice to date an energetic girl.” He had such a quiet demeanor that I couldn’t tell if that was meant to be suggestive or not.

“Has its perks.”

As tired as I was, though, being in the heart of London felt energizing. We lived in a suburb in Portland. Even staying at Morgan’s Baltimore apartment that one year, it didn’t feel anything like this.

People were everywhere. The sounds, the smells, the buzz of the city flowed through me. Not just that, but everywhere I looked was distinctly English. The cars were different. The storefronts felt British, somehow. There were red double-deckers—albeit pretty modernized—and pubs on seemingly *every* corner.

“You know Morg went to school at UCL?” Prithya’s comment to Tariq filtered back to me, and suddenly my ears perked up.

“Smart girl,” he said, looking across at my wife. “Or maybe well connected?”

“Smart,” Prithya corrected. “Like, crazy smart. Valedictorian at our high school. Just beat *me* out.”

“Oh, stop,” Morgan said. “That’s only because there wasn’t an AP class on music theory.”

“UCL’s just a neighborhood away,” Tariq said, interrupting their banter. “We should wander over there. Take a trip down memory lane?”

Morgan actually glanced back at me. We’d done a lot of talking about her past, but she was still sensitive to what the time in her life meant to me. But I nodded encouragingly. I didn’t love that she still needed to treat me with kid gloves when it came to that time.

"Sounds fun. It'll be nice to actually see some of these places that I've only ever heard of."

We walked north from Clerkenwell, the air cooling as the last of the daylight faded between rows of brick terraces. Morgan and Prithya continued to walk a few steps ahead, laughing about some old story, while I hung back with Tariq, half-listening, mostly trying to stay awake.

"So how long have you and Prithya been dating?"

Tariq scratched his cheek, where the scruff of a beard had started to grow. "About a year, although that's kind of complicated."

Even in my jet lagged state, I could do the math. Prithya had been at our wedding and fucking Lorenzo just six months ago. She hadn't mentioned anything about Tariq at the time.

"Complicated?"

"Just... we've been on-and-off. More off than on until... well, until she came back from your wedding. Guess it was inspirational."

"Well, I'm glad we could, um, inspire." There was a minefield here and I wasn't about to step into it. "How did you two meet?"

"Through my band. She's good friends with the bass player—through the orchestra—and came out to some shows. We hit it off, and it's been great since. Never thought that I'd be dating a finance chick, but people surprise. You know?"

"People surprise, for sure," I repeated. "A band, huh? That's pretty cool."

"We play at pubs and bars. Nothing major. But it pays most of the bills." He looked around. "Can't say I could afford living anywhere close to this were it not for the successful girl."

I understood that, too. "I'm a teacher married to a doctor. Trust me, I get it."

He gave me a fist bump. "To partners who provide. I don't mind being a house husband. Eventually."

Prithya and Morgan looked back at us. “What are you two laughing about back there?”

“We are talking about sports,” Tariq said with a straight face.

Morgan looked at me and smirked. “Now I know that’s not true. Nathan’s not much of a sports guy.”

We continued into Bloomsbury, where the University College London’s campus was situated. It was a prestigious school in the heart of the city, and when Morgan learned that she’d not only gotten into their study abroad program, but got a scholarship with it, she was so thrilled. I’d understood it on paper at the time, but being here in the midst of it all, I finally understood what a big deal this was.

Layered on top of that, of course, was the fact that this was the birthplace of what would eventually become our shared hotwife journey. We were quite literally walking through the geography of her past life. She lived a whole life here... without me.

And yet we were back now, together. I watched her brush her fingers along familiar railings, or pause to look at a cafe.

“It’s all the same, but like, so different,” she said. “We used to hang out here all the time, but it was a kebab shop back then. Now it’s fancy.”

I heard the ‘we,’ and while that probably meant her friends, or Cassidy, or just the collective we of the student body, what I heard was “Lorenzo and I.”

“Is it weird?” I asked as we crossed Gower Street, arm-in-arm

“So weird. Nostalgic, but also... it’s fun that you’re here.”

I looked back at Prithya and Tariq and lowered my voice. “Where did Lorenzo live?”

I felt her stiffen against me. She pointed down one of the streets ahead of us. “His flat was off there,” she said.

As we approached the quaint little avenue with its very fancy brick row homes, I felt like I was walking to the edge of the abyss. I almost didn’t

want to look, like I'd see Morgan being pulled into the home by her fit ex. Which was silly on all kinds of levels.

"That where you lived during the last couple months? Before flying home?"

Morgan hesitated, looking at me. Worry was etched in her brow. "Some of the time," she said. "We traveled."

"Man with means, makes sense."

"You upset? Talk to me." She read the wrong tone in my words.

"Sorry, no. Not upset." I smiled at her reassuringly. "I actually really like that I get to share this with you now."

She squeezed my hand. "Me too."

We walked by the street when something occurred to me. "Does he still live there?"

"Hm? No, he lives in Spain now. Or did when I talked with him at our wedding."

"Too bad. We could have popped in for a cuppa."

Morgan covered her mouth as she laughed. "I'm sure that's what you were actually thinking."

I put my arm around her and pulled her close. "You know me so well."

"Look at how cute they are," Prithya said from behind us. "Some newlywed energy." To Tariq: "We're going to have to make sure to clean the sheets when they leave."

We had dinner at a pub that had been one of Morgan's hang-outs. She talked about Cassidy and Bianca, about the bartenders that they'd met, and some of the older regulars.

By the time we made it back to the flat in Clerkenwell—via black cab—it was getting close to ten and I was practically dead on my feet.

"You look like you're about to face-plant, my friend," Tariq said, an arm around me.

The single pint hadn't helped at all. "I think I've been up for over thirty hours now," I said.

Morgan guided me to the guest room again. "Let's get you to bed."

I nodded, my head feeling heavy. "Thanks for letting us stay here," I said to Prithya. "And nice to meet you, Tariq."

"Thank you for coming, Nathan." Prithya hugged me tightly. "Now get to bed."

Morgan and I headed into the guest bedroom. Our luggage was still packed up where we'd left it earlier—how was that only a few hours ago? She fished out our pajamas, shedding her clothes with the nonchalance of two people who'd been together forever. Her underwear was practical for the flight, white cotton and far from sexy, yet I found myself staring.

"You okay?" she asked. "You seem quiet."

"Just *crazy* jetlagged," I said, taking my eyes off her as I reached for a long-sleeved t-shirt. "It's pretty cool to see the place where you went... back then."

She unfastened her bra, flashing me her tits for a moment before she pulled her pajama top on—more tank top than anything. Her nipples, erect in the chill air, poked through the thin material.

I changed into my PJ bottoms before going to her and kissing her. "I have imagined your world while you were over here so much. Like, an unhealthy amount."

"I know."

"And it's gone from getting me so... so knotted up in jealousy that I could barely function—"

"We did break up."

"Exactly. To now, which is totally... different. Like, I look everywhere, and I see you there... the younger you, smiling, laughing..." I lowered my voice. "Being charmed by a certain attractive Sudanese Spaniard."

Morgan blushed. "It was definitely not all that."

“But it was sometimes,” I said. “And if I wasn’t about to pass out, I’d throw you onto this bed and do unspeakable things to you.”

Morgan giggled. “I love you, you silly man.” She kissed me sweetly. “Now get some rest. I think I’m going to stay up a little longer. Catch up with Pri.”

“How are you not passing out, too?”

“It’s only, like, 2 in the afternoon back on the West Coast, and unlike you, dear husband, I actually slept on the plane.”

With one last kiss, I crawled into bed. Morgan grabbed a hoodie, pulling it on over her bare shoulders, and paired her flannel pajama bottoms with a pair of socks to keep her warm. She glanced back at me one last time before easing the door shut.

I crashed after that. As soon as my head hit the pillow, it was like the world tilted around me. I don’t think I realized just how exhausted I was until I pulled the sheets up around my body.

Still, for a few lingering moments, I heard them outside, just beyond the door. Voices in the living room. Morgan’s laughter. Prithya’s excited voice telling a story that I couldn’t comprehend. Tariq chiming in, his calm voice low and comfortable.

Was this what life had been like, back then? Students hanging out in the dorm lounge after hours, drunk on pints and excitement and life, connecting with one another? I should have been in there, forced myself to stay awake for just a few more minutes, but that ship had sailed.

I heard Tariq say something, voice low and conspiratorial and completely incomprehensible to me. It made Morgan laugh, and Prithya say something that sounded defensive. The trio got quieter, like they remembered that I was asleep in the next room.

Something curled in my stomach as sleep finally took me, but I was too tired to even begin to analyze it. I fell asleep to their mingling voices,

pulling me in, pulling me under, lulling me to sleep in this strange new world.

I had no idea where I was when I first woke up. I had no idea what time it was. But I did feel amazing. The sun streamed in through tall and strange windows, filtering through long, gauzy curtains.

Morgan was curled at my side, her long, chestnut brown hair swept over her peaceful face. I didn't want to disturb her, so I carefully crept out of bed. She stirred, but didn't wake.

The living room was empty when I made my way out to the bathroom, but I heard voices filtering in from the kitchen. hushed but not conspiratorial. There was the clatter of a mug being set softly down, and Tariq saying, "They're in good hands, babe."

I slowed, pausing at the door to the bathroom. Prithya's voice came clearer to my ears, now that I was listening. "I'm sure that's what you're hoping for. She's not Ophelia, love."

Ophelia. The name sounded familiar, but everything was still in a fog. "She kind of looks like Lia," Tariq said. "And I swear I'm getting vibes—"

"Oh stop. She's my bestie. Just leave her alone. Be a good host."

"You know just how accommodating I can be with your friends." I heard the suggestion in his low voice. I heard the sound of kissing that followed, too. What I didn't hear immediately was Prithya's chiding. "But seriously, I'll be on my best behavior."

“Good.” The scrape of keys was followed by, “Thank you for being the sexiest tour guide they’ll ever have. I’ll link up with you guys after my rehearsal this afternoon. Thanks again for showing them around.”

“Just two more days until the big concert,” he said. “Home stretch.”

“Home stretch,” Prithya repeated.

I ducked back into the bedroom as I heard Prithya’s footsteps round the corner. My heart was racing as I tried to decide whether any of what I heard meant anything. Clearly Tariq had the hots for Morgan and Prithya wasn’t bothered by it, plus the suggestion that maybe she was more than okay with it. But maybe I was just hearing what I wanted to hear. Not everyone we met was going to be a swinger.

I glanced back at the bed. Morgan was still lying there, completely dead to the world. Outside, I heard Tariq moving in the kitchen, but didn’t want to emerge just yet and make him wonder if I’d overheard something. So I stood there awkwardly at the door, wishing that my phone wasn’t on the opposite side of the bed so that I actually had something to kill the time.

At last, when I didn’t hear him and felt like enough time had passed, I quietly opened the door again. He wasn’t in the living room, so I padded over to the bathroom at last and relieved myself.

“Good morning.” Tariq was coming out of the master bedroom that he shared with Prithya. He was already dressed and ready for the day, wearing a pair of jeans, a charcoal gray shirt, and a jacket. “Sleep okay?”

“Like the dead.”

“Coffee?”

“Please.”

We moved into the kitchen, where he poured me a mug from the French press. We talked about the plans for the day. It was a touristy day in London: The Tower, St. Paul’s, the British Museum.

Morgan eventually got up and joined us, her hair back in a ponytail and looking like she wished she was still sleeping. “I’m normally used to weird

schedules, but this jet lag thing is kicking my ass,” she said as I handed her a cup of coffee. She sipped greedily. “Oh, thank you for this.”

“I’m going to have to split off around the museum,” Tariq said, “But Pri should be able to join you around then.” He collected some of the empty dishes from breakfast and said over his shoulder, “I don’t like supporting institutions that profited by pillaging my homeland.”

Right. He was Egyptian. I didn’t

know what to say to that, so I looked at Morgan, who was just as speechless.

Then Tariq smiled and shook his head. “I’m just fucking with you two. I took my Mum and Da when they visited last year. They loved it. No, I’ve got a gig tonight.”

We visibly relaxed. Morgan said, “Very cool.”

”It’s local. Not like Prithya’s thing.”

“Like at a pub?”

He nodded. “In Camden Town.”

”We should go,” Morgan said to me. “Can we go?”

I laughed at her enthusiasm, wondering if they did this back in the day. “Well, we *are* here on a musical adventure. Of course. Let’s do it.”

WE DID the day of tourism. Tariq was a great host, helping us navigate the Tube, the buses, the winding streets. We walked a *lot*, which we were used to back home, anyway, but after yesterday’s epic day on the plane, I was all for it.

“How’s it feel being back?” Tariq asked Morgan. We were on the second story of a double decker, headed for the British Museum. He was sitting in the seats in front of us, turned around so he could look back at us.

“Very different.” She glanced out the windows and into the crowded streets of London’s commercial district. “But also, so much the same.”

Tariq didn’t immediately probe for more. He seemed like a listener, knowing when to give someone space to think through their answer.

“It’s like... the buildings are all still here. But that was once a Top Shop, and now it’s an H&M. Some of the pubs have new names. But also, the smells and the sounds are the same. It brings back *all* the memories and all the feels and, just... all of it.” She seemed to realize that she was talking to Tariq, not me, and smiled bashfully. “Probably more than you were expecting.”

”No, no. It makes sense. It’s how I feel when I go home. It’s not my home anymore, this is. But still, it’s also... home.”

Morgan nodded.

Tariq left us at the British Museum, where we got lost in the very crowded rooms. The Egyptian wing was as packed as I’d ever seen a museum, with barely room to read the plaques and display descriptions. We got to see the Rosetta Stone, though, which was really cool.

Prithya met us in the atrium, which was so huge it was hard to believe we were still indoors.

“Fun day?” She was dressed casually in an oversized gray sweater and a pair of leggings, and gave us hugs when she saw us.

“Very. Your boyfriend’s a great guide.”

”Oh, he loves the touristy stuff. Only time we really get to do it is when friends visit.”

“He said he’s playing a show tonight,” Morgan said. “We’re all going, right?”

Prithya smiled. “Well, I didn’t want to force you, but I was planning on it.”

”I think Morgan wants to relive a little of her past,” I said.

Both women shot me a look, then glanced at each other. I wondered how much Prithya knew about Morgan's time here. They hadn't overlapped. Prithya had moved to London a few years after Morgan's time abroad, but they were still close friends. Prithya had also met Morgan's London friends at the wedding, so there were probably stories there.

"Do you have something to wear?" Prithya asked Morgan.

"I brought a dress for your concert."

"That's not going to work. No..." She looked Morgan up and down, sizing her up. "You're taller than me, but we may be able to share some clothes. Or..."

"Or?"

"We could go shopping."

Morgan looked over at me, checking in. Morgan wasn't a big shopper, but I could tell that she wanted to go now—if only to hang out with her friend some more. "Go and have fun. I'll stay here. We're doing a unit on Ancient Greece, and I wanted to check out the Parthenon sculptures."

"Want to go see how you compare to Adonis?" Morgan put her arms around me. "Because there's no comparison."

I laughed at the corniness of her joke. "Did you really just make that joke?"

"And proud of it." She kissed me. "But are you sure you don't mind me leaving?"

"I'm a history teacher. This is like heaven here. I'll meet you back at the flat."

Prithya handed me an extra set of keys. "You're a keeper, Nathan. And I'm a hugger." She hugged me again, followed by a kiss from Morgan, and they were off, arm-in-arm.

IT WAS ACTUALLY nice to be alone for a few hours, lost in history. This place really was one of the destinations that I'd been looking forward to exploring. I could have spent days here, but I'd take the afternoon that we could afford.

I wandered through the grand halls without purpose, just taking in the aeons of history here. Not to be too metaphoric about it all, but it reflected my current state-of-mind. I was here to absorb the world around me, to experience some of what Morgan may have experienced.

To experience something brand new.

Her most recent girls' night out was never far from my mind—watching her flirt, watching her leave with someone else, thinking she'd be crossing some lines that night. We were far from home now, far from our friends, our jobs, the expectations of who we were supposed to be.

We did have Tariq and Prithya here, but I was starting to put together that this couple was pretty open-minded. When Morgan had first told me about this trip, I'd hoped that something *would* happen when it was going to be just Morgan traveling. Why should it be any different, now that I was there?

We were ready.

Or as ready as anyone could be to cross this crazy line.

But I wasn't going to force it. If it was going to happen, it would happen. If it wasn't, then it wasn't.

I was the first back at the Clerkenwell flat, even though I decided to walk. We'd been through here yesterday, and while most of that time was hazy from sleep deprivation, I was pretty good with directions. Plus, the wandering felt good, even in the crisp London evening.

Not too much later I heard Morgan and Prithya coming up the stairs, their laughter making me smile. It was good to hear Morgan so relaxed. She was better now than she had been in med school, but her residency was still tough.

“Nathan, you beat us,” Morgan said as they entered. Each had several bags in hand, and based on Morgan’s flush, they’d stopped at a pub or two along the way. I confirmed it when I went up and kissed her hello.

“Museum closed. I thought about hiding out in the bathroom, but then I’d miss Tariq’s show.”

“Goof.” She tapped my nose playfully. “Well, you definitely won’t want to miss what Pri talked me into wearing tonight.” She turned to her friend. “Although I’m still on the fence.”

“Go put it on. Show him.” Prithya shooed Morgan towards the bedroom. She winked at me. “He’s going to love it.”

“Oh, I *know* that,” Morgan said, allowing herself to be herded away.

“We don’t have much time anyway. We should get there in...” Prithya looked at her watch. “Thirty minutes.”

“Sounds like plenty of time,” I said.

Both women fixed me with incredulous expressions. I held up my hands. “Says the guy who just needs to change his shirt and look fine.”

“You two look amazing to me.” It was true. They didn’t need to glam up at all.

But when they did...

“That’s...” My stomach did flips as Morgan emerged from the bedroom. Gone was the girl-next-door doctor. “Wow.”

Morgan’s face, glowing from her makeup, seemed to redden under my inspection. “I look like a streetwalker.”

“No, no.” My denial was echoed by Prithya, who was also emerging from her own bedroom. “Just... I love it.”

Morgan’s black skirt was very tight and very short, barely a belt around her slender hips. It left her flat stomach bare, navel piercing glinting. Up top, she wore a black halter top with a zipper down the front that was so fucking tempting.

But it was her boots that made the outfit—black thigh-high boots with stiletto heels. I'd never even imagined her wearing something like that, and while they did give her a vaguely *Pretty Woman* vibe, the boots didn't scream "hooker". They screamed "bad ass bitch."

And tonight, I was all for it.

The band was already into its first set when we arrived at the Black Hart. We could hear the bass and the drums from outside, and I knew this was going to be a wild night. I looked at Morgan, who glanced back at me with an excited smile.

“This like how it was? Back then?”

“Kind of, yeah.” She seemed to vibrate in time with the music, her excitement infectious. “Same energy.”

When Prithya opened the door, the wall of sound hit us full force. “Oh, this is my favorite song!” she shouted over the music. She grabbed Morgan’s hand and pulled her to the front of the stage. Over her shoulder, she shouted, “Get us drinks!”

“Drinks, right.” I watched them thread through the crowd, guys looking annoyed at first before realizing how hot the two were.

Prithya wore a white crop top that left her midriff bare and glowed in the lights of the club, paired with dark jeans that were painted on. They easily made it to the front of the small stage, arms up as they danced.

The Black Hart wasn’t a large venue. During the day, I imagined it was a restaurant, but most of the tables had been cleared away to make room for the packed ground. The music itself was rock, Tariq standing at the center,

guitar slung low, head tilted ever-so-slightly as he sang right up against the mic.

It was cool seeing this side of him. My impression from the day was a quiet and darkly romantic soul. He'd been polite, soft-spoken, a great host. Here, on stage, he'd shed that poetic exterior for his inner rockstar. He owned the stage, confident and charismatic as he stepped back, lifted the guitar, and cranked through a solo.

It was a reminder that we all had different sides, different aspects. It reminded me of my conversation with Morgan after the girls night out, after the thing with that guy Wes.

"...just a fun opportunity to see what you were like back when you were 'single' ... And maybe we can make a new story or two."

"Anything's possible."

"Seriously though, you've told me enough stories to know that version of you knew how to have fun. I'd kind of like to meet her."

"You know her. She is me."

I watched Morgan now, dancing to the rock music, to the drums, to the wall of sound in the middle of all those swaying bodies. *She is me... make a new story or two... anything is possible...*

There were four other people in the band. The other guitarist was a big guy with an even bigger beard. A black woman worked the keyboard. The drummer wore a tank top that left his lean arms bare and glistening as he set the rhythm.

And then there was the bassist, who must have been Ophelia, and she *did* look a little like Morgan. She had the same chestnut brown hair with natural highlights, although she had bangs—reminiscent of Morgan's from Suncrest Valley. Her body type was the same, too—lean and slender, although with smaller breasts. Her face was rounder than Morgan's, a doll face with pouty lips and a button nose—adorned with a glittering stud.

I went to the bar when I realized that I had no idea what they wanted. This didn't seem like a white wine kind of establishment, so I ordered pints of three different lagers and hoped one of them was good. No way was I going to get up to the front of that crowd balancing these three drinks, though, so I hung back and enjoyed the band from the bar.

If I was honest, this was my comfort zone—in the back, watching, a voyeur. The crisp lager was icing on top. I found myself smiling. The band was really good. Tariq had an amazing voice, but when Ophelia stepped up to the mic and took over at some point, she blew the crowd away.

Morgan and Prithya were right up there at the edge of the short stage, faces lit by the pulsing blue lights, laughing and moving. After another song, I was surprised when Tariq called Prithya up on stage.

“You all know Pri, right?” he asked the crowd as she picked up an electric violin that I hadn't noticed. “She's performing at the Royal fucking Albert in two days. That's class.” The crowd cheered.

“Excuse me,” Ophelia said into her own mic. “I'll also be performing?”

There was a playfulness between the two that I didn't miss. This banter wasn't new, nor was the sexual tension. I thought about what I'd overheard. ‘*She's not Ophelia,*’ and missed the rest of their exchange.

Next thing I knew, Tariq was kissing Prithya passionately on stage to the accompaniment of hoots from the entire bar. He then turned, nodded to the band, and they started rocking out again, this time with Prithya on the fiddle. Morgan looked back at me, finding me at the bar, her eyes wide with surprise. I just nodded and held up her beer.

She came back to me then, collecting it from me. I'd already finished mine and was drinking the one I'd ordered for Prithya.

“This is a surprise,” Morgan said. “Aren't they amazing?”

“For sure. The bassist is cute.”

Morgan snorted. “I'm more into the drummer. Those arms...”

I laughed, although I wasn't sure if she was kidding or not. She was probably as serious as I was about Ophelia. My heart tightened before I could even voice my next question: "So is he the one?"

Morgan glanced at me, her eyes dark and searching. The corners of her mouth were turned up.

"What? You did dress up like a hot groupie. Let's not waste the effort."

Morgan laughed, setting a hand on my chest. I wondered if she could feel how fast my heart was beating. "Why don't we play it by ear."

"A music metaphor. Nice."

She curtsied, laughed again, and hugged me. "This is fun. Thank you for coming back here with me." She looked from the empty pint to the one in my hand. "Wait, where's Prithya's?"

I gave her a faux grimace and handed her the one I was drinking. She laughed and waved it off, ordering a gin and tonic from the bar. "She's not much of a beer gal anyway."

The bartender fixed Morgan's order much quicker than he'd poured my three pints. Of course. "I'm required back up at the front."

"I'll stay here and enjoy the show."

"Ha."

Prithya stayed on stage for just the one song, but the band was nearing the end of their set anyway. They played a couple more songs before Tariq announced that they were taking a break. "We'll be back in thirty minutes or so. Band's getting thirsty back here."

The house music came on over the speakers, far quieter than the live music was, and all of a sudden I could hear conversations around me again.

"They're surprisingly good."

"That violin. Wish that chick would play every song with them."

"You just want to keep looking at her."

"I mean, that too?"

I smiled to myself, moving to meet Morgan and Prithya half way. “So what did you think?” Prithya asked.

“Incredible,” I said. “They’re *really* good. In all honesty, I was expecting a cover band.”

Prithya laughed. “No, it’s all original. Lia, the bassist, writes most of it.”

“She’s also in your orchestra. I heard.”

We moved back to the bar, where Prithya ordered us a round of shots of whiskey. I laughed, trying to recall the last time that I’d actually done a shot. “To London being the best fucking city in the world,” Prithya said, raising her glass. She was already tipsy, and that was fun.

Morgan and I shared a smile before raising our shot glasses and tipping the fiery liquid back. I actually coughed at the burn. Morgan had no problem downing hers.

Prithya turned to Morgan. “So how does this compare to the last time you were here?”

My wife—hard to believe sometimes—glanced at me and smiled. “Better. But different.”

Before she could elaborate, the drummer came over from the stage, a towel slung around his neck. Sweat still glistened along his arms and collarbone. He had long, shaggy hair that was tied back into a top knot, and an easy smile.

“Hey, Pri. Always a great show when you join.” He looked to Morgan, quickly taking in her short skirt, her boots, her bared belly. My own belly twisted. “And you brought friends.”

“This is my best friend, Morgan,” Prithya introduced. “And this is Nathan.”

“Hey.” He gave me a nod, but his attention was on Morgan. “I saw you up front. You’ve got serious energy.”

Morgan laughed, tucking a strand of hair behind her ear, her eyes lingering on his a beat too long before she answered. “It was a great set.”

“American.”

“Yeah. Visiting for Prithya’s performance.”

Prithya leaned her head on Morgan’s shoulder. “She’s such a great friend.”

“And this is your boyfriend?” He looked my way as he asked, but the question was all for Morgan.

She went to tuck a strand of hair behind her ear again, even though most of it was already in place from before. That’s when I noticed it. She wasn’t wearing her rings.

She caught me looking, registered exactly what I’d seen, and smiled slyly. In that half-second, I realized exactly where this was going. Her calculation was quick. We knew where we stood.

“No, just friends,” she said.

Prithya shot a quick look between us, but otherwise held her tongue. I flushed. The drummer, on the other hand, looked like he’d just discovered that he held a winning lottery ticket.

His grin widened. “Well, in that case…” He raised his pint toward her. “To new friends.”

Morgan clinked her glass against his, laughing. “To new friends.”

“I’m going to go use the restroom,” I announced to no one in particular. Pretty sure the drummer didn’t hear me at all. Morgan did glance my way, and in that look, we exchanged a whole conversation.

Have fun.

You sure?

I’ll be right here.

Okay.

Walking away from her, though, took every ounce of willpower to do. It felt like I had bungee cords strapped to my body that grew tighter and tighter with each step away. At last, in the bathroom, I was able to splash water on my face and stare at myself. My vision began to swim, and it

occurred to me that I'd already had two pints and a shot in a short amount of time.

I splashed more water on my face.

I was also very hard, my balls buzzing as much as the back of my neck. This *could* happen. It could happen tonight.

When I exited the bathroom, Morgan and the drummer were even closer now. Prithya had moved on, chatting with Tariq quietly by the stage. I wondered if they were talking about us, wondering why Morgan was pretending to be single. Or maybe they already knew about this game we were playing?

I didn't have the presence of mind to even consider what any of *that* meant. I was too drawn to Morgan with this other guy, standing within her space, chatting her up. He had a hand resting on the bar by her hip, not quite touching, but ready to. Morgan didn't shy away from the proximity. If anything, she leaned into it, just as she had with Wes when I'd watched her before.

"They say we look like twins." Ophelia's comment made me jump. I turned to the bassist, who was standing just behind me, her face glittery, her eyes large and dark. "What do you think?"

I could definitely see the resemblance, although this close, it didn't fully hold up. Her face was softer, almost Eastern European if she didn't have such a posh English accent. "I can see it."

"You think she's pretty?" She had a direct way of speaking that I kind of liked.

"Yeah." How could I answer any other way about my wife, even if this woman didn't know that.

"So that means you think *I'm* pretty." Ophelia winked. "Unless you think she's pretty because she's got nice tits."

"Uhh, no, that's not the reason."

“But she does have nice ones.” Ophelia leaned closer and lowered her voice. “Dylan thinks so.”

“Dylan’s the drummer?” I asked.

Ophelia just laughed, seeing right through me. I wondered if she was baiting me now, if she suspected that Morgan and I were together after all. I could play that game, too. “You seem jealous,” I said. “Are you and Dylan a thing?”

Ophelia laughed maybe a little too quickly. “Right to the band gossip, huh?”

I shrugged. “I’ve always wondered what the life of a rockstar was like.”

“Dylan there works at Uniqlo during the day. Ada’s a software engineer.” Ada was the keyboardist. “Hardly rockstar living.”

“And you?” I glanced at Ophelia, seeing the tight, cropped band shirt and tighter leather pants. “Let me guess. Stripper.”

Ophelia covered her mouth as she burst out laughing. “You’re a funny one.” She leaned into me. “If I was, would you come watch me?”

“Lia, stop harassing him.” It was Tariq to my rescue. He put an arm around me and squeezed. “What’s she saying?”

“Hey, *he’s* the one harassing *me!*” Ophelia met my eyes. “And you know how much I like it.”

“Ophelia here thinks very highly of herself,” Tariq explained to me, as though the woman wasn’t standing right there. “Nathan is my guest. Behave.”

“*She’s* also your guest.” Ophelia nodded towards Morgan. “And I can guarantee that Dylan’s being Dylan.”

Tariq just stared at Ophelia, something silent passing between the two of them. She held up her hands. “Okay, okay, whatever. We need to get ready for our next set anyway.”

She walked away, heading through a curtained doorframe behind the stage, where I’d watched a few other band members hang out in.

“Sorry about her. She can be a lot.”

“No worries, man.” I looked over at Morgan, who glanced at me as Dylan whispered something into her ear. I was also suddenly very aware that I was alone with Tariq. “So... you must be wondering what’s going on.”

“No, I get it.” His response surprised me. He laughed. “Prithya filled me in. A little, anyway.”

“What...?” I was confused.

“They had a boozy shopping session. You know how women can get sometimes, especially old friends.”

“I see.”

“You know we’ve also got an open relationship, right?”

“I... didn’t.” Although maybe I kind of did. *She’s not Ophelia*. “You and Ophelia?”

“For a hot minute. And also, Lia and Pri.”

My eyes went wide. “I... okay. Wow.”

“Hot, right?”

It really was. So amazingly hot. “Is everyone in my life in this lifestyle?” I said, mostly to myself.

”What’s that, mate?”

”Nothing, sorry. Just mumbling.” I scratched the back of my neck. “You know we’re not... open. Like that. Right?”

“I don’t know much about you. And whatever you’ve got going, it’s your business alone. I just wanted you to know where we stand.” He had a disarming smile. “But also, if you really aren’t, you may want to watch yourself around Dylan. He can be quite charming.”

Ophelia re-emerged from the backroom with the other guitarist. The two took the stage again, picking up their instruments.

”Time for set two,” Tariq said. “You doing okay? With the jet lag at all?”

”Surprisingly, I’m pretty wired.”

Tariq grinned. “I bet you are.”

Across the room, Dylan said one last thing to Morgan, they shared a smile, and he practically sprang back into place behind the drum set. The band slowly came alive. Conversations died down. The bar turned back to the stage. Tariq was the last to take it, shouldering his guitar strap and then stepping up to the mic.

Morgan made her way back to me, leaning against the bar at my side without being too close. We were friends, after all. “You okay?” Her question was casual, but I heard the concern there.

“Yeah. Unexpected turn, but fun. Tariq and Prithya know?”

“They know some of it. I’m sorry, I should have checked with you before.”

“It’s okay. Probably necessary if we’re going to... do... anything.” My heart shivered at the slow statement. “You seem to be hitting things off with Dylan.”

“I’ve always liked drummers. Cliche, huh?”

“I had no idea.”

“Now you do.” She bit her lip, thinking. “We can leave now, if you want. We’ve had our fun.”

Up on stage, Dylan seemed to catch her eye from across the room, smiling as he worked the drums.

“And leave him? Seems cruel.”

“He invited me back to this little after-thing. We could go to that, too.”

The suggestion hit like a blow to the chest. “Oh?”

“One of them lives a few blocks away. It’s not a big deal.” She said the words, but this felt like a big deal.

I took a pull at my beer, happy to feel the lager wet the back of my throat. “You know he doesn’t just want to hang out and talk about politics, right?”

“I wasn’t born yesterday, Nate,” she said. “Pretty sure that guy wants to talk about... his record collection.”

I snorted. The laughter felt good, but my world was speeding up along with my heart.

“Are we still playing this by ear?”

She took my beer from me and tipped it back, swallowing half of it. “I’m game if you are.”

I wondered if this was a glimpse of the girl from London that she’d been. “Let’s keep the night going.”

It seemed like the exact answer that she was hoping for, and I wasn’t entirely sure how I truly felt about that. We were beyond the check-ins and the reassurances. We were in new territory now—new to me, anyway. I watched her watch the crowd, her shoulders bouncing to the music, to the vibes, to the back beat delivered by a man who she clearly had the hots for.

The Camden flat belonged to the other guitarist, whose name I still hadn't caught. All the names were flowing together in the current of the evening. I felt caught in it, loosened by the booze and the sense of inevitability.

We walked the short distance. It had begun to rain, and the streets were slick. Morgan, in her tall boots and short skirt, leaned on Dylan for balance as I trailed behind next to Prithya.

"How are you doing?" Her question was empathetic. She linked her arm into mine, just like Morgan ahead of me, and I was happy for it.

"I'm doing great."

I felt her eyes on me, wondering if that was actually true. In the end, though, she wasn't going to stop this night. She said simply, "Okay."

We arrived at a row house tucked into a side street that was probably once grand. Now it was clearly a group house of young twenty-somethings. It smelled like cigarettes and mildew and better days.

Someone turned on some music. Someone else fired up a bong. There were more people here than just the band, although I wasn't sure if they'd come with us from the bar, or we were entering a party in mid-flight.

Tariq had a guitar out and strummed idly at the strings, sometimes matching the music, sometimes doing his own thing. People paired off and

grouped up. Morgan was at Dylan's side, speaking low. It felt like someone was sitting on my chest.

Drinks flowed. The music felt loud. I was once again a piece of flotsam in a current that I didn't want to control. I could stop watching Morgan and Dylan, even as I had full conversations with strangers—conversations that I forgot about even before they were over. My stomach wouldn't stop doing flips.

Prithya, Ophelia, and Tariq were whispering with one another, and it felt charged. Especially when Tariq put his hand on the backs of their heads and gently pressed them together. The women smiled, tilting their heads, and kissed passionately.

My mouth fell open. When the women broke the kiss, Prithya turned to her boyfriend and kissed him. Then he kissed Ophelia.

I knew that Ophelia wasn't Morgan. Despite the comparisons, I didn't see the resemblance. Maybe it was because I knew Morgan so well. Except that when I watched Tariq kiss Ophelia, for a moment, it was like watching my wife kiss another man.

And it was fucking awesome.

I watched, fixated. Her eyes closed. Her lips parted wide, her jaw working as she accepted another man's tongue into her mouth. One hand slipped behind his neck and held him close as the other braced on his thigh.

It was like all the air had been sucked out of my body, out of the room, out of the entire fucking world, and I didn't care because I was watching Morgan make out with another man.

Then the kiss ended. She looked my way, and Ophelia was Ophelia again, lips pouty and slightly swollen from the make out session. Her eyes locked onto mine, wide, large, doll-like. She smiled. Tariq whispered something to her, and she smiled even wider, rising from the sofa.

Whether she was Morgan or Ophelia didn't matter. She was sexy as hell. She wore tight jeans filled with strategic tears and a tight black tank

just small enough that the edges of her lacy black bra peeked out. I was spellbound as she sashayed up to me, unable to tear my eyes from that sly smile.

“You always like to watch?” There was that posh accent. It wasn’t Morgan. I still couldn’t step away.

“Maybe I’m just shy.” I didn’t know why I was flirting with her. I blamed the booze, which I’d had way too much of.

I kept expecting her to stop her advance at some point—to pause at a polite, safe distance where people usually paused. But Ophelia didn’t slow. She crossed into my personal space without hesitation.

Then closer.

Then close enough that I could feel her breath on my throat, see the shine of her nose stud, to pick out each individual strand of her that made up her bangs. Her body met mine. Her hand slid along my ribs, light at first, then firmer, until her fingers curled around my side and pulled me flush against her.

My heart stuttered. I didn’t know where to put my hands. I didn’t know where to look. Deep down, I knew this was wrong. I knew this evening wasn’t playing out the way any of us predicted. But I couldn’t seem to stop it, either.

“I like being watched.” I could feel Ophelia’s lips flutter against my cheek. “And I don’t mind shy.” I could smell her perfume, and beneath that... her.

Before I could find the strength to step back, to realize that this wasn’t actually Morgan being so fucking how to *do anything*, we were kissing. Her lips moved with confidence, parting, her tongue pushing past mine, her grip tightening in my shirt as she drew me deeper into it. The night began to spiral.

But I *did* break the kiss. I did stop it. I needed to pull us out of this dive.

I glanced across the room, finding Morgan where she'd been flirting with Dylan. They were still there, only now they were looking at us. Morgan was looking at *me*. I couldn't read her expression, but it didn't look great. I didn't see the same fire in her eyes that I would have felt watching her make out with another man.

I forced a smile that probably looked more like a grimace.

Dylan whispered something to her. I saw her weigh it in real time, a visible flicker behind her eyes. Then she turned toward him, slid her hand behind his neck, and pulled him into a kiss that matched the one Ophelia had just crushed me with.

My stomach dropped. The night had already felt completely out of control. That metaphoric current that I was being pulled along suddenly turned into a waterfall. I was tumbling as I watched Morgan make out with the drummer—*my wife* in that tiny skirt, his hands already on the bare skin of her waist, his thumbs caressing her.

And then there was Ophelia, still pressed against me, her hands still holding me against her. She'd tracked my eyes. "Looks like your friend's enjoying some English hospitality."

My breath caught at Ophelia's statement, but I kept staring at my wife.

Morgan and Dylan broke the kiss, but he didn't step back. He stayed close, hands steady on her waist, whispering something into her hair. She glanced my way, our eyes meeting. *This what you want?*

Was it Morgan asking me? Dylan asking her?

Morgan turned back to Dylan and nodded. In a blink, he was guiding her out of the room, threading them through the cluster of people. The crowd parted instinctively, like they could all feel the electricity snapping off the two of them.

I could definitely feel it.

Arousal surged. Panic followed right on top of it. This was everything that I'd wanted, everything that I'd been fantasizing about, yet it all felt

wrong right now. The lines had blurred. This was a mistake that was happening before my eyes. I was back in Senior Year all over again, jealousy pressing around me from all directions.

“Where does that lead?” I asked Ophelia.

“To privacy,” she said cheekily. “You want to check up on your *friend*?”

I heard the way she enunciated that last word. She knew something—or at least suspected something. I didn’t care anymore. The game was over.

“I should... I need to...”

“Get another drink?”

I laughed at Ophelia’s suggestion. “Oh, no, I’ve had way too many of those.” I almost made my point as I stepped forward and wobbled a little.

“Maybe water.”

“I’ll get you a bottle.”

Every second that I left Morgan alone with Dylan was like another ten pounds of pressure applied directly to my body. The longer he had time, the higher the chance that we’d be crossing a major line.

So I stood there in the room, hair on fire, as Ophelia retrieved a bottle of water. I unscrewed it and downed nearly half of it with a thank you. “You really want to go check on them,” she said with a chuckle.

“I do.”

“Free world, man. No one’s stopping you.”

I nodded, but hesitated a moment before stepping towards the room. Was this happening? Was this it? Not the way I’d fantasized it, but then again, when did fantasies ever follow a plan?

There was a short hallway that led to a back room. The door was half ajar, although I still thought of that door at Jeremy’s—back during senior year when I’d been so terrified that I’d discover her fucking Jeremy. How things were different now...

I pushed open the door. The lights in the room—some kind of den—were low. Dylan was just straightening up as I entered, wiping his nostrils

with the side of his thumb.

The desk lamp beside him caught on the glass-topped coffee table—thin, bright lines of white powder, a couple bills that had started to unroll, a credit card.

Before I could fully process the scene, though, there was another, softer sniff. Not his.

Morgan sat up on the opposite side of Dylan, a rolled bill still pinched in her fingers. She blinked once, a tiny flutter, and tweaked her nose like she'd done it before.

It was like everything in me jolted all at once. I was hit by surprise, shock, even arousal, like it was me at that table snorting up the rail.

A thing that I'd never done before.

Hell, I'd never even seen it before. Call me sheltered. Call me a normie. The hardest thing that I'd ever seen before were some Ecstasy pills when I was out in Santa Rosa with the vineyard crew, and I'd turned those down.

Here, though, it seemed so fucking casual—as casual as drinking a beer or passing a bowl of chips. There were two other people on a loveseat just beside Morgan, chatting lazily, already tapping out more lines.

One looked up at me. He took the rolled up note from Morgan and held it out to me. “Welcome, mate. Bump?”

“No, I’m... I’m good. Just... just looking for my friend.” I nodded at Morgan.

“Nathan,” she said, rubbing her nose involuntarily as she shifted on the sofa. “Hey, um... we were just...”

“No, I got it.”

The guy on the loveseat—one of the two who'd taken the rolled bill from her—snorted a laugh under his breath, already bending over the table again. He wasn't paying attention to us anymore. Neither of them were.

Morgan, though, watched me, eyes wide, pupils even wider.

“Well, you’ve found her.” Dylan draped an arm over her slender shoulders and stared up at me as if to say, *Now what are you going to do?*

I ignored him. I was staring at Morgan, who was staring back at me in the same exact way: like nothing else mattered. Like we were alone in the room. Everything else around us was just background noise.

There was something feral about her in that moment. I’d seen glimpses of the old her, the wild her, the version of her that had come to London to have new experiences, but this was the first time that I’d actually seen her. And seeing her, staring at her, I wanted to drag her out—not like that party from so long ago, not out of jealousy or insecurity, like a caveman pulling her by the hair. I wanted to get out of there because I needed to fuck her.

Morgan saw all of this. The worry and guilt melted away.

“I think we should go,” I said.

“You can go,” Dylan responded with coked up bravado. “I’ll make sure she gets home by sunrise. How’s that?”

My dick swelled. It was actually a tempting thought, even though this guy wasn’t endearing himself to me at all.

It was Morgan who spoke up for us. “No, I’m ready.” She held her hand out to me, and I helped her stand.

To his credit, Dylan released her. Not that he was happy about it. He stood with her, directing his ire towards me. “Now time out, mate. We were just getting to know one another.”

I looked at Morgan and resisted the urge to say, *Ditto*. Instead, I posed the question to her. “Would you like to stay?”

It was a dangerous question to ask her as I took in the too short skirt, the thigh high boots, her kiss-swollen lips. If she wanted to stay, she would stay. We’d deal with those consequences in the morning. But I had a hunch.

“No, I think it’s time to go.”

Dylan saw the way we were looking at one another. The friend facade was gone.

“The fuck is going on here?” He looked at me. “Who the fuck are you, *friend*?”

Old Nathan was quick to anger. Old Nathan was quick to go dramatic. Old Nathan was just starting to emerge when Morgan stepped between us, placing her palm in the center of the drummer’s sinewy chest. “I’ll tell you who he is,” she said. “He’s the best fucking *friend* I’ve ever had. He wants what’s best *for me*. Not a guy who only wants something *from me*.”

She was wired. I could almost feel the restless energy radiating off of her in waves. Her pupils were huge, her breathing quick. “We’re leaving.” Dylan had been dismissed. This command was for me. “Now.”

I don’t remember the goodbyes. I don’t remember the house. I do remember the rain, which was coming down hard. How we grabbed a cab. How we made it back to Clerkenwell and the completely empty flat like it was ours.

“I like this city,” I said as we unlocked the front door. “I see why you did.”

Morgan didn’t say anything to that. She just pulled me close, her body soaked in the cold rain, and kissed me, wild and unrestrained.

Like a fever dream, we stumbled through the hallway, pulling at each other’s clothes. I tossed Morgan’s sodden coat to the floor as she practically tore open my shirt.

She backed me up against the wall of the narrow hallway, her mouth against mine, her kiss urgent. Her hands were already working at my belt.

“Morgan—”

“I need you.”

My belt came free. She yanked at my jeans, shoving them down my hips while her tongue invaded my mouth. It was all I could do to keep up, to hang on, my hands on her waist.

I found the zipper of her skirt and tugged at that as she shoved her hand down the front of my boxers. “Mmm, you’re so hard.”

I gasped. “We should...” I glanced towards the guest bedroom.

She nodded, discarding her skirt outside the door as she pulled me inside, wearing nothing but her black thong, her halter top, and those tall boots. Fuck, that was hot.

The top went next, and the bra followed. By the time I hit the bed, I’d kicked off my jeans fully. I don’t even remember losing my shirt. Morgan was upon me, straddling me, rubbing herself along my length with just the thin layer of underwear to separate us.

“Stay,” she commanded, grinding against me through my boxers. I could feel how wet she was through the thin fabric.

I reached for her breasts—perfect handfuls, nipples hard—but she caught my wrists and pinned them to the bed. “*I said, ‘stay.’*”

My breath caught. She wasn’t usually like this, but I liked it. It was new. It was thrilling. She peeled off her thong, sliding it over those boots, then freed my cock. I watched, mesmerized, as she positioned herself above me. The slick heat of her was right there, teasing, so fucking smooth. Then she sank down in one motion, and I swear I almost came.

Instead I gasped, “Fuck.”

“Okay,” Morgan said with a charged grin. She started riding me, hard and desperate, chasing something. Her hips snapped and rolled, taking me deep, her breath coming in sharp gasps. I gripped her thighs, my fingers digging in, feeling her muscles flex.

She leaned forward, bracing her hands on my chest, changing the angle. Her dark, still-damp hair fell around her face as she fucked me. I thought of the way she’d bent forward earlier, at the house party, before I knew it was her. Her sniff. The line crossed. The line snorted.

“Morgan,” I groaned. The pressure came on fast. Too fast to stop it. “I’m gonna—”

“Not yet,” she panted. “Not yet, not yet—”

But I couldn't hold off any longer. I'd been holding back for too long. I needed to come. I needed release. The sight of her, the feel of her, the desperate energy radiating off of her—it was all just too fucking much.

I came hard, gripping her hips, feeling the grain of the leather on those tall boots as she dragged them along my thighs.

Morgan didn't stop bouncing on me. She ground down hard, rubbing her clit, chasing her own release, even as I started to soften inside of her. One more thrust and I popped free.

"No," she breathed. "No, we're not fucking done here."

She sat up off me and slid down my body before I could fully process what was happening. Her mouth was on me instantly, swallowing my cock.

I gasped, too sensitive, but she wouldn't relent. "Morgan, I can't—"

She ignored me. Her tongue worked along my length, her hand stroking in time with her bobbing head. She was relentless, desperate. I started to respond, despite having just come.

She pulled off with a slurp. "You liked watching me kiss Dylan?"

I jumped in her hand. She grinned. "I liked kissing him, too. What would you say if I did this to him?"

With that, she lowered her mouth back down to my dick, eyes never leaving mine as she blew me. Or blew Dylan. Would she have done it? If I hadn't gone back there, would they have moved somewhere even more private?

She pulled back, and when she did, I was fully erect again. "You like that idea."

She climbed back up my body, positioning herself over me again. This time when she sank down, she cried out. "Yes. Fuck, yes."

She rode me even harder than before, one hand between her legs, working her clit while she fucked herself on my cock. I watched her chase her orgasm, seeing the slender lines of her body flex and use me. The

piercing in her belly button caught in the dim light. If I hadn't come already, I'd be coming now.

But instead, I held on, gripping my incredibly sexy wife's hips, watching her close her eyes and throw back her head. Her body trembling as she came, her mouth open, her hand a blur between her thighs.

Her pussy clenched around me. I didn't come with her, but in that moment, it wasn't what I needed. What I *needed* was to hold Morgan close as she collapsed onto my chest, shaking and ragged and once again mine.

WE LAY IN THE DARK, listening to the rain outside the windows. We hadn't turned on any lights. We hadn't even bothered climbing under the sheets. "You're still wearing your boots," I said. "They're that comfortable?"

"No." She laughed softly, shifting onto her back to gracelessly unzip the unwieldy things. "But worth it. I'm going to need to get me a pair."

"They're Prithya's?"

"Yeah. Same size."

"She's full of surprises." I turned onto my side, reaching out to tweak Morgan's nipple. "So are you."

Morgan glanced at me. Her pupils were finally returning to normal, although I could still feel her jittery energy as she curled up against me.

"I'm guessing that wasn't your first time?" We both knew exactly what I was referring to.

She shook her head.

"London? Lorenzo?"

"London, yes. But not just because of him. It was just part of the experience. I told you I went there to try new things."

I nodded. "You did. I just... I've always thought of that as pretty hardcore. But at that party, it was just..." I shook my head. "...like so

casual.”

“Yeah. I used to feel that way, too. The first time I saw Cassidy pull some out before a club, I was so shocked. Guess I got acclimated to it.”

I took it in. Of course Cassidy did it. Seemed so obvious now, but I honestly had no idea. I went with humor, which was my usual defense mechanism when it came to uncomfortable topics. “You know you probably didn’t need to go all the way to London to experience that. It’s probably easier to get in the good old U.S. of A.”

“Oh, I know. Believe me.”

Something about the way she said it. “Those experiences didn’t stop in London, did they?”

Morgan looked bashful. I felt the sudden pressure of a new confession. “It was never a big deal or a regular thing, but no, they didn’t. I was still friends with Cassidy senior year...”

“Aspen?”

Morgan nodded. “I’m sorry.”

“No, no. I’m not all that naive. Just kind of surprised. Seems a little wild for you.”

“And at the time, it didn’t seem wild at all.”

I thought about med school, her abuse of Adderall. She’d used a similar statement when talking about that time. It was easy to normalize anything. “How about since then?”

“No, not since. Until tonight. After med school... well, it was a wake up call. There was some of that going on at Cassidy’s bachelorette party, but I didn’t participate.”

I wondered what would have happened if she had. “And tonight?”

“Tonight was different than then. Tonight... you were there. But also, it felt like I was back in time, back here in London. Different faces, similar experiences. But with you at my side, keeping me tethered. And then I saw

you making out with that..." I thought she was going to say 'slut,' but she reigned herself in. "...with Pri's friend, and it was like the tether snapped."

"Were you going to go back and fuck him?" My cock actually jumped as I asked the question.

"Honestly? No. Not at first. Even going to the house party was like a big, extended tease. Like a show. For *you*. I was drunk—still *am* drunk—and I didn't want our first time to be something we'd not remember in the morning. Plus, I'm not going to cross the line with a random *drummer* for fuck's sake."

She laughed.

"But then we got there, and I saw you with Lia, and you seemed to enjoy that. And then Dylan asked if I partied, and I just shrugged and went with it." She slowed herself down, took a deep breath. "I'm sorry. It's not very fair of me to get so jealous when you're... you."

"Well, that's actually a more normal response."

Her hand was on my cock again, stroking it slowly. I'd never gone fully soft. "But it does get you excited." She was quiet a moment, then: "Nathan, what do you actually want? Like, really want?"

The question hung in the air between us. My heart rate picked up again.

"I want..." I swallowed. Could I actually say this? I swear I had, yet whenever I thought back on it, it had always been couched as a euphemism. But euphemisms weren't meant for a moment as raw as this one. We were beyond that kind of shadowplay now. "I want you to fuck someone else."

There. I'd said it. Out loud. Not hinted at it, not suggested it through some story about Trip and Tracy or a comment about her past. And fuck did it feel good. That weight that had been sitting on my chest all night long—maybe my whole life long—was finally lifted.

Morgan's hand stilled on my cock. "You want me to fuck another guy." It wasn't a question.

I resisted the urge to say something stupid, like, *Another woman would be fine, too*. Because that wasn't actually the truth, as hot as it was. The truth was that I wanted her to fuck *another man*. So I simply said, "Yes."

And she simply said, "Okay."

It wasn't a dismissive okay. It wasn't packed with judgment or disappointment or resignation. It wasn't even pure acceptance. There was a lift to the end of it. There was hope. There was the sense of, "*Okay, we're going to do this thing.*"

"And you, Morgan? What do you really want? And you're not allowed to say, 'You're all I want.'"

She laughed. "For the record, I wasn't going to say that." She paused, thinking, processing. "I want it, too. It's hard to express just how turned on it makes me, seeing you watching. Like tonight, it was such a turn on when Dylan led me out of the room. I could practically feel your eyes on me."

"Yeah, that was intense."

"I don't *need* this, though. It's important that you get that. I'm not some sex-craved nymphomaniac."

"I don't know. Some of the stories I'm hearing bouncing around this place lead me to believe otherwise."

She laughed lightly. "The stories are snippets. What you're not hearing are the hours spent in the library cramming for tests. Or going to plays in the West End. Or traveling around the English countryside. I did all those things. I lived all of that. It was part of the experience. And yes, some of those experiences got a little wild."

"You let go here," I said. "And I want to watch you let go again. With me."

"I can do that. But I'm coming back after."

"I sure hope so," I said.

"I want to be thoroughly reclaimed."

I snickered at the term. “Can one reclaim something that one doesn’t own in the first place?”

“It is a funny term, isn’t it?” She let a comfortable silence settle between us as she traced circles on my hip with her thumb. “You really think you’d be okay with it? Like, really okay? Not just in the fantasy, but after?”

That was the million dollar question. “I think so. I mean, tonight scared the shit out of me, especially when you went back there with Dylan, but it also...” I gestured down at my still-hard cock. “Obviously.”

She issued a nervous laugh.

“I trust you, Morg. And I want you to feel free to... to be that girl in London again.”

“But I’m not her anymore. And I don’t want to be.” She kissed my shoulder. “But if you want me to be the woman who’ll fuck another man for her husband’s hotwife fantasy, then I could be persuaded.”

I felt relief and fear and optimism for what was next all at once. “I feel like I’ve been trying to persuade you since New Orleans.”

“And I’ve been listening. Just not ready. Neither of us were. And we weren’t tonight.”

“No.”

“If we’re going to do this, we’re going to be sober, with eyes wide open.”

“And not with Dylan,” I added.

“No,” she laughed. “Definitely not Dylan. He turned out to be kind of an asshole.”

“Kind of?”

She laughed softly. “That’s something you should know. I’m attracted to assholes. You should have seen...”

“Don’t say it,” I spoke over her, knowing the joke that she was about to make, as she finished, “...the guy I dated senior year of college.”

We shared a laugh, and it was amazing. After it settled, though, Morgan went on. "Actually... I may have already found someone."

My heart stopped. "What?"

"Today. When Pri and I were shopping." She bit her lip. "We were talking. I told her about... about what we've been exploring. About you wanting this."

"Tariq mentioned it, actually."

"I'm sorry."

"It's fine. We're all friends, and they seem very... open."

"Yeah they are. She straight up came out and offered Tariq to us." She laughed. "Like she was letting me use her car or something. She said I could 'borrow' him if we wanted to try it."

My mouth went dry. I'd watched him kiss Ophelia tonight while imagining it was Morgan. And I liked the idea. "Tariq..."

"If you want to." Her hand resumed stroking me. "We don't have to. But Pri said he'd be into it. That he thinks I'm hot. And..." She paused. "I mean..."

"You think he's hot, too."

I loved that Morgan could still blush, despite everything that had gone down tonight.

I shook my head. "Holy shit," I said, mostly to myself.

"Is that a good 'holy shit' or a bad one?" She was watching my face carefully.

I looked down at where her hand was working my very hard cock. "What do you think?"

She laughed, relieved. "So you'd be okay with it? Really?"

"Yeah. Fuck. Yes." My mind was racing. "When? How would it...?"

"I don't know. Soon? Before we leave?" She shifted closer. "We'd need to talk to them. Make sure everyone's on the same page."

"Right. Of course." I was still processing. "Tariq."

“You keep saying his name like that.”

“Because I keep picturing you with him.”

“Yeah?” Her strokes got slower, more deliberate. “What are you picturing?”

“You in those boots. That skirt.” I swallowed. “Him touching you the way I’m touching you now.”

“Just touching?”

“No.” My hips moved involuntarily. “More than that.”

Morgan’s breathing had changed. Her free hand slid between her own legs. “Tell me.”

“You and him. Knowing you want it. Feeling him enter you. Hearing you come on his cock.”

“Fuck, Nathan...” She climbed atop me again, positing herself over my cock, “How about you picture *you* with me right now,” she said, sinking down slowly. “Round three.”

I groaned as she took me in fully.

“You didn’t come the last time,” she observed, rolling her hips. “And there’s one other thing you should know about me.” She bit her lip, starting to ride me with that same desperate energy from before. “Coke always makes me so *horny*.”

Away we went. Together. Like we had always been. Like we always would be—even while we were apart.

Making the decision to cross the line was one thing. Actually doing it proved harder. Especially when we ended up sleeping in until noon the next day. By that time, everyone was gone.

Also, my hangover was real, and judging from the way Morgan was barely moving, hers was worse.

I got us some water and found some Advil with our travel kit, but once she was on her feet, Morgan announced her own version of a cure.

“We need a good English breakfast. You can’t leave London without experiencing that.”

“It’s after noon,” I pointed out.

“I know just the place.”

And she did. It was a small cafe near the university, painted blue and just big enough to hold a handful of tables. The cook’s young daughter sat at one, playing a Nintendo Switch, and smiled at us as we were seated.

“I can’t believe it’s still here,” Morgan said, smiling at the girl. “And it hasn’t changed.”

“You used to come here often?”

“At least once a week.” She looked at the menu briefly, then set it down. “And we’re getting the Full English Breakfast.”

“Pudding for breakfast?” I asked.

“Blood pudding. It’s not the kind of pudding you think it is.”

“What is it?”

“You’ll see.”

We ordered the breakfasts along with coffee, and the food really did help with the hangover. Or maybe that was the fluids re-entering my system. The so-called “blood pudding,” however, did not agree with me. “Nope. That’s... I don’t want to know what that is, but it’s not for me.”

“Fair enough,” Morgan said, forking mine off my plate and adding it to hers. She smiled at me, and I smiled at her. God, she was amazing.

“So about last night,” I began slowly, once the throbbing in my head had dulled. “Want to back out? Change our minds?”

“Only if you do,” she said. “Do you?”

Did I still want her to sleep with Tariq? To fuck him? To get on her knees and—

“Yes. I mean, yes, I still want that.” Then, quickly, “If you want it.”

“You’re an adorable man, Nathan. I do want it. But for us, okay?”

I wondered if she’d ever had this kind of conversation with Lorenzo. Maybe they’d sat in this very cafe after a night out, talking about what he wanted her to do. Had she given the same answer?

”With Lorenzo...” I began, wanting to have this conversation, but not sure how.

Morgan seemed to follow my line of thinking, just as she always did. “He never asked what I wanted. He assumed that *he* what wanted, I wanted.”

“And was he right?”

She took a long, slow breath as she considered her answer. “Maybe at the time, I thought so.”

“Like the see-through dress?”

“Yeah.”

“And the trip to Spearmint Rhino?”

This was well-trodden ground. Morgan knew it, and leaned in to short-circuit it. “Nathan, with Lorenzo... he knew what he wanted, and I wanted to give it to him. It was that simple. This isn’t a judgment on you or what we have. I’m just saying that things with him... they were different.”

“Before we came out here, you said that if Lorenzo told you to hook up with Prithya, you’d do it. *And* you’d enjoy it.”

“Yes, exactly.”

“And if I told you to do that?”

“You wouldn’t. Not unless you knew that’s what I wanted to do. It’s what I love so much about you. It’s what lets me *trust* you.”

“But you liked not having to decide back then.”

She considered this. “I’m not going to lie. I did. There was something freeing about just... letting go. Not thinking, just doing.”

I thought about Tariq on stage, the quiet command he had. The way he pushed Prithya and Ophelia together for a kiss. “And with Tariq?”

Morgan’s eyes met mine. “We’ll see, won’t we? But he seems like a man who knows what he wants.”

“And he wants you.” It felt so wrong to say.

“It does seem that way.”

Morgan was a total dichotomy. On the one hand, she was one of the most capable people that I knew. Type A to a fault. Always striving for perfection. She’d known that she wanted to be a doctor since she was a young girl. On the other, she completely suppressed that strong sense of self when she was here last time, with Lorenzo, and became his plaything.

But she wasn’t just one or the other. She was both. I’d seen both. Whether I realized it or not, I’d *fallen in love* with both. It was the flaw that drove me away at first, and that flaw that brought me back. She wanted to present herself as perfect, but I loved that she wasn’t.

“You’re thinking,” she pointed out.

“Yeah, sorry.”

“Ready to share?”

“I’m the one usually asking that.” I smiled at her. “Not much to share. Just... I love discovering all these aspects of you. I love the messiness of it.”

“And I hate that I have them. Sometimes.”

“I know you do.”

After the *very* late breakfast—which really did help with the hangover—we ended up seeing the quieter, less touristy side of London that Morgan had fallen in love with. We walked along Regent’s Canal and through Little Venice. There was a hidden garden there that she’d discovered early on and went there when she needed to be alone and think.

“I spent a lot of time here,” she said as we sat side-by-side on a stone bench. “I thought about you a *lot* while I was here.”

Looking around at the small, cloistered space, I finally saw the real Morgan from back in that time. She wasn’t the party girl. She was just a girl.

“Thank you for showing this to me,” I said.

“And thanks for coming.” She took my hand in hers. It was clammy, and when I looked her in the eyes, I could see her nerves. “I heard back from Prithya.”

My heart skipped a beat. “What did she say?”

“She said that she would be in final rehearsals for most of the day, but that she’d talked to Tariq.”

My mouth was suddenly so dry. “And?”

“She said he’s home now. And is game if... if we want to go there.”

“This is it.”

She was already sitting close. Now she scooted even closer. “This is it.”

I had to remember to breathe. I had to remember that this was real, not a dream, not a hypothetical. “I’m ready.”

Morgan leaned in and kissed me passionately, pressing her body to mine. “So am I. Now how do you want to do this? Do you want to be in the room?”

The idea was as terrifying as it was exhilarating. I’d thought about it a lot. Many of my fantasies involved walking in on her mid-coitus. There was something so wrong about that. But for our first time...

”Yes, I’d like to be there.”

”Good.” She squeezed my hand. “I want you there, too.” She rose. “Shall we head back?”

I drew a shaky breath, but when I stood, I was solid on my feet. “Let’s go.”

We took the slow way back to Clerkenwell. The streets were still wet from the rain last night, and while the sky threatened, it wasn't raining now. We made the journey together, holding hands all the way.

"We don't have to do this," I said, giving her one last out as we stood before the front door to Prithya's.

"We don't." She tugged at my hand. "That's kind of why this works."

Agency. It was something that she hadn't had before—at least not in her sex life. Not beyond her decision to completely give it up.

Tariq met us at the front door of the flat, looking casual in a pair of jeans and a tight gray shirt. This was the man who was going to fuck my wife.

"Hey, you two." He smiled, stepping aside to let us in.

I had no idea what to expect. For all of my fantasies, I'd never considered a moment quite like this.

"Hey," Morgan said, sounding about as unsure as I felt. "You talked to Pri, then?"

"She filled me in." The man was so fucking at ease with this, although even he couldn't wipe away the smile at his good fortune. "You want something to drink?"

“No, no drinks.” She squeezed my hand one last time and turned for the guest bedroom. “I’m going to go change. Give me a few.”

We both watched her disappear behind her door. The other man turned to me with a knowing look. “You okay? I could fix *you* a drink if you want.”

And I could have used one. But no, I was going to honor the vow of sobriety here. “I’m good.”

The silence stretched, and I searched for something to fill it.

“So... have you done this before?” God, why did I ask that? “I’m sorry, this is all new... and, like, really awkward.”

“Hey mate, no worries. I get it. I’ve been there before.”

“Really?”

He chuckled. “I still remember how weird it was the first time Prithya and I decided to swap, although there was a lot more alcohol involved.”

“Worth it?”

“Oh, fuck yeah.”

We went into the kitchen, where Tariq retrieved a couple bottles of water from the fridge. “My suggestion? Stay hydrated.”

So practical in the face of what we were about to do. “Thanks.”

“How long have you been thinking about this?”

“A while. I’m not really sure when it started. Or, you know, I actually know exactly when it started, but I don’t know when it became, like, a whole hot... wife fantasy.” I knew that I was rambling, and unscrewed the water bottle just to shut myself up.

“When did it start?”

“When she was here, studying. Or, when she came back, I guess, and I started hearing stories about her time.”

“Ah, you mean with that guy Lorenzo.”

I thought about Prithya in the grotto, naked and on her knees before Morgan’s ex. “You’ve heard of him?”

“Prithya shared some stories. From your wedding, actually. We were just getting back together and I think she was trying to make me jealous.”

“Lorenzo and her...?”

“Fucked, yeah. A lot. Apparently he’s got a huge dick.”

”So I’ve... heard.” I drank more of the water. “And that doesn’t bother you?”

“Morgan experienced it a lot more, from what I understand. Does it bother *you*?”

“I see your point.”

“Sexuality is a mysterious thing, Nate. Don’t overthink it.”

The door opened. Morgan emerged with a tentative step. My breath caught. She’d exchanged her jeans and blouse for a tight, gray jersey dress. It was short and hugged her body while still feeling casual, and as she walked up to us, all I could think about was how easy it was going to be to remove.

“You look so sexy.” It was Tariq who spoke first, as I fought to find my own voice. “So,” he said in a tone that wouldn’t have been out of place accompanied by clapping his hands together. “How do you two want to do this?”

Morgan came to me first, placing her hands on my chest as she kissed me softly. She’d applied some makeup while in there—some eyeliner, some mascara, some lip gloss. Still in my arms, she turned to Tariq and said, “Let’s go into your bedroom.”

And with that, she detached herself from me and went to *him*. My stomach swam as I watched the two of them. As Morgan slipped her hand into Tariq’s and gently pulled him in that direction.

He simply grinned and let himself be guided. I followed closely behind.

Prithya’s bedroom was a little larger than the guest one, but it wasn’t huge. Not by American standards, anyway. Plants sat on the windowsill.

The bed was a modern four-post canopy. And at the foot of it was a chair. For me.

I tried to slow my breathing down, to get my heart under control. It was hard when Morgan turned to face Tariq, looked one last time at me, and reached up to him. With one hand on the back of his neck and the other cupping his jaw, thumb caressing his dark scruff, she pulled him in for a volcanic kiss.

His hands went right to her, pulling her against him by the small of her back with one hand as the other grasped her bare shoulder.

I gasped. Morgan broke the kiss, checking in on me once again. I wasn't sure exactly what she saw in my face, but it was enough to make her smile and nod at me. To mouth, *I love you*, before returning to Tariq.

Tariq sat on the edge of the bed and pulled Morgan into his lap. She straddled him, and because the dress was so short, it rode up over her ass, exposing what turned out to be a gray g-string.

As hot as that was, though, watching Tariq's hand cup Morgan's breast through the dress was even wilder. When he tugged the strap off her shoulder, pulling the jersey material down her body, I think I forgot to breathe.

Her breast popped free, and Morgan gasped. She flicked her hair back as she leaned back enough to give Tariq access. He took it, leaning down to capture a nipple between his lips.

I was rock hard. Painfully hard.

Morgan held him against her chest, fingers in his dark hair, mouth open. She looked over at me, her eyes alight. *This is happening*, she seemed to say.

The other man's teeth grazed her nipple, and Morgan gasped, her eyes fluttering shut, our connection wavering. I'd never done that to her. I'd always worried that I'd hurt her, but Morgan didn't push him away.

He ran his hands lower as he continued to suck her tits, down her body and across her ass. By this time her dress was nothing more than a belt bunched up around her narrow waist, leaving her nearly completely exposed.

"Fuck, you're hot," he said, lifting his head. They kissed again, quick, forceful kisses, like animals snapping at one another in their need. Morgan cradled his face in her hands, rising up over him, pressing her body against his.

I wasn't really expecting much hesitation in Morgan, and she showed none, grinding her hips against Tariq's as they kissed.

He pulled something from his pocket: a small black ring about the size of a poker chip. Breaking their kiss, he asked Morgan, "Do you know what this is?"

I didn't have a clue, but Morgan apparently did. "Yes."

He handed it to her. "Put it on."

I watched, confused for only a moment, before Morgan shifted off of his lap and knelt down between his legs. Tariq pulled his gray shirt off, revealing a broad, muscular chest with matted hair. Morgan looked almost luminescent against his deep brown skin.

Shirtless, he reclined with his arms behind him, watching as Morgan fumbled with his belt, her hands shaking slightly as she worked the button open.

I wanted to touch myself. I wasn't sure if that was appropriate—then nearly burst out laughing at how crazy that sounded, even in my own head.

The sound of Tariq's zipper cut through the air, thick with tension. His cock sprang free, bigger than mine, thicker, even semi-erect.

Morgan took that little black ring and slipped it over the tip of his dick, rolling it down the length, right into the trimmed thatch of dark hair at the base. Then she stretched the ring and gingerly stuffed his balls through.

“Someone’s used a cockring before,” Tariq said, watching her work. His hand found the back of her head, his fingers threading through her dark hair. “Go on.”

She leaned in and took him into her mouth.

I had to grip the arms of the chair and start counting backward from a thousand by twos just to keep from coming right there and then. Watching Morgan's lips stretch around another man's cock—watching her choose to do it, watching her want to do it—was unlike anything I'd ever experienced.

The intensity of the moment only grew, though, even after that first threshold had been breached. Her head bobbed as she worked him, her hand gripping the base of his shaft, stroking in time with her mouth. Tariq's head fell back, but his hand stayed firm in her hair, guiding her pace.

Morgan gagged slightly when he pushed deeper, but she didn't pull away. Instead, her eyes rolled up to meet his, watching him and what she was doing to him. She wasn't with me. She wasn't imagining me. She was with him. Tariq. A new man. A new cock.

“That’s it,” Tariq breathed. “You’re so fucking good at this.”

I felt pride in his praise of her. No doubt Morgan did, too, as she moaned around his dick, the vibration drawing a groan from Tariq. His hips began to move, fucking into her mouth with controlled thrusts. My wife—my beautiful, controlled, perfect wife—was on her knees taking another man's cock down her throat, and she was loving it.

I shifted in the chair, my own cock desperate for attention, but I couldn't look away. Wouldn't look away.

When he was fully hard, his dick ballooning around what I now knew was a cockring, Tariq pulled her off of him. Morgan gasped for breath, her lips swollen and wet, her mascara slightly smudged.

She rose, all limbs, curves, femininity, and pushed the gray scrap of her dress over her hips. The g-string went next, discarded just as hastily.

There she was, my wife, completely naked before another man. Her breasts heaved with her ragged breathing, the thin landing strip of dark hair between her thighs leading the way to her wet slit.

Tariq already had a condom in his hand

“On the bed,” Tariq commanded. “On your back.”

Morgan moved to obey, crawling onto the mattress and lying back against the pillows. Tariq followed, positioning himself between her thighs. He ran his hand down her body—over her breast, across her stomach, down to the apex of her legs.

I watched, transfixed, as he ran a finger through her wetness.

“Fuck, you’re soaked,” he said, and there was satisfaction in his voice.

He lowered his head, and Morgan’s back arched off the bed as his mouth found her. I couldn’t see it, but that didn’t matter. Watching her react to him was so much more powerful—her hands gripping the sheets, her whimpers, the way she arched up into him.

“Oh God,” she gasped. “Oh fuck, yes, just like that—”

I couldn’t deny myself any longer. I unzipped my jeans and fished out my dick. I was throbbing, leaking precum. My balls hurt.

Tariq gripped her thighs, holding her open for him, as his head moved in tight circles. Morgan’s head thrashed against the pillow, her eyes squeezed shut, her breath coming in short, sharp pants.

“Mmm...” She moaned. “Ohhh yesss...”

I stroked myself slowly, not daring to go any faster. I didn’t want to come too soon. I wanted to last.

Just as she was at the edge of an orgasm, Tariq pulled back. “I’m so close,” she whined.

“I know you are,” Tariq said, sitting up and rubbing her pussy. “I like it.”

Morgan moaned, shifting her hips against his hand, but again he denied her release. “No, please...” she said with a gasp.

“Top drawer,” he said, nodding at the nightstand.

Morgan twisted, pulling open the drawer as directed. My breath caught when I saw her retrieve a square wrapper. A condom. This was it.

She glanced in my direction, her eyes tracking to my dick. I nodded at her. She bit her lip and nodded back.

Then she tore the wrapper open with her teeth and fished out the white latex sheath. Tariq sat up on his knees, his cock bouncing forward looking huge and plump, no doubt bolstered by the cockring. Morgan rolled the condom down its length, pinching the end, making space where his come would soon fill. She’d done this before.

Before things progressed, though, she turned back to me and held out her hand. I went to her, climbing up onto the bed at her side, and nodded. “Watch,” she whispered, turning back to Tariq. He was there, moving, positioning himself against her entrance.

Next to her now, I could see everything. I could watch as Tariq pushed forward and sank into Morgan with one long, slow stroke.

Morgan cried out, her back arching, her hand tightening in mine, so hard it hurt. I didn’t care. I was right there with her, watching another man’s cock disappear inside of my wife.

“Oh God,” she gasped. “Oh fuck, yes—”

Tariq was slow at first, letting her get used to him—maybe letting *me* get used to it. It was obscene, watching her stretch around him, my own porn right there in front of me. Each long, deep stroke drew gasps and whimpers from her, so controlled, doling out the experience to us both.

“That’s it,” he said, his voice low. “Fuck, you feel good.”

“Oh, my... oh God,” Morgan gasped, her hips rolling to match his rhythm. Her breasts bounced with each stroke, her face tight with pleasure.

And the whole time, I was right there, watching her take it, watching her get fucked by another man. It was the single hottest thing that I’d ever seen in my life.

But it was just the beginning. Tariq was holding back, and after a few minutes of that steady pace, he picked it up. Pulling almost all the way free, he slammed back into her, hard. Morgan's entire body jolted with the force. A cry ripped from her throat.

"Fuck!"

"More?"

"Yes." Morgan was nodding frantically, her breathing ragged. "Yes, more."

Tariq obliged. He picked up the pace, his thrusts becoming harder, deeper, more urgent. The bed began to shake with the force of his thrusts. From this position, I could see his muscular body moving against hers, could see the contrast of his darker skin against her pale flesh, could see the way her fingers dug into his back.

She'd let go of my own hand as their sex grew harder, more rabid.

"Oh God, yes, yes yes!" Morgan gave herself over fully to the sex, her hips meeting his thrust for thrust, like her entire focus narrowed to the sensation of him inside of her.

With his thick arms on either side of her, he loomed over her, kissing her passionately as he continued to drive into her.

The kiss set me off. I didn't want to, but all of a sudden I was coming in my hand as another man claimed my wife in front of me.

And then Morgan was coming, hard. She broke the kiss and arched her back, chest up, eyes shut tight. Tariq kept moving, kept fucking her. "That's it," he barked. "Take it. Take it just like that."

"Oh! Oh!"

I kept jerking myself off, too, but my dick was deflating, and with it, the high of the moment.

Morgan, on the other hand, completely past words, only made sounds—gasps, whispers, broken cries of his name, as she seemed to keep coming and coming. If Tariq was close, he didn't show it. Maybe it was the

cockring. Maybe it was just his natural stamina. The man fucked like a machine.

With my come cooling on my wrist and stomach, I slipped off the bed. “I’m just going to clean up,” I announced. Tariq nodded at me, but didn’t stop fucking. I’m not sure Morgan heard.

I slipped out of the room, leaving the two of them, so I could get washed up.

The bathroom was cool and quiet. I cleaned myself off with toilet papers, my mind still spinning. We’d actually done it. Morgan had fucked another man, and I’d watched. She was not just a wife anymore. She was a *hotwife*. A fantasy that had been born out of an insecurity that had started *here*, in this very city, was now a reality.

I sat on the edge of the tub for a moment, catching my breath, letting my heart rate come down.

No one can really know how they’ll react to a fantasy made real. Until that moment, in the post-orgasm clarity of another couple’s bathroom, I realized that this really was what I wanted. I had no regrets, and from the sounds of it, neither did Morgan.

I stood up, catching my reflection in the mirror. My hair was a mess, dark blond waves askew, forehead glistening with perspiration. I was so flushed. Thoroughly fucked.

And yet I couldn’t wipe that smile from my face. I almost clapped my hands. Instead, I splashed water on my face and headed into the kitchen to grab some water.

They were still going at it when I started for the bedroom. I could hear Morgan’s cries—“Uh! Yes! Uh!”—and the creak of the bed, faster now, harder.

My cock, which had only just started to soften, jumped back to attention. I moved toward that partially shut door, my hand absent-mindedly wrapping around my cock as the sounds of sex grew louder.

Morgan was on her knees on the bed, her back to me, her body glistening with fresh sweat. Tariq was behind her, holding her by the hips as she grasped the headboard. And he was *fucking* her.

“Oh God, yes!” The room was filled with the sound of slapping skin and Tariq’s barking grunts.

“You like that?” he asked, voice low, a growl.

“Yes! So... so good!”

Tariq’s hand came down hard on her ass, and Morgan cried out. Not in pain. I recognized that sound. I’d heard it before, when I’d spied on her with her old boyfriend, Will.

“How about that?” he asked

“Yes,” Morgan admitted, her voice lower now, like she didn’t want to fully admit it.

I wasn’t sure if I should stay, join, leave. I was rooted to the spot, watching the scene unfold, watching my wife lose it to this other man.

He spanked her again, and Morgan hissed, her head hanging between her shoulders. I realized that she only held the headboard with one hand. The other was between her legs, furiously playing with her clit.

“I’m going to come again,” she gasped. “Please, I’m gonna—”

“Do it,” Tariq commanded. “Come on my cock.”

Her whole body went taut as she came, pushing her hips back against him as she came hard. “Fuuuuck!”

And Tariq *still* wasn’t done.

He pulled out of her and sat back on his heels, his chest heaving. His cock was still hard, glistening with the condom and her wetness. “Come here,” he commanded.

For a second, I wondered if he was talking to me and flinched back. But no, all attention was on my wife.

It was Morgan who moved, Morgan who he was staring at. Morgan, her body flushed, her ass red from his spansks and where he’d dug in his thumbs

as he pounded her, looked thoroughly fucked.

And still she wanted more.

They kissed first, the wet sounds feeling like fingers gently tickling my balls. When Morgan pulled away from him, she glanced my way and smiled. So she knew I was there.

Her smile, her vivid excitement, was worth any angst that I'd felt—which was surprisingly little.

I love you, she mouthed.

I blew her a kiss.

Tariq reclined on the bed, one muscular arm bent behind his head, and peeled the condom off, already reaching for another.

Before he could roll it on, though, Morgan turned, bent down, and wrapped her lips around him.

"This one's a keeper," he said to me. I just nodded, not trusting myself to speak.

Morgan used her hand to jack him as she bobbed, rubbing her thumb in a lazy zigzag along his sensitive underside. Tariq groaned, rolling his head back. "Fuck, that's good, but I'm going to need you to ride me. That pussy is too good to resist."

Morgan nodded, taking the new condom from him and rolling it back down his length. It was such a simple gesture, yet so loaded. With a flip of her hair and a quick glance back, checking in on me, Morgan mounted Tariq and eased down over his cock with a gasp.

That wasn't going to ever get old.

"Mmm..." she groaned as he opened her up. Bracing her hands on his shoulders, she began to ride him, hips rolling, eyes closed, skin glistening with sweat.

"Fuck, that's good," Tariq said, watching her move above him, letting her set her own pace...

...for a few moments, anyway. Then he pulled her down against his chest and pinned one of her arms behind her back with his own. She couldn't move like that, held tightly against him. But he still could.

I had the perfect view of the two of them from where I stood as he began to thrust upward, driving into her with controlled power. I could see his latex-sheathed cock slide in and out of her with each movement, her pussy stretching around his girth.

Morgan's head fell back against his shoulder, her mouth open, her eyes shut. She couldn't do much more than receive the fucking.

"Oh God," she gasped. "Yes, like that—"

He kept her pinned there, his arm a vice around her, as he fucked up into her. With the hand not holding her, he grabbed her ass, slapping it again, squeezing her, using her in a way that I'd never done before.

I wasn't sure that I *could* use her like that.

The man seemed super human as he fucked her. How long could he last? How good was that fucking cockring? I thought about pulling out my phone and ordering one myself.

Then I thought about pulling out my phone and filming this. But I didn't. I needed to ask her first, and I wanted to live in the moment just a little longer.

Tariq shifted again, sitting them up abruptly, wrapping his hand around her neck. She steadied herself with her hands behind her, bracing herself against his knees. Her eyes were open, staring at him with challenge.

"You know what I want to see," Tariq said, face closer to hers.

Morgan waited to be told, breathing hard.

"I want to see how hard you can ride me. Show me how much you need it." He leaned in, as though to kiss her. She tipped her head to receive, but he pulled back. "Show your *husband* how much you need it."

And with that, any last bit of hesitation in Morgan fell away. She repositioned her legs so that her feet were flat on either side of him, putting

her into a low squat. She wrapped her arms around him, forehead to forehead, and started to bounce on his dick, hard and fast.

Her breasts bounced against his chest with the force of it, her breath coming in gasps and cries. I watched his big dick drive into her again and again, her heart-shaped ass even pinker now.

“Yes, yes, yes!” she chanted, her movements becoming frantic.

She rose up over him and their mouths crashed together again.

Tariq’s hands gripped her hips, resuming control, even as she bounced in his lap. He pulled her down to him, pushed her up, fucked her like a ragdoll. “Harder,” Tariq groaned against her mouth. “Come on. Harder.”

Morgan obliged, her bounces becoming almost violent, her entire body moving with singular purpose, She was close—I could feel it, could see it in the tension of her muscles and the way she could barely breathe with just those short gasps.

“I’m gonna... I’m gonna...” She gasped between bounces, tipping her head back.

“Come. Yes. Fucking. Come.” Now Tariq was driving up into her. His hands made impressions in her ass. He was close at last. The man *was* human after all. “Fucking. Come.”

“Ah! Ah!”

“Take. It.”

“Ahhhh!” Morgan was there, coming again, grinding her hips down into his as she squeezed her arms around his neck.

Tariq finally lost it, too. “Fuck yes,” he grunted, his body tensing, his hips finally stilling as he exploded inside of his condom.

They stayed like that for a moment, locked together, both breathing hard, both completely spent and covered in sweat.

Then Morgan pulled back and looked over at me, standing in the doorway. Her eyes found mine, and when they did, she looked relieved. I hadn’t left. I hadn’t hidden away. I was there with her.

She crawled off of Tariq, whose cock was finally wilting. He carefully disposed of the condom and slipped out of the cockring. I barely registered it. I was so focused on Morgan, getting to her wobbly feet, moving towards me. She was completely naked, skin flushed and glistening with sweat, hair a tangled mess. Body covered with the signs of sex, pink marks, spank marks, the flushed exertion.

“You look thoroughly fucked,” I said.

She laughed lightly. “I feel like it,” she said. Coming to me, she steadied herself on my body and leaned in. She smelled like him—like another man, his cologne, his musk, his come. But she was mine again. “But I’m not done fucking yet,” she said.

For a second, I thought she was going to ask for round three. “Okay. Want me to get you two water?”

“No, you goof,” she said, seeing my misinterpretation. “I need to get fucked *by you*.”

“Oh.” I laughed.

“Come on,” she said, taking me by the hand and pulling me out of the room. “Time to reclaim your blushing bride.”

“Time to reclaim your blushing bride.”

In our bedroom, she turned and kissed me, deep, urgent, desperate. Her hands found my shirt and practically tore it off my body. One moment ago, she seemed ready to collapse. Now, I was ready to consume.

I was just as amped up. I felt the hunger, too, and when she kissed me, I kissed her right back. I pushed her onto the bed, and she grabbed me, pulled me onto her.

My hands were shaking, my mouth finding hers again, then her neck, then her breasts. She was still wet. She still smelled of another man.

“I *need* you,” she hissed, fumbling with my pants. Easy enough since I’d forgotten to zip back up after watching earlier. She shoved her hand inside, grabbing my cock as I wiggled the rest of the way out of them.

Climbing over her, she positioned me against her sex as I drove forward.

“Oh, yes,” she gasped, her hands gripping my back, her legs wrapping around me. “Yes, yes, yes.”

She wasn’t as tight as she’d been yesterday when we’d fucked after the party. Tariq was bigger than me, and as I slid my dick into her very slippery pussy, there was no doubt that he’d stretched her.

If I hadn't come earlier, I'm pretty sure I would have at that realization. I'd heard of that sensation before. I'd read about it, about husbands whose wives were looser thanks to their more well-endowed lovers. I didn't think it was a thing for me. I didn't think that I had that kink. But as I sank balls deep into my bride and experienced the evidence that she was no longer mine alone, it was like the swell of an orchestra all around me.

And with that, I started to fuck her like a man possessed. I don't think I truly understood what "reclamation" sex was until I needed so desperately to reclaim her. I had something to prove, and I was intent on proving it.

Morgan met me thrust for thrust, her nails digging into my shoulders, her voice breaking as she completely lost it.

Tariq was somewhere outside. He'd hear this. That only drove me to fuck Morgan harder. Let him hear. Let him know that I could make my wife come just as hard as he could.

"Come, baby," Morgan pleaded. "Give me your come."

I drove harder.

"Tell me you still love me," she gasped.

"I still love you." I fucked into her. "I will always love you."

"Then come, baby."

I drove harder.

"Give me your come."

I was so close. My balls tightened.

"Make me yours."

Her heel pressed into my ass, demanding. I obeyed.

This time when I came, I wasn't watching a show that continued without me. This time, I was completely present, completely connected with my wife, my love, my soulmate.

Morgan started to come as she felt me fill her, her words a beautiful, unintelligible mess. Her body hummed against me. Her pussy clenched and

squeezed and milked. Her arms tightened around my neck, holding me close as we reunited as husband and wife.

When it was over, we lay tangled together, both breathing hard, both completely spent.

“I love you,” she whispered into the darkness.

“I love you too,” I said.

“No, I fucking *love* you.”

I laughed, and it felt wonderful. All of this felt so wonderful.

We lay in comfortable silence together. The sun had set at some point. I had no idea what time it was. I barely remembered that we were still in England.

“No regrets?” she asked at last.

“Only that we didn’t do this earlier.”

Morgan snuggled closer, like she wanted to climb inside me. “We weren’t ready.”

“I know.” I did. I totally did. And this was the only way that it would have worked. “But I’m glad we did this.”

“Me too.” Morgan was my wife again, the girl I’d fallen in love with, smiling and looking bashful despite the crazy sex she’d just had.

“You think it’ll be weird?” I asked. “With Tariq and Prithya?”

“No, I really don’t. I don’t think we could have picked a better couple to experiment with.”

“Yeah? What about Trip and Tracy? Or Cassidy?” *Or Lorenzo?* I didn’t dare say it.

Morgan laughed. “Trip and Tracy are our neighbors. What if things got weird?”

“They could still get weird here,” I pointed out.

“And we’ll be gone in three days. We could always go stay somewhere else. Harder to do with the people who literally live in a house attached to ours.”

“So you’re saying that you’d fuck Trip otherwise?”

Morgan slapped me gently on the shoulder with a laugh, and moved on without answering. “And Cassidy is a woman, not a man.”

“Oh, I know.” Before she could slap my shoulder again, I added, “And she knows a lot of guys.”

“That’s definitely true.”

“You’re right, though, Tariq was pretty perfect. And it seemed like he knew what he was doing.”

“Oh, yeah.” Her enthusiastic acknowledgment made my dick jump.

“So we do have three more days here. Tomorrow’s the concert, then a free day, then we fly home.” I knew what I wanted to say, but suddenly felt like it was too much to ask. I mean, my greatest fantasy literally just became reality, and now I was wanting more?

“That is a lot of time to... experience more of what London has to offer,” Morgan said for me with a knowing smile.

“I just want to experience what you did, back in the day.” I tweaked her bare nipple. “You know, to better understand you.”

“And Tariq *is* a great host.” Morgan couldn’t stop smiling as she said it.

“His hosting skills are quite impressive,” I said.

Morgan burst out in a hysterical laugh. “God, I love you, you dork.”

“I love you, nerd.”

We kissed.

“How about boundaries? We should talk about that,” Morgan said once we stopped giggling.

“I liked being in the room, but honestly? It was pretty fucking exciting when I heard you two outside the door. So I don’t think I need to be there, if that makes sense.”

“I liked that you were there, but okay. I’ll keep it in mind.” She thought about it more. “Condoms? We didn’t talk about it, but I’m glad Tariq had them.”

“Yeah, need to be safe.”

“Is anything off-limits for you?” she asked.

I thought of Lorenzo, who pushed all of her limits. I wasn’t going to be the one to impose my own. “I trust you. As long as you’re comfortable...”

“I don’t know. You’d be surprised at what I can get comfortable with,” she teased.

“Sounds like story time.” I turned fully on my side so I could look at her. “Now that you know that I’m not some wilting flower, tell me a wild one.”

“Wild huh? Hmm...” Even just watching her sit there and run through the mental catalog of wild stories was stirring something inside me. I didn’t think I could get it up again, not fully, but today, anything seemed possible.

“How about one involving the so-called ‘Stallions.’”

“Luca, Klaus, and Milo?” Morgan cracked up. “You think I had sex with those three? Like all at once?” She laughed some more.

“So that’s a no.” I kind of felt foolish. I definitely felt oddly disappointed.

“That’s a no,” Morgan confirmed. “They were Lorenzo’s groupies.”

I laughed it off. “You know me and my imagination. Gets pretty wild sometimes. I mean, you were with a guy who seemingly got you to do some wild stuff. I just figured that some kind of multi-guy orgy *could* have happened.”

“Well I didn’t say it *didn’t*. Just not with the ‘Stallions.’”

My jaw fell open.

Just then, outside the door, we heard Prithya enter the apartment, her heels clicking along the hardwood. Tariq came out to greet her. “*You’re back,*” his low voice came, muffled through the door.

“I’m back. That smells amazing, love.”

Morgan looked at me. “I swear, I didn’t mean to leave you in such a lurch, and I promise to make it up to you later with a nice, juicy story, but

we should probably get dressed.”

I groaned, but she was already getting out of bed and pulling on a sweat shirt. I didn’t want to follow. I watched her pull on a pair of baggy, heather grey loungers, and wondered just how awkward this was going to be.

I got up, too, and got dressed, and went to follow Morgan.

“Hey, there,” I heard Morgan say in the next room, her voice light.

“Hey yourself,” Prithya returned. Her voice dipped. “You okay?”

I emerged from the bedroom to see Morgan smiling shyly at her friend and nodding her head. “I’m... great, Pri. Like, really great.”

The two turned to look at me when they saw me step out. Morgan added, “*We’re* great.”

“That true, Nathan?” Prithya asked. It was actually nice that even *she* was checking in on me.

“Like I’m still in this amazing dream,” I responded.

Prithya was still in her rehearsal clothes—black leggings and a black knit blouse. She studied us both for another moment, then her whole face relaxed into a grin. “Oh, thank God.” She turned back to her bag and pulled out a bottle. “Because I brought champagne to celebrate, and while I may like to drink, I’m not sure Tariq and I could polish off a whole bottle ourselves.”

Tariq laughed from the kitchen. “Speak for yourself.”

That’s when I realized how hungry I was, and how amazing it smelled out here. Turning, I saw Tariq—dressed again, of course—moving about the kitchen. He had something sizzling in a pan on the stove and was just pulling a pan of roasted vegetables from the oven.

“I think maybe I’m still in that dream?” I said.

The girls laughed.

“No one wants to wake you,” Prithya said. She held up the champagne. “Come on, let’s celebrate.”

THINGS WERE SURPRISINGLY chill despite the monumental line that we'd just crossed. It helped that Prithya and Tariq were so chill about it, with Prithya continuing to check in with us and make sure that everything was good, while at the same time snuggling close to her man, to show us that there were no hard feelings.

"So how long have you two been doing this?" I was happy that Morgan asked the question that I was so curious about.

The two looked at each other, sharing a whole conversation before Prithya turned to us. "Well, we've been on-again, off-again for a little over a year."

"Really casual at first," Tariq added.

"I wasn't really looking for anything serious, but Tariq was a great booty call." She stared at Morgan and added, "As you now know."

"I can attest." Morgan laughed, even as her face turned red.

"But he's also just a good guy. When I came to your wedding and saw just how much you two loved each other, the person I kept thinking about, when I closed my eyes, was this guy." She grinned at Tariq.

"She actually texted me how much she missed me," Tariq said. "In fact, I think her exact words were, 'I wish you were here so I could fuck your brains out.' I told her to find someone to stand in for me."

"And that's when I knew he was a keeper," Prithya said.

Morgan and I looked at each other, both thinking the same thing—Lorenzo. I guess that Morgan hadn't told her friend that I'd spied on them. That made me feel better.

"After I came home, we decided to try the dating thing again, only we kept things open. I mean, they were already pretty open, but we kind of included one another more."

“And you don’t get jealous?” Morgan asked. “Of him and other women?”

“Of Tariq fucking you all afternoon, you mean?” Prithya was beaming at Morgan’s discomfort. She put a hand on his arm. “No, I don’t get jealous. If anything, I’m pretty proud of what my man is capable of doing.”

“I... could see that,” Morgan said.

“It’s not for everyone. All relationships are different.”

Morgan nodded, but said, “It doesn’t seem fair though, right? I mean, like, Nathan lets me have all the fun, how can I deny him?”

“I bet he doesn’t see it that way.” Prithya turned to me. “Do you?”

“I don’t. It’s not, like, a reciprocal thing for me,” I said. “My fantasy is to have a hotwife, not be a swinger.”

Tariq chuckled. “My recommendation is not to put labels on everything. Don’t box yourself in.”

“I’m a teacher. We label and categorize. It’s kind of what we do. And yet that does make sense,” I said. To Morgan: “But seriously, honey, I don’t see it as unfair. There is no resentment.”

“You really are different from the guy who I came back to Senior Year.”

“And you’re different from her, too. And *way* different than the girl who left for London.”

Prithya watched our exchange with curiosity. “And even way different than the high school Morgan. You should have seen her back then. All lanky, wearing glasses, total nerd.”

With that, the conversation moved on from swinging and sex and hotwives to tamer topics: high school friends, movies, the logistics of tomorrow’s orchestra concert at the Royal Albert. We were once again friends and guests, not lovers or fuck buddies.

Yet underneath it all, we all felt it: the promise that this visit wasn’t over, and there was still so much more fun to come.

Despite only being a couple of days removed from our West Coast USA time, Morgan and I crashed out hard that evening. We had dinner, talked about tomorrow, got ready for bed, and by the time I changed out of my contacts, Morgan was asleep.

I wasn't that far behind her. Or at least I didn't think that I was. We'd gone through so much that day—both physically and emotionally, and it's not like we got great sleep the night before.

Still, I must have been suffering some residual jet lag because I stirred awake sometime later that night. Checking the clock, it was only a little past 11 and I needed to pee.

Once out in the hall, I heard it—the unmistakable sound of sex coming from the now familiar door to the master bedroom. “Uh, uh, uh.” A woman moaning. The rhythmic creak of a bed.

My stomach churned. Morgan had been in the bed beside me when I'd slipped out to use the restroom, right? Now I couldn't remember and my paranoia spiked.

Morgan wasn't actually in there, right? She hadn't snuck out to get another go at him. She hadn't.

“Oh, yes...”

I couldn't tell if that was Prithya or my own wife. Not through the door. I took a step towards the door, drawn just like earlier.

Through the door, I heard Prithya and her Indo-British accent. "You made her come."

Tariq's response was muffled, but I heard Prithya moan in response.

"Fuck, that's so hot. My hot fucking man making my bestie... uhh... scream."

The bed creaked faster.

"I want to hear everything," Prithya gasped. "Tell me... tell me how good she felt. Did you... did you *stretch* her?"

I stood frozen in the hallway, my cock hardening despite myself. Any relief that I felt finding that it wasn't Morgan in there was forgotten as I listened to how much Prithya got off on hearing about the afternoon. She was like me, a kindred spirit.

I tiptoed into the bathroom, forced my dick down enough to pee, then went back to the guest room. They were still fucking when I passed, and Morgan was definitely asleep on our bed.

I snuggled in next to her and sleep found me, filling my dreams with visions of sex that faded by morning.

I WOKE up the next morning alone. Morgan's spot was empty, and for one disorienting moment, I wondered if she'd spent the night with Tariq. My dreams bled forward, my hazy recollection of listening to sex coloring this moment.

Thing was: I didn't hate it. I mean, I didn't love it, either, but just like last night, there was just something I found deeply exciting about the idea of Morgan *needing* to fuck a man so badly that she snuck out of bed to do it.

And just like last night, I was wrong. I heard Prithya and Morgan talking in hushed tones in the kitchen as I finally wandered out. They had their heads together, whispering, coffee mugs cradled in their hands.

I paused in the doorway, not wanting to interrupt. From where I stood, I could see that Morgan was relaxed and well-rested. Prithya had a hand on Morgan's arm, her expression serious but warm. Checking in. Making sure.

Morgan nodded at something Prithya said, then squeezed her friend's hand. When she looked up and saw me, her smile widened. No guilt. No hesitation. Just genuine happiness.

"Morning, sleepyhead," Morgan said, holding her hand out to me. "Coffee?"

"Please," I said, going to her and kissing her good morning.

Prithya looked between us, seemed satisfied with whatever she saw, and grinned. "I was just telling Morgan that tonight's going to be amazing. I scored the three of you great seats in the orchestra."

"Can't wait," I said, accepting the mug Morgan handed me.

Whatever conversation they'd been having was over, but I got the sense that everything had been said that needed to be said. Morgan was good. We were good.

And judging by the way Prithya was looking at us, she was good too.

"Also, I think you're going to like the dress she bought the other night," Prithya added.

I looked at Morgan, wondering if I'd get a reprise of *the* dress, the one that Lorenzo made her wear to the opera. But no, as much as this was a trip down memory lane, some things were going to remain in the past. I couldn't imagine Morgan causing such a scandal these days.

"She looks good in anything," I said, meeting Morgan's eyes.

"She does, but trust me, she'll look really good in this one."

Morgan just rolled her eyes at her friend. She said to me, "How are you feeling?"

I wasn't sure if she was asking about how I felt now that she was a hotwife—she was a *hotwife!*—or just now I slept. Then I realized that the answers were the same. “I feel great.”

Morgan beamed up at me. “Good.”

“So what's in store today?”

“We'll take a trip down the Thames on the river ferry to Greenwich. Do some touristy stuff there. Walk up to the Prime Meridian.”

“And you'll talk,” Prithya said from her seat at the kitchen table.

“Of course,” Morgan said. “And then we come back here and get ready for the concert.”

“Are you nervous?” I asked Prithya.

She shook her head. “Oh no. We've been practicing so much I'm pretty sure I could do this in my sleep. Not that I'll be sleeping at all. This is me checking off one of my bucket list items, and I'm not even thirty.”

Glancing at Morgan, I wondered if yesterday was a bucket list item for me, too. Certainly not one that I'd *always* had, but leading up to it, I realized that it was.

“It's going to be amazing.”

SO WAS THAT DAY.

It spit rain most of the day, was gray and overcast, was chilly enough that ducking inside any building was a welcome respite, and I loved it. It was basically Portland, and we loved Portland. Only we weren't in Portland. We were thousands of miles away, happily tourists, enjoying the day.

“You know, I never got down here?” Morgan said as we exited the ferry into the quaint town of Greenwich.

“Too busy with... studying?”

Morgan heard the short pause in my question and laughed. “I mean, yeah, honestly.” She sidled close to me, arm in mine, and leaned close as we walked. “But also other things.”

My heart fluttered. “So are you going to tell me about your multi-guy orgy?”

Someone definitely looked back at us as I asked the question, his eyes wide. Morgan nudged me in the ribs, hanging back as we passed by the Cutty Sark, an old clipper ship with a museum built up around it.

“That story is best told somewhere private.”

“We could go to Spearmint Rhino. Pretty sure no one would blink at a story like that there.” Spearmint Rhino was the stripclub that Morgan had gone to with Lorenzo back when she was studying here. He’d gotten her to get a dance from a stripper named Sapphire, and the story had stuck with me since then.

“It’s actually closed,” Morgan said. When I looked at her in surprise, she said, “I checked. Flood closed it a few years back.” She giggled under my stare. “What? I figured you may be interested in that, so I looked it up.”

“Too bad,” I said.

“Besides, if I recall, it opened, like, at 10 pm or something. Not the kind of place where the London suits go for a steak lunch, like back home. It was definitely for the party crowd.”

“Too bad.”

“Yeah, too bad. Although...” She glanced at me, and I knew this next part would be good. “I did read that there’s a place called the Pendulum Club that opens at...” She checked her watch. “...in about two hours.”

“Well that’s interesting.”

“Very,” she agreed.

Neither of us could stop smiling.

“Just enough time to walk up to get a photo of us standing where time starts. Although I really was looking forward to losing myself at the

Maritime Museum.”

Morgan laughed. “Well, we could do that instead. I have absolutely no plans. Just giving you options.”

“There are plenty of maritime museums back home.”

Morgan snorted. “Come on. Let’s do the walk up the hill.”

FROM THE OUTSIDE, the Pendulum Club was nondescript. Located on a side street a few blocks off Greenwich Church Street, we almost missed the small plaque printed with the name. No neon lights. No velvet ropes. Just a door with a gold handle and the sign.

Inside was a different story.

The entrance opened onto a small foyer with dark wood paneling and low amber lighting. A woman in a sleek black dress stood behind a podium, her expression professionally neutral.

“Good afternoon,” she said in a posh accent, mostly addressing me. “First time?”

“That obvious?” Morgan asked, her voice steadier than I felt.

“No, but I’d recognize someone as stunning as the two of you.” Her smile was warm. “There is a cover charge.”

“Naturally.” Morgan removed a credit card from her purse.

The woman took the card and swiped. “It’ll appear as P.C. Inc. on your bill, as will any additional expenditures that you incur.” After running the card, she tapped an earpiece that I hadn’t noticed that she was wearing, inclined her head slightly and spoke quietly into her sleeve. A moment later, a man in a well-tailored suit appeared from a side door. He was older, maybe mid-fifties, with silver hair and an easy smile.

“Welcome to the Pendulum Club,” he said, his voice smooth and practiced. “I’m Thomas. I’ll be your host this afternoon. If you’ll follow

me?”

He led us through a heavy velvet curtain into the main room, and I had to stop myself from staring. I'd never actually been to a strip club and I honestly wasn't exactly sure *what* I was expecting, but the Pendulum Club wasn't it. There weren't garish lights. There weren't sad patrons drinking at the bar alone as they watched girls shake it on a narrow stage.

On the flip side, it wasn't the glitzy layout that's sometimes portrayed in the movies, with multiple stages and a sea of low-backed chairs, where dancers moved through the crowd like sharks.

No, this space was a lot more intimate. Deep burgundy leather booths lined one side of the wall. Small tables with flickering candles dotted the room. A sleek bar ran along one side, backlit with amber light that made the bottles glow. Even the music was sleek and loungey, electronic with a bent towards jazz.

At the far end, a single brass pole stood on a small circular stage. A blonde in black lingerie and stockings moved around it, graceful and athletic, her hips moving in time to the sexy beat of the music.

There were only two other groups in the club—a couple of older guys in the back, and a group of three men in business suits at a corner booth, speaking in hushed tones with a brunette dancer perched on the arm of their seat. One turned to look over at us as we walked in, and I felt like a complete imposter.

“Our dancers are available for personal dances in the booths,” Thomas explained, his voice pitched low. “For something more intimate, there are private rooms upstairs. You're also more than welcome to simply enjoy the ambiance and the entertainment up on the stage. The bar is open, and we have a full menu if you're interested.”

He led us to a booth with a good view of the stage but tucked away enough for privacy.

“Your server will be with you shortly. Enjoy your visit.” He gave a slight bow and disappeared.

Morgan slid into the booth, and I followed. For a few moments we just sat there, taking it in.

“This is...” I started.

“So different,” Morgan finished.

“Not what you were expecting?”

“Uh, no.” She laughed like it was all so ridiculous. “Just to be clear, it’s not like I’m an expert on these things. I’ve been to two other, uh, ‘gentlemen’s clubs.’” She said the word with an affected accent. “And they were, like, way more like a... I don’t... like a club than this, if that makes sense. This is...”

“Classy?”

“Yeah.” She laughed again. “Like, I feel a little underdressed.”

I knew what she meant. We were the only obvious tourists here, probably the only Americans, and I felt like I’d stumbled into someone else’s expansive party.

A waitress appeared—blonde, stunning, wearing a very tiny black dress.

“What can I get you to drink?” Her accent was Eastern European, her smile warm.

“I’ll take a gin and tonic,” Morgan said, then turned to me.

“Uh, same.”

The waitress smiled and disappeared in the direction of the bar. I couldn’t help but watch her go. Even the waitress looked like a model. Beyond her, the blonde on stage moved with hypnotic grace, her body rolling against the pole in fluid movements.

Almost like she sensed me looking, the dancer glanced back through a cascade of golden hair, met my eyes, and deftly unclasped her black bra.

I felt Morgan’s hand tighten on mine and looked over at her. She looked as mesmerized as I felt.

“What?” she whispered, seeing me staring.

I shook my head, unable to put it into words for a moment. Eventually I said. “I’m just surprised that you’re all wide-eyed is all. I thought you had all the experiences.”

Morgan laughed quietly, covering her mouth. “No, definitely not *all* the experiences.” She took my hands in hers. “I’m glad that we came here—to London, I mean—so that you could get a better idea of what my life was like back then. It wasn’t all parties. I really did spend most of my time studying, as boring as that sounds. Or just, like, traveling. Going to museums. Doing a high tea.”

Our drinks had arrived at some point, delivered discretely. On stage, the dancer was easing down her thong, her back to her small audience. But rather than watch that, I turned back to my wife, because she needed to be challenged a little on this.

“But you were also dating—”

“Not dating,” Morgan corrected.

“Then what was it? Are you denying that you two were effectively a couple here?” It should have been a deflating question, but if anything, my whole body surged.

Especially when she quietly said, “No, I won’t deny that,”

“So while you may have been having normal life-experiences here, you were also not-dating a man who had access to a yacht and a private jet and at least one vacation home in Spain. A physical specimen who you’ve admitted you’d do everything that he asked you to do.”

“Not *everything*,” she said.

“I’m not upset. Maybe once, yeah, even thinking that stuff would have set me spiraling. But now, it’s all just... I don’t know... fascinating, I guess. Exciting?”

“You’re an amazing man, Nathan. I’m so lucky that Will’s parents had that reunion at your vineyard.”

“This is going to sound sappy and romantic, but I think we were going to find each other again, somehow,” I said,

“You’re right,” she nuzzled close, lowering her voice. “That was pretty sappy.”

I laughed.

She added, “But I don’t mind sappy and romantic.”

“Wasn’t your Spanish boyfriend a romantic?” I think I mostly called Lorenzo her boyfriend to trigger me—in the best ways—but it seemed to have some kind of effect on Morgan, too.

“He could be. If it served him. He loved expensive dinners. He loved jet setting to romantic *places*, but I wouldn’t call him romantic. Definitely not sappy.”

The smile she wore as she reminisced made me happy that he was well in her past, but also intrigued me. What would it be like if he was back—beyond just showing up for our wedding?

On stage, the blonde had finished her set. The music shifted to something deeper and more sensual, and a new dancer emerged through the back curtains.

She was stunning. An Asian woman, Vietnamese maybe, based on her tawny skin and facial features. She had a tight little body, showcased by her white thong and top that glowed under the lights, and wore her black hair in a bun. She moved to the pole with complete confidence, and I was momentarily distracted.

“You like her?” Morgan asked.

“She’s very, uh, athletic.”

Morgan snickered. The dancer released her hair, and it cascaded around her tanned skin. The tips were dyed platinum blonde.

“You can look, you know,” Morgan said. “We *are* in a strip club. It would actually be rude not to.”

I thought about two nights back, with Ophelia, with the kiss and the way Morgan had looked at us. There was no doubt that she'd been jealous, whether she chose to admit it or not. Then I thought about Morgan and Tariq and yesterday afternoon's amazing experience, and something occurred to me as I watched my wife.

"You didn't take me here to, like, even out the scales or something, did you?"

Judging from the way she didn't immediately deny it, it was clear that I had guessed right. "We *were* looking for somewhere private to talk," she said, but she knew she was busted. She couldn't stop grinning—a sure tell that she was lying.

"You know you don't need to do that, right?" I said. "Seriously, I'd actually rather watch you get a lap dance than get one of my own." I wasn't sure if that was *exactly* true, but it sounded noble enough in the moment. "And all things being equal, even better would be to watch you go at it again with Tariq."

"Really?"

"I take it this wasn't how things went with Lorenzo when he brought you to a... venue like this?"

"Uh, no."

"Tell me."

"Well, there was far less conversation, for one."

I remembered her story of Sapphire. "And he told you to get a lap dance. I'm good with that."

Morgan giggled. "Yes, I heard." She picked up her gin and tonic and sipped. "But even that was different. You're, like, giving me permission. You're suggesting. And I love that about you," she quickly added. "About *us*. With Lo, he didn't suggest. It wasn't about him giving me options. He gave orders."

"And you followed."

“Yeah.” She said it for what it was: a nostalgic confession. A regret, but not quite a regret.

Before this conversation could continue, movement before the table pulled my attention. The brunette who’d been with the business men was approaching our booth. Up close, she was even more striking—delicate features, auburn hair, wearing champagne-colored lingerie and heels.

“Hi there,” she said, her accent unmistakably British. “First time at the Pendulum?”

“First time, yeah,” I said.

“American,” she smiled. “Lovely. I’m Sienna.” She looked between us. “And you two are so cute. I love it when couples visit us.”

“Newlyweds,” Morgan said, holding up her left hand.

“Even better.” Sienna’s smile widened. “Can I interest either of you in a dance?”

I looked at Morgan, thinking about Ophelia, about reclamation, about reversing the dynamic. Thinking specifically about Lorenzo and how he didn’t just suggest.

“My wife would like a dance,” I said.

Morgan’s head turned toward me, eyes wide. “Nathan—”

“You heard me.” I grinned. Then, because I was who I was, I added, “If you want it.”

Sienna’s smile turned knowing. “Oh, I do like you two.” She extended her hand to Morgan. “What do you say, love?”

Morgan looked at me one more time, then nodded and took Sienna’s hand. To me, she said, “It’ll be twenty quid for the dance, billed to your card.”

Watching the woman lead Morgan towards the private booths along the wall, I would have paid just about anything in that moment. Twenty seemed like a bargain.

The private booths, which had been empty when we'd arrived, were a deeper burgundy leather than the chairs, recessed enough to offer a semi-enclosed space. LED candles flickered on a small shelf, creating an even more intimate ambiance, and the music was louder here. The intent was to enjoy dances, not have deep and meaningful conversations.

"You sit here," Sienna said to Morgan, gesturing to the center of the booth. "And you..." She looked at me with a playful smile. "You can sit over there." I was directed to a spot at the very edge of the booth, giving me a great view of the action. "House rules—no touching the dancers, but watching is very much encouraged."

Morgan settled into the booth, her hands gripping the edge, her chest rising and falling a little faster.

Sienna moved to the center of the small space, and the music shifted—something slow and sultry. She began to move, her hips swaying, her hands trailing down her body. She was professional, practiced, but there was something genuine in the way she looked at Morgan.

"Just relax," Sienna said softly, moving closer. "This is for you."

She turned, her back to Morgan, and began to lower herself—slowly, gracefully—into Morgan's lap. Morgan's hands stayed frozen on the edge of the booth, her knuckles white, but her eyes... her eyes were completely locked on Sienna back, the clasp of the other woman's bra, the way her thong plunged between her perfectly formed buttocks.

Sienna rolled her hips, her body moving in waves against Morgan. She reached back, unclasped her bra, and let it fall away. Her breasts were small and perky, and her nipples were hard. She turned to face Morgan again, straddling her now.

"You're beautiful," Sienna said. I knew it was a line, that this woman was paid to sound genuine. But she sure sounded genuine, and Morgan seemed to buy it. "Your husband is a very lucky man."

Morgan's breathing was shallow now, her pupils dilated. Sienna's hands moved to her own body, cupping her breasts, trailing down her flat stomach to the waistband of her champagne thong.

The dancer rolled her body against Morgan's, leaning down as if to kiss my wife. I thought of Morgan's story with Lorenzo. *Lo wanted us to kiss, so we kissed.* I so wanted them to kiss.

Morgan, too. She turned her head and leaned in, but at the last moment, Sienna eased back, just out of reach, and Morgan groaned.

Instead, the stripper turned again, once more facing away from my wife, and hooked her thumbs into the sides of her thong. Slowly, so slowly, she eased the fabric down, bending forward as she did so, giving Morgan a peek at the smooth lips of her pussy. When she straightened, flipping her hair, I saw the neat triangle of dark hair she had about her otherwise bare sex, and now she was completely naked, still moving to the music.

I watched my wife watch this beautiful woman dance for her. Morgan's lips were parted, her face flushed. I could see the pulse in her neck, could see the way her thighs pressed together.

Sienna sank back into Morgan's lap, reclining into her, her dark hair draped over Morgan's. She spread her legs, and her pussy glistened with excitement. She ran her hand down her body, down between her legs. We both watched it, Morgan and I, holding our breath. When the dancer touched herself, I'm pretty sure we both groaned.

Over her shoulder, she said to Morgan, "I wish this was your hand, but rules are rules."

Morgan nodded, watching the other woman play with herself as the song finally ended.

Sienna sighed, sitting forward and straightening. I swear there was some reluctance there. She leaned back down to Morgan, a hand going to the back of my wife's neck. "Upstairs, in one of the rooms, we could continue. And up there, the rules are more... relaxed."

I was about to say yes, to take my money.

“And how much is that?”

“Five hundred.”

That was a lot, but in the heat of the moment, I was already thinking about what things we could cut back on in the next month. Who needed groceries—

“Thanks, but we’re going to pass,” Morgan said, the voice of reason. “Maybe next time.”

“God, I hope so,” Sienna said. And then she did lean forward and kiss Morgan gently. “You really are fucking hot.” With that, she gathered her lingerie and was gone, leaving us alone in the booth.

Morgan sat very still, her hands still gripping the edge of the booth, her breathing uneven.

“You okay?” I asked.

She nodded, then laughed—a breathless, disbelieving sound. “That was...”

“Hot?”

“So hot.” She looked at me, her eyes dark. “Nathan, I need you. Now.”

I moved around her, getting close. She was like a stick of dynamite with a lit and sizzling fuse. Any moment, she would explode. Perfect. “First, we came here for a reason.”

She looked at me, glassy eyed and confused.

”A story, remember?”

Morgan blinked, remembered, and laughed. “You’re pretty focused.”

“And you seem to be trying to do anything you can to get us off the subject. So that means this story is pretty good.”

She touched my chest. “Come on, let’s go back to our seats. Refresh our drinks. And then sure, story time.”

“O kay, so a story.”

Morgan and I were back in our seats, pulled as close to one another as we could get. A new dancer was up on the stage: a pale skinned redhead with freckles *everywhere*. We had fresh drinks, although both of us were slowly sipping it. This would be our last before tonight’s orchestra performance, and neither of us wanted to be drowsy for that.

“I lost my mom when I was twelve. Have I ever told you about that?” She saw the expression on my face and laughed, despite the serious subject. “I know, I know, not exactly the story you want to hear. We’ll get there.”

I shook my head. “No, it’s okay. Please, share. I actually don’t know much about your mom.” I *did* know that her dad was a controlling asshole, but kept that statement to myself.

”She was wonderful. I can still remember her hugs, her scent, how she never raised her voice. My dad could be... difficult, sometimes, but she never seemed to get frustrated with him, she never raised her voice. She was... perfect. Or, at least, my memory of her is.

“Anyway, after the accident, Dad and I muddled through for a time. I threw myself into school, into emulating my mom. Dad gave me structure—some would call it controlling, but it’s what I needed. Or thought I

needed? Or... whatever, I'm not sure. Going to college I just continued on in that vein."

I knew this part, too. I'd pieced bits together. She'd planned everything: school, career, probably finding a husband (me or her other ex, Will, someone safe). Her path was clear and clean, but didn't allow for deviations. Unfortunately for this early Morgan and her plan, life was all about deviations. I didn't need to be a high school history teacher to know that.

"When I came here, to London, it really was to just put something on my resume, to help get into med school. UCL is a really prestigious school, and I came here to *study*. Then you broke up with me before I even arrived."

"Temporary break." I scratched the now overheated back of my neck. "But yeah, that was dumb of me."

"It was unexpected, that was for sure. And honestly, at first, when I got here, I was pretty devastated. I liked you. A lot. Flaws and all. You were funny, but more than that, you didn't try to control me." She shook her head. "No, that's not quite right."

"I did try to control you?"

Morgan laughed. "No, not that, either. It was like... it wasn't even part of the equation. Most of the men in my life that I gravitated towards were... authoritative figures. My dad. My teachers—and no, don't even go there. Even the one guy that I dated in high school was kind of a jerk, in hindsight. But you... you were just you. Doing your own thing, and you let me do my own thing. And when you broke up... when you told me you wanted a 'temporary break' *just* before I left for London, it hurt."

"I was not great back then."

She ran her hand along my shirt front and looked up into my eyes. "You hadn't matured yet. Neither of us had."

“That’s true.” I held her eyes and asked, “So when do we get to the fun part of this story?”

Morgan laughed. “And you’re *still* maturing, I see.” She took a breath. “So you understand the context. When I came here. I was a little adrift.”

“And then you met Lorenzo and his super cock and alpha male attitude and were in love.”

“You going to let me tell this story?”

“Sorry, sorry.”

“You know, Babe,” Morgan glanced towards the stage, where the stripper had finally slipped out of her tight miniskirt, leaving her in nothing but a thong. “If this wild ride you and I have been on together has taught anything,” she turned those big brown eyes back to me, reached up, and affectionately cupped my jaw. “It’s that sometimes the build up is the best part.”

“What attracted me most to Lorenzo wasn’t any of that. When I first met him, I just rolled my eyes. I saw him the way you probably do: rich, entitled, cocky. Total *playa*.”

“Yup, just about.”

“But over time, hanging out with him and that group, I realized that... well... that while he *was* all of those things, he also just didn’t care. Like, he owned it. He wasn’t trying to be the perfect *anything* other than the perfect version of himself. And when I was around him, I didn’t feel the need to either.”

I knew some of this, too. Over the years, she’d shared parts of this perspective. But hearing it all so succinctly stated was like seeing her from an angle that I’d never seen before. “That makes sense now. With Lorenzo, you kind of... could explore a part of you that you’d always suppressed.”

”Yes, exactly.”

”And with me?”

She cast her eyes down, embarrassed. “I worried that you wouldn’t...”

”Approve?”

She continued to look down, grimaced.

“I’m not your dad. And you should know that I definitely approve. Look, Morgan...” I took her hands in mine. “I want you to be whoever you want to be with me. I want you to explore, if you want to explore. Yesterday, watching you with Tariq, was the single most intense, hottest moment of my life. And I have no regrets.”

Morgan nodded, taking it all in, internalizing. “I believe you. Okay.”

”You can tell me *anything*, Morg. I’m not going to judge. I want to know. I want to share that side of you.”

“Even if it involves things that I may not be entirely proud of doing?”

My heart hammered away. My cock surged. But I kept my answer measured. “If it was traumatic for you, and you don’t want to share it now, I understand. Did he... did Lorenzo ever do—”

”No, it wasn’t like that. He wasn’t abusive or anything. Things with us were always... consensual. He liked to tell me what to do, but he seemed to know just how much to push. No, it’s more like... I found myself *wanting* to do things that kind of shocked me in hindsight.”

“And you regret them?”

“Sometimes.”

“And other times?”

“It turns me on just thinking about it.”

I had a brief flash of Morgan, alone in bed, fingering herself as she thought about some experience she had here. It left me breathless. I waited, letting her gather her thoughts. Just watching now, I noticed all the little tells that pointed to arousal in my wife.

Her breathing went shallow. She shifted in her chair, squeezing her thighs together. It was hard to tell in the ambient red light, but I swear her cheeks were flushed.

“This happened at the end of our spring term. We’d just finished finals week. The program was technically over, although only a few people had gone home. It was like... like all the pressure was off. I miss those days of experiencing the start of summer break.”

“Only reason I teach,” I said.

“*That’s* not true. You love it.”

I did, but kept my mouth shut. I wasn’t going to derail wherever *this* story was going.

“Anyway, I got invited out with some of the students from my ethics class. Some pub over in Shoreditch. Totally casual thing, and no, Cassidy and crew weren’t there. It wasn’t their scene. Like at all.”

“No Lorenzo?”

“We’ll get there.” She grinned at my enthusiasm. “At first, though, it was just me, the other students, and Professor Whitmore.”

The way she said his name set off a fluttering in my stomach. This was new.

“That class was the hardest that I’d taken in all of college. Something about ethics and philosophy just didn’t click for me. And Whitmore didn’t tolerate bullshit. I worked *so* hard in his class.”

I thought about med school, about her struggles. Was this a precursor?

“I got an A, but it was hard. Made the A feel good, though.” She smiled at the memory of her own accomplishment. This was the Morgan that I knew so well, and loved so much. “At that little gathering, out of the class, he seemed different.”

He. Professor Whitmore. I liked where this was going.

“He was relaxed, drinking wine, telling funny stories about past semesters. I saw that there was more to him than just a hardass prof. He was just another man.”

“And you were attracted to him.”

Now she was definitely blushing. “Yeah. I know, it’s kind of messed up. He was, like, over twenty years older than me. He could have been my dad. But... yeah. I liked the gray in his stubble. He was very... English, but all of that was suddenly just so sexy.

“As the evening wore on and the wine flowed, I found myself gravitating towards him. It all felt so natural. I found myself flirting with him, and I couldn’t believe that I was doing it, but again... first day of summer vibes and all.”

It was almost impossible not to think back on her time with Dr. Mikael Koskinen, but all *that* did was stir up even more butterflies for me. I held my tongue.

“Then Lorenzo showed up, and everything changed.”

“WHAT ARE YOU DOING HERE?” I said.

“Good to see you, too, Mo.”

“I didn’t think you were in Professor Whitmore’s Ethics class.” Ethics wasn’t exactly a word in Lorenzo’s vocabulary. Yet here he was, looking unfairly hot in a pair of frayed designer jeans and a knit top that stretched taut over his muscular upper torso.

“Actually, the prof and I go way back,” Lorenzo said. “James did some consulting work for my dad.”

James. Such a casual way to refer to the man who’d made me rewrite my final paper twice.

“Your dad knows Professor Whitmore?” I tried to picture the stern, silver-haired Professor Whitmore in Lorenzo’s world of yachts and private jets. The images didn’t align.

Lorenzo just shrugged. To him, the details didn’t matter. What he was more focused on was—

“And you are into him.”

“No.” My answer was swift. I was immediately on my back foot.
“Don’t be jealous.”

“Me? I don’t get jealous. Just observant. And you... you want to fuck him.”

It wasn’t a question, but even so, I should have kept denying it. He was my professor. It was inappropriate. But the program *was* over, and there was something about being with Lorenzo that made me stop making excuses. When I looked at him, he just lifted his brows at me, as if to say, *You deny it?*

“Yes, I want to fuck him.”

“Then go get him.”

With permission granted, I sought out Professor Whitmore. We’d already been flirting, but he’d seen Lorenzo arrive and must have noticed our body language. We never advertised our relationship, but people could tell. I’m sure James—Professor Whitmore—suspected. So he was a little more guarded. At first, anyway.

“I wanted to tell you that your final paper was excellent. Genuinely excellent. I knew you struggled with it at first—”

”No thanks to you. I wrote it three times because you told me I was being too simplistic.”

“Because you were. But you got there.” He took a sip of wine, his eyes never leaving mine. “You’re stronger when you stop trying to find the ‘right’ answer. Philosophy is about getting comfortable with uncertainty.”

There was something about how he said it and how he was looking at me that gave me the impression that we weren’t just talking about philosophy.

“That can be challenging for me,” I said.

“Oh, I noticed. But I think you need to be challenged. It’s good for you. Not everything fits into a neat little box. You want to be a doctor. Lot of

uncertainty even there. Sometimes the answers aren't so obvious. Being... flexible can help you sort through all of that."

The air between us felt charged. I was hyperaware of how close we were standing, how his accent made even mundane words sound so sexy.

"You know, on the first day of class, I thought that I was going to have to fail you."

That was surprising to hear. "Me? What?"

"You are clearly a very intelligent young woman. You're driven, focused. Probably took my class to show diverse thinking for a med school application."

He wasn't wrong.

"But you came in with this rigid way of thinking. Everything was black and white. Right or wrong. And ethics..." He smiled slightly. "Ethics lives in the gray."

"And now?"

"Now I think you're starting to appreciate the gray." His eyes held mine. I glanced at his hair, threaded with gray, and smirked.

"You're right. I've come to appreciate a little gray."

He laughed. "You're not the same girl who walked into my classroom in January."

He was right. I wasn't. And standing there, feeling his attention on me like a physical thing, I realized I didn't need to be that girl. Not tonight. I glanced over at Lorenzo, who was talking to some girl, but focused on me.

James Whitmore followed my eyes. "Lorenzo seems like an interesting companion for exploring uncertainty."

"He is. You know him?"

"Oh yes. Not the kind of man I'd expect a brilliant American student to hang out with."

I preened at the compliment. "Weren't we just talking about gray areas, professor?"

“Lorenzo is one big gray area.”

“More like one big black area.” I couldn’t believe I said it, but here we were. I leaned in close as he grinned at me, close enough that no one could hear what I said next. “James? I can call you James, right?”

“We’re not in class anymore.”

“That’s a shame.” The words seemed to flow before I could even process them. “I’ve always wanted to have sex in a lecture hall.”

Even for a man who was expecting sex, Professor James Whitmore looked surprised. He quickly recovered, though, smoothing it over. “The University is all closed up at this hour. But you know what? I still have my key...”

“Well that’s... interesting.”

“Isn’t it?”

I glanced once again at Lorenzo. He’d dismissed his lady friend and was striding over to us. The man knew how to read a situation.

“Ready to go?” Lorenzo asked.

“I am. James just offered to give us a night tour of the lecture hall.”

Lorenzo looked at the older man, slapping him on the back. “What fun.”

The professor didn’t seem put off by this turn of events at all. He was clearly game, and it made me wonder if I wasn’t the first “brilliant American student” that he’d fucked. The image of this perfect, stern English professor fucking a pretty young coed shattered any remaining hesitancy that night.

James just looked at me, then at Lorenzo, and said, “Shall we?”

THE LECTURE HALL was dark except for the small lamp at the podium. I stood at the front of the room, staring up at the empty tiered seats rising

around me in the darkness. I stared at the chair that I always sat in—center-right, second row.

“This one?” Lorenzo asked, walking up to it.

The professor came up behind me, his arms moving around my waist. “That’s the one, every Tuesday and Thursday,” he said. “Always eager to prove herself.”

“That’s Mo,” Lorenzo agreed, plopping himself down in the lecture chair. He looked too big for the seat, reclined, legs splayed, one finger just below his lower lip. “Always seeking approval.”

“You know what I really thought about...” James asked, his voice low, yet in the same measured tone he employed to such powerful effect in his lectures. “...when you sat in the second row every Tuesday and Thursday? When you'd raise your hand with those thoughtful questions?”

“What?” I breathed.

“How badly I wanted to bend you over this desk and fuck the overthinking right out of you.”

In hindsight his declaration was so predictable, especially considering the circumstances. Still, this was my *professor*. Of *ethics*. And for whatever reason, that lit me up.

I turned in his arms to face him. Up close, in the dim light from the single lamp, I could see the silver in his hair, the lines around his eyes. He looked every bit the distinguished professor—except for the hunger in his expression.

Nothing “tweedy” or “respectable” in that.

“Then do it,” I said.

The man didn’t need to be told twice. He didn’t even bother looking in Lorenzo’s direction. He just wrapped his arms around me, pulled me against his surprisingly firm body, and kissed me. It was fucking crazy. Wild. When he broke it, I was breathless. I needed him.

I hadn't dressed particularly sexy for that night. It was supposed to be just a gathering with other students at a pub, not a night out. But my top was tight enough to draw James' eyes, and stretched when I lifted it up over my head.

"Fuck, you're sexy." The way he was staring at my black lacy bra, I could tell that he didn't see me as just the smart, striver, the authority pleaser, straight-A student anymore.

"It gets better," Lorenzo said from my former seat.

I reached back and unclasped my bra, letting it fall away. There's something so inexplicably sexy about being exposed before a man like James Whitmore—a man who'd once intimidated the hell out of me. Now he was staring at me, waiting for *me* to dictate what came next.

I savored the power in that as he breathed, "Christ."

The jeans went next. I eased them down my hips, along with my thong. No sense in putting it off much longer. Stepping out of the denim, I felt the cool air of the lecture hall on my skin, and even more arousing, the eyes of two men on my naked body.

"Beautiful." James' eyes trailed down my body. Was he surprised that I had a belly button piercing? Did he expect that this studious American was completely shaved bare?

From the second row, Lorenzo's voice cut through the moment. "The desk, James. You said you wanted to bend her over your desk."

James's eyes never left mine. "I did say that, didn't I?"

Even his accent, slightly Welsh, was fucking hot in a proper kind of way.

Things moved quickly after that. We kissed again as we maneuvered to the desk—same desk where he'd sat just last week, watching us as we completed our final exams. He bent me over the desk, a hand on the small of my back. "Look up," he said.

I did. All those empty seats like an audience all around us, and there in the second row, where I always sat, was Lorenzo, nodding his approval.

“Do you know how many times I imagined this?” James asked. I heard his belt buckle, the zipper. Felt his hands on my hips. “How many lectures I gave while thinking about bending you over and making you stop thinking so hard?”

He pushed me forward. The desk was cool against my tits. I felt the head of his cock pressing against me.

“Tell me you want this,” he said.

“I want this,” I breathed. “I want you to fuck me on your desk.”

He pushed inside, and I gasped at the stretch. Even more, though, I was getting off on how fucking transgressive this was. I was as turned on by where we were as I was by who I was fucking.

He started to move—slow at first, deliberate, letting me adjust, but it didn’t stay slow for long. His pace quickened, his fingers digging into my hips as he fucked me harder against his desk.

I braced my hands against the wood and met Lorenzo’s eyes. He nodded at me, his hands rubbing himself through his jeans. He watched us fuck for a bit, but unlike you, he wasn’t much of a voyeur. He rose and came down the aisle, pulling his shirt off. Then his pants. Then out came his cock.

Sitting up on the desk beside me, he stroked my hair, cock in hand, and said, “Open.”

I did, and he pushed into my mouth. I gagged as he hit the back of my throat, but he didn’t stop. His hand tightened in my hair, holding me in place as he pushed even deeper.

I relaxed my throat. I knew how to do this. Lo had trained me. I breathed through my nose and let him use my throat as James continued to fuck me from behind. The sensation of both of them—James’s thick cock stretching my pussy, Lorenzo’s massive one buried in my throat—was

overwhelming. I couldn't breathe properly, couldn't think, could only submit to it.

They found a rhythm, one pushing in as the other pulled back, and I was lost in it. The fullness, the intensity, the absolute wrongness of it all happening in Professor Whitmore's lecture hall.

"Look at her," James panted. "My hard-working student, taking both of us."

Lorenzo's grip tightened in my hair. "She's not so innocent after all, is she?"

I moaned around Lorenzo's cock, and he groaned in response. James's pace became more urgent, his breathing ragged.

"I'm close," he said.

"Pull out," Lorenzo ordered, and James obeyed, withdrawing from me. "I want her to finish you."

They switched positions—Lorenzo moving behind me, James coming around to the front. I barely had time to process before Lorenzo was sliding into me, filling me again, and James's cock was at my lips.

I could taste myself on him as I took him in my mouth, could feel the evidence of what we'd just done. It should have been degrading. Instead, it made me wetter.

Lorenzo fucked me hard—harder than James had—his hands bruising on my hips. And I sucked James with everything I had, desperate to make him come.

"That's it," James groaned, his hand gentle in my hair. "Just like that."

I felt him tense, felt his cock pulse, and then he was coming in my mouth. I swallowed, looking up at him as I did. That moment, staring up at Professor fucking Whitman as he filled my mouth with his come, set me off, too.

But not Lorenzo. Lorenzo was a man of stamina.

James stepped back, catching his breath, watching as Lorenzo pulled out of me. Those dark hands gripped my hips and flipped me over on the desk so I was on my back, legs dangling off the edge.

“Watch this,” Lorenzo said to James, spreading my thighs wide.

I was completely exposed now—laid out on Professor Whitmore's desk like an offering, my pussy still wet and swollen from being fucked. Lorenzo stood between my legs, his massive cock in his hand, and slapped it against me. Once. Twice. He knew what he was doing, and I was gasping at the tease.

Then he pushed inside. I cried out. From this angle, I could see everything—see him filling me, see James watching with hungry eyes, see those empty seats rising into darkness above us.

“Look at her take it.”

And I *took* it. We put on a show—hard and fast and loud. Lorenzo could fuck, and we did it right there in front of my professor, my cries echoing off the tiered seats. James couldn't look away, his hand already moving to his cock, stroking himself as he watched.

It was me who reached out to him, grabbed his wrist, pulled him closer. I needed his cock in my mouth again, needed to taste him while Lorenzo pounded into me.

James stepped forward, and I took him between my lips, sucking him as Lorenzo fucked me harder. The desk shook beneath me with each thrust. I was lost in it. In the fullness. In the wrongness. In the absolute perfection of being used by both of them in this place where I'd tried so hard to be good.

Lorenzo's pace became relentless, his huge cock driving into me as I worked James with my mouth. I could feel another orgasm building, could feel myself getting close.

“She's going to come again.” Lorenzo knew me, anticipated me, his hands gripping my thighs, spreading me wider.

He was right. It was too much. All of it, all around us. The circumstance. The people. My brain was short-circuiting. I came hard, my body arching off the desk, a muffled cry around James's cock.

“Fuck, yes,” Lorenzo groaned. He was close, too. I knew him just as well.

“Uhh! Uhh! Do it, baby! Come inside me!”

Lorenzo drove deep one final time and came with a shout, his cock pulsing inside me as he filled me. The sensation of it, the heat of him, pushed me into another smaller wave of pleasure.

James pulled from my mouth, stroking himself fast. “Where?” he gasped.

“Wherever you want,” I breathed.

His hand was a blur as he finished himself off, exploding across my tits and face, his release hot on my skin. When he was done, he stepped back, looking at me laid out on his desk—fucked, used, covered in come.

“Now that’s what I call embracing uncertainty.”

“HE DID *NOT* SAY THAT.” I just stared at her, my breathing hard, my dick even harder.

Morgan blinked, coming back into the present and seeing me there, listening. She laughed. “Well, I don’t know. Something cheesy like that. But it was over. Done. I cleaned up and left after that.”

“Did you ever do it with him again?”

“Never saw him again. Honestly, I was a little nervous that we’d run into him when we walked around campus the other day. That could have been awkward.”

“Or hot?”

Morgan laughed and shook her head. “No, definitely awkward.” We sat with each other, the aftermath of the story still lingering in the air between us. Dancers had come by to see if we wanted another dance, but left when they realized that we were having a moment. At last, Morgan said, “You know I’m not that girl anymore, right?”

I glanced over at her, seeing the tension in her now. I may have come to terms with her wild past, but Morgan was still struggling with it.

“I do know. But I also know you’re not *not* her.”

“That’s a double negative,” she pointed out.

“What I mean is that when you came here the first time and you let loose, you did it for yourself, not someone else. I don’t think I realized that until now. Lorenzo was just the catalyst.”

“You’re right, I did.”

“And when you came home, you couldn’t just go back to the girl you were, although I think that you tried. Maybe sometimes still are trying. And to be clear here, while your stories are, like, some of the hottest things I’ve ever heard, they don’t diminish the amazing, smart, successful woman that’s sitting here with me now.”

Her eyes started to water as she smiled. “Oh, Nathan, you’re going to make me cry.”

“I’m only speaking the truth.”

“Well, you’re pretty amazing yourself,” she said. She looked around, checked her watch, then jumped. “Oh, wow, we need to head back. I didn’t realize how much time had passed.”

“That *was* quite a story.”

She was already packing up her things, though, signaling to the server to bring the check. “Hopefully we hit the ferry in time. We *can’t* be late for Prithya’s thing. It’s like the whole reason we came here.”

It was one of the reasons, I didn’t say. Or maybe it was an excuse. Either way, this trip had been one of the most eye-opening and educational

experiences that I've ever shared with Morgan.
And it wasn't over yet.

We got back to Prithya's in time to get ready. Prithya had to go to the Royal Albert Hall early, so the plan was for us to head in with Tariq. I changed into a suit that I'd brought along and Morgan shooed me out of the room so she could get prepared.

Tariq was already in his tuxedo, looking sharp as he adjusted his bow tie in the hallway mirror. He caught my reflection and grinned.

"Looking good, mate," he said.

"Thanks. You too."

The silence that followed was thick. I busied myself with my cufflinks, hyper-aware that this man had been inside my wife less than twenty-four hours ago. That I'd watched it happen. That I'd wanted it to happen.

Tariq seemed completely at ease, which somehow made it worse. Or better. I wasn't sure.

"Drink?" he offered, moving to the bar cart.

"Yeah. Thanks."

He poured two whiskeys and handed me one. We both sipped, the awkwardness stretching between us. What was the protocol here? Did we talk about it? Pretend it didn't happen? Make small talk about the weather?

"Prithya's pretty excited about tonight," Tariq said finally, mercifully choosing neutral territory.

“I bet. The Royal Albert Hall is incredible.”

“She’s excited about that, too,” he said with a wink.

Before I could ask about that, the door finally opened and out stepped Morgan.

From the front, the dress was simple and elegant. The neckline scooped just low enough to hint at cleavage, but was otherwise a simple design, the sleek black material fastening behind her neck. It was when she turned slightly to close the door that my jaw fell open. The dress had no back. None. It was cut so low that it nearly reached the curve of her ass. The sides were cut high, too, showing off her side boob when she moved.

“Wow,” I managed.

“Too much?” A flush had crept across her cheeks. She tucked a strand of hair—down and in loose waves—over one ear. Her nervous gesture, but one that showed off her sparkly, dangling earrings.

“No, definitely not too much,” I said. “Morgan, you look...”

“Fucking stunning,” Tariq finished for me.

Morgan glanced at him, then back at me. I saw the flash of something in her expression. She was pleased. She was excited to receive the compliment from him. From her *other lover*.

“Prithya helped me pick it out,” she said.

“Prithya has excellent taste,” Tariq said, his eyes traveling slowly down Morgan’s body.

I should have felt jealous. Territorial. Instead, I said, “I’ll... uh... order us an Uber.”

Morgan sat between us in the back seat of the car as we drove through the London streets. Night had fallen and the world was a blur of lights and nervous energy. I kept looking over at her, seeing how her makeup sparkled in the low light. Seeing Tariq staring at her and half-expecting that he’d have his hand resting on her thigh.

It never was. The man was enough of a gentleman like that, but I could tell that he wanted to.

From the outside the Royal Albert Hall was breathtaking. The iconic circular building lit up against the night sky with crowds of well-dressed patrons streaming through the entrance. Morgan squeezed my hand as we walked in, her eyes wide.

“This is incredible,” she whispered.

“So cool that she’s playing here.”

The interior was all Victorian grandeur. Red velvet and gold trim were everywhere. The massive domed ceiling soared overhead. Our seats were in the orchestra section, right there on the floor, close enough that we could see the musicians’ faces.

The lights dimmed. The members of the orchestra filed onto the stage. We saw Prithya, second violin, looking stunning herself in a long black dress, her black hair up. She looked out, but couldn’t see us through the lights and the sea of people.

The conductor took her position, the concert master warmed everyone up, and then the music began.

I’m not going to pretend I understood all the technical aspects of what we were hearing. I knew very little about music. I was a history teacher, after all, and classical music was never my thing. But I knew when something *sounded* good, and they sounded better than that.

The orchestra moved as one, the sound filling every corner of that vast space.

I watched Prithya, the elegant way she bowed, how into the music she was. She moved in her chair to the swells, she closed her eyes in the quiet moments and let the music flow through her.

I found Ophelia there as well, surprised that she was First Chair of the cellos. Although maybe I shouldn’t have been. She was like the version of Morgan who threw herself into music rather than medicine, and seemed to

excel at whatever she put her mind to: singing, playing bass, writing music, and now, apparently, playing cello.

They finished with an emotional piece that left the entire hall silent for one pregnant moment. Then, the applause was thunderous.

“That was incredible,” Morgan said, turning to me with shining eyes. “Just... incredible.”

“Not bad, yeah?” Tariq said with obvious pride.

“Get out of here, man,” Morgan teased, elbowing him. “You know that was way better than just pretty good.”

We headed to the reception after that, held in one of the Hall’s ornate bars, tucked away behind the main auditorium. The space was smaller than I’d expected, more intimate. More exclusive. So funny how different this was from the pub in Camden Town a few nights back, and *definitely* different from that after party.

Here, the dingy house was instead paneled in dark wood, gilt-framed mirrors, glowing chandeliers. The bar wasn’t a kitchen counter top but a marble-topped affair, lined with bottles of champagne already open and breathing.

The room buzzed with energy, laughter echoing off the high ceilings. Somewhere, a string quartet played softly, and I wondered how that small group felt, following up from the performance we’d just heard.

Waiters in crisp white shirts circulated with trays of champagne and canapés. I snagged three flutes as one passed, handing them to Morgan and Tariq.

“To Prithya,” Morgan said, raising her glass.

We clinked and drank.

An older gentleman in a perfectly tailored suit approached Morgan, his face warm with admiration. “Excuse me, but I have to say—you were absolutely masterful up there. That Dvořák movement, particularly. Just beautiful.”

Morgan blinked, confused. “Oh, I—”

“The vibrato in the third movement,” he continued, not hearing her. “Exquisite. You must be very proud.”

“I think you have me confused with someone else,” Morgan said with a smile.

The man looked more closely, then laughed, embarrassed. “Oh my goodness, I’m so sorry. I thought you were—there’s a young woman in the orchestra, the cellist—”

“Ophelia,” Tariq supplied, grinning.

“Yes! You must be sisters.”

“Sure,” Morgan said, giving the man an out.

“Well, please pass along my compliments.” He inclined his head and excused himself.

Morgan turned to me, eyes wide. “Do I really look that much like her?”

“I mean, kind of, yeah.”

“Sisters,” Tariq agreed with a smirk.

“Huh.” Morgan sipped her champagne, processing this.

“There she is,” Tariq said, nodding toward the entrance.

Prithya emerged from a side door, still in her concert black, her face bright with post-performance adrenaline. She was immediately swept up by a small crowd of well-wishers—older patrons, probably donors, judging by their expensive jewelry and the way they commanded space.

She caught Tariq’s eye across the room and her smile widened. She held up a finger—one minute—and turned back to the conversation she was trapped in.

Ophelia appeared a few minutes later, weaving through the crowd in her concert black. Her hair was held back in a curly ponytail, and with the formal dress and elegant setting, the resemblance to Morgan was even more pronounced than it had been at the pub.

“There's my girl,” Tariq said, pulling her into a hug when she reached us. “Absolutely fucking brilliant tonight.”

“Thanks,” Ophelia said, beaming. She looked at Morgan and me. There was a moment of awkwardness there—she *had* kissed me, after all—but she moved past it quickly. “Glad you could make it. What did you think?”

“Incredible,” Morgan said. “Seriously, you were amazing.”

“Thanks.” Ophelia seemed a little reserved around Morgan, a flicker of something in her eyes as they looked at one another.

“No, really,” Morgan insisted. “That Dvořák movement was simply masterful,” she said. “And the vibrato in the third movement... exquisite.”

Ophelia blinked at Morgan. “I didn't know you were so knowledgeable.”

Morgan laughed. “Some guy thought that I was you. I'm just passing on the compliments.”

“Oh.” Ophelia laughed. “Well, thank you. Or thank him.”

The tension broke after that. A waiter passed with champagne. We all took fresh glasses. Tariq broke it further by raising his glass and saying, “To the Royal fucking Albert Hall.”

Somehow, cursing in this uptight venue felt freeing. “To the Royal fucking Albert Hall,” we echoed.

The champagne was crisp. The conversation flowed. Ophelia told us about how the second chair of the second violins forgot his bow and they had to scramble.

Prithya finally extracted herself from the donor circle and practically bounded over to us, her face flushed with excitement and champagne.

“Sorry, sorry! God, they would not stop talking.” She threw her arms around Ophelia. “We did it! We actually did it!”

“We *fucking* did it,” Ophelia agreed, hugging her back.

When they pulled apart, Prithya grabbed Morgan next. “Thank you for coming. Thank you, thank you. It means *so* much to me. You have no idea.”

“Are you kidding? We wouldn't have missed this for anything,” Morgan said.

Tariq had his arm around Prithya now, kissing her temple. “I’m so proud of you.”

“We should celebrate properly,” Ophelia said. She looked at the crowd around us—the donors, the patrons in their expensive clothes, the overly formal atmosphere. “Somewhere that's not here.”

“Yes,” Prithya said immediately. “God, yes. Tonight was amazing. It’s actually been a dream to play here. But now I’m ready to go.”

“Back to yours?” Ophelia asked Tariq.

He glanced at Morgan and me, something unspoken passing between us. “Yeah. Back to ours.”

We made it back to the Clerkenwell flat in no time, and before we knew it, we were all sitting in Prithya's living room, still in our formal wear, opening a bottle of whiskey.

"God, this feels like post-prom," I said, looking around at our gathering.

"Not *my* post-prom," Morgan said. "I'm pretty sure that I was home by eleven, watching SNL and eating a bowl of ice cream and trying to forget how Alex Gucciano tried to kiss me at the front door. In front of *Dad*."

"The Gooch," Prithya said with a laugh. "I remember him."

I sometimes forget that Prithya knew Morgan back in high school. "You didn't like him?" I asked.

Prithya answered for her. "They were just friends. Morgan was just friends with almost everyone, although they all had crushes on her. She was too busy trying to beat me in grades."

"I was very clear to Alex that we were going to prom just as friends," Morgan said defensively.

Prithya kicked off her heels and curled up on the sofa beside Tariq. "God, that feels good. I love performing, but performing in heels is like hell."

"You performing in heels is one of my favorite things," Tariq said. Prithya shook her head at him, but was laughing.

I sat in the armchair while Morgan took the other end of the couch beside Tariq. The conversation flowed. We rehashed moments of the performance, the audience reaction, all the hours that they'd poured into rehearsals. Prithya wondered what it would be like now that it was over and things would return to normal.

Ophelia seemed more interested in me and Morgan. At some point, she took a sip of her whiskey, looked over at Morgan, and said, "So, we going to talk about the other night? At the party?"

The room went quiet for a beat. "What do you want to talk about?" Morgan asked.

"How you went into the back with Dylan that night."

"Oh, that." Morgan didn't look away from Ophelia. Instead, she smiled and said, "Nothing happened." She looked over at Tariq. "Nothing happened with *Dylan*."

Ophelia's eyes widened. Her mouth fell open. "OMG, really?"

Morgan just sipped her champagne, the smile still there.

"No fucking way." She looked at Prithya and Tariq.

It was Tariq, of course, who responded. "Oh, we fucked in a lot of ways."

Ophelia's head swiveled around the room, apparently realizing that she was the last person to understand the true dynamic of this gathering. She looked at me. "And you're okay with this?"

All eyes turned to me. I felt my face heat up as I nodded. "Yeah. I am."

"You were there?" Ophelia asked, picking up on something in my tone.

"Yeah."

Her grin widened. "You watched."

It wasn't a question. I took a drink of the whiskey instead of answering, which was answer enough.

"Holy shit." She turned to Prithya. "And you?"

"I was at rehearsal."

“And missed out on all the fun. Well, that’s a pisser.” Ophelia was smiling. To Morgan and me, she said, “So you’re, like, open? Like these two?”

“It’s more like...” Morgan paused, choosing her words. “Nathan likes watching me with other people.”

Fuck, that was hot to hear her say. It was true. I’d had the fantasy for so long. But to hear my wife, Morgan, actually acknowledge it was so erotic.

“A hotwife thing,” Prithya added.

“Yeah,” Morgan said. “A hotwife thing.”

My chest tightened. My pants were even tighter.

Ophelia’s eyes sparkled. She looked at me. “Does he only like to see you with men?”

The question hung in the air. Morgan glanced at me, and I could see the question in her eyes, too.

“Umm... not just men, no,” I said.

Ophelia’s smile turned knowing. “Interesting.” She looked at Morgan. “Have you been with women? Since doing this?”

“No, not with women,” Morgan said. “Not since we started doing this, anyway.”

“I love that answer.” She reached out and put a hand on Morgan’s knee. Morgan’s breathing had changed, gotten slightly shallower. My heart was pounding. The air felt so thick. “You know they say we look like sisters, right?”

Morgan seemed to find herself, slowly smiling. “Twins, I’m told.”

“Tariq has this fantasy,” Prithya said casually. Her own hand was resting on her boyfriend’s thigh. “About twins. Haven’t you, babe?”

Tariq’s eyes moved between Morgan and Ophelia. “I have.”

“And here we are,” Ophelia said, gesturing between herself and Morgan. “Twins.”

“Not actual twins.”

“Close enough.” Ophelia looked at me. “What do you think, Nathan? Do we look enough alike?”

My mouth was dry. “Yeah. Definitely.”

“Want to see two sisters kiss?” Ophelia asked.

I didn’t trust myself to speak, so I just nodded.

And then, amazingly, Morgan and Ophelia tilted their heads, closed their eyes, and kissed. Right in front of all of us.

The kiss started tentatively, almost chaste. But then Ophelia’s hand came up to cup the back of Morgan’s neck, and Morgan made a soft sound—half gasp, half moan—and suddenly things grew more intense. Their mouths opened, tongues visible for just a moment before they pressed closer together.

I watched as my wife’s kiss with another woman deepened, their bodies angling toward each other on the couch, Ophelia’s other hand still on Morgan’s knee, sliding higher now.

Beside them, Prithya’s hand moved from Tariq’s thigh to between his legs. She rubbed him slowly through his tuxedo trousers, watching Morgan and Ophelia. I could see the outline of him getting hard under her palm.

Watching another man watch Morgan and Ophelia was almost as intense as the girl-on-girl show. Almost.

Morgan’s hand found Ophelia’s waist, fingers splaying against the black fabric of her concert dress. When they finally broke apart, both women were flushed, breathing hard.

“Fuck,” Ophelia whispered.

“Yeah,” Morgan agreed.

Ophelia looked down at Morgan’s dress—that elegant black number, nearly backless, her body so accessible. She slipped a hand into the side, right over Morgan’s right breast. Morgan’s breath caught.

“This okay?” Ophelia asked.

Morgan nodded, biting her lip. She glanced at me and smiled. I managed a smile in return. And in that moment it was just the two of us, together, stepping off happily into the next stage of this ever-evolving adventure. She didn't break the contact, continuing to smile at me for a beat longer as she answered. "Yes."

Prithya had unzipped Tariq's trousers now, her hand inside, stroking him. He groaned softly, his eyes never leaving Morgan and Ophelia.

The women kissed again, Morgan's hands in Ophelia's hair now, less tentative.

I was rock hard, my hand reflexively moving to adjust myself through my pants.

Tariq noticed. "You good, mate?" His voice was rough.

"Yeah," I managed. "Really good."

Prithya looked over at me, still stroking Tariq. "Touch yourself if you want," she said. "I know I want to."

Ophelia had unclasped Morgan's dress, exposing her breasts. She leaned down and took one into her mouth as Morgan cooed, eyes closed.

I unzipped my pants, my hand finding my cock. The relief of finally touching myself was immediate. I stroked slowly, not wanting to finish too quickly, just needing some release from the pressure building inside me.

Prithya noticed, glancing down at my lap, and she smiled. Then she turned to Tariq, leaning close to whisper something in his ear. He nodded.

"Go join them," she said louder, giving him a gentle push. "I know you want to."

Tariq stood, already loosening his bow tie, and crossed to where Morgan and Ophelia were tangled together on the couch. Morgan's dress hung open, her breasts exposed, Ophelia's mouth still working on one nipple.

"Ladies," Tariq said, his voice low and commanding. "Let's get these dresses off, yeah?"

Ophelia pulled back from Morgan's breast, grinning up at him. "About time you joined us."

Morgan's eyes were glassy, drunk on more than just the whiskey. She nodded, letting Tariq help her stand. The dress fell away easily, pooling at her feet, leaving her in just a tiny black thong.

Ophelia stood too, reaching behind herself to unzip her own concert dress. It slid down her body, revealing her completely naked

"Of course you went commando on the biggest night of your life," Prithya said.

I barely heard her. I was staring at Morgan's doppelgänger. The resemblance really was uncanny—same lean, athletic build, same perky breasts, even the swell of her hips and butt were the same as Morgan's. But then there were differences, too, like seeing an alternate reality version of my wife.

Where Morgan was mostly pale in the winter, Ophelia had distinct tan lines from a bikini— a thong bikini at that, evidenced by the pale skin plunging between her buttocks. She had tattoos as well, a musical motif along her right shoulder, and another in the small of her back.

When she turned, I caught the flash of metal, not just from her belly bar, but also from the hoops in her nipples and the matching one that pierced the hood of her clit. She was otherwise shaved bare, just like Morgan used to be.

"Fuck," I breathed, my hand moving faster on my cock. I wasn't a huge fan of piercings—other than the one Morgan had in her navel. But seeing her like this felt like glimpsing something I wasn't supposed to see, which only made me want to see more.

Tariq was naked, too, his cock jutting out, hard and ready. He idly stroked it as he sat on the sofa again and patted the spots on either side of him.

Morgan and Ophelia took the hint, curling on either side of him. He put a hand on the back of each of their heads—the exact same gesture that I’d watched him do at the house party. Only now, there were a lot fewer articles of clothing on, and my wife was one of the women.

He guided their heads together. “Kiss,” he said simply.

They did, leaning across Tariq—two nearly identical women, their mouths locked together, hands exploring each other's bodies. When I saw Morgan move to wrap hers around Tariq’s erection, my own jumped.

“That’s so wild looking,” Prithya said, her voice breathy with arousal.

I tore my eyes away from the scene on the couch to look at her. She’d stripped out of her dress while I’d been transfixed. She stood there in just a black thong, garter belt, and stockings—her bra already discarded somewhere. Her fuller breasts were bare, dark nipples hard, and she was touching herself through the thin fabric of her underwear.

“They really do look like twins,” she continued, watching Morgan and Ophelia kissing over Tariq’s lap. “It’s fucking hot.”

I nodded, unable to form words. My hand was still moving on my cock, my attention split between the three of them on the couch and Prithya on the loveseat to my left.

The women broke their kiss. Morgan looked up at Tariq, then down at his cock in her hand. Without hesitation, she lowered her head, taking him into her mouth.

I watched my wife’s lips stretch around another man’s cock, watched her head bob as she sucked him. Ophelia watched for a moment, then leaned down to join her, her tongue finding Tariq’s balls, licking and sucking while Morgan worked his shaft.

Tariq groaned, his hand finding Morgan’s hair. “Fuck, that’s good. Both of you.”

It was so fucking hot: two nearly identical women servicing him together, their brunette heads moving in tandem.

On the loveseat, Prithya's fingers were moving fast beneath her thong. She squeezed her tit with her left hand, watching the threesome on the couch.

"Is it everything you dreamed about, baby?" she asked him.

"Almost." He guided Morgan back up to him and kissed her. To Ophelia, he said, "I want to see you eat her out."

Ophelia grinned, pulling back. "Yes, sir."

Morgan's breath caught as Tariq repositioned her, guiding her to lie back on the couch. Ophelia knelt between Morgan's legs, hooking her fingers into Morgan's thong and sliding it down slowly.

I couldn't breathe. My wife was about to be eaten out by another woman while I watched. While Tariq watched.

Ophelia tossed the thong aside and spread Morgan's legs wider. "Cute landing strip," she said, running her finger through Morgan's folds. "And look how wet you are."

Morgan whimpered, her hips lifting.

"Please," Morgan breathed.

Ophelia didn't make her wait. She lowered her head and put her mouth on my wife.

Prithya and I looked at each other. She lowered her eyes to my cock, hard in my hand, and asked, "Can I?"

My breath caught. I looked across the room at Morgan, lost in the dance of Ophelia's mouth and fingers. I wasn't sure if she'd even heard the question. I wasn't sure if she remembered I was there at all.

But I also remembered that conversation. *I don't like the idea of another woman sucking your cock.* Her one boundary in all of this.

"I... I can't. Morgan doesn't—"

"Say no more," Prithya said immediately. There was no judgment in her voice, just understanding. "I get it. Everyone has their lines."

Then I realized that Morgan *was* looking at me. I saw gratitude there, even in the middle of all this wildness. I nodded at her. *We're good.*

She smiled, then gasped as Ophelia flicked her tongue along Morgan's clit.

Tariq knelt on the couch beside Morgan's head, his cock level with her face. "Open," he said softly.

Morgan turned her head, her lips parting, and took him in, her hand coming up to grip his thigh as Ophelia worked between her legs.

The sounds Morgan was making—muffled around Tariq's cock, desperate and needy—went straight through me. My hand moved faster on myself.

Tariq groaned, one hand tangling in Morgan's hair, guiding her.

Ophelia came up for air, her chin glistening. "She tastes amazing," she said, grinning. Then she dove back down, and Morgan's whole body tensed.

Prithya fingered herself faster, gasping. "God, look at her," she breathed. "Your wife is so fucking hot."

She was. Laid out on the couch, Tariq's cock in her mouth, Ophelia between her legs—Morgan looked completely lost in sensation. Her eyes were closed, her free hand gripping the couch cushion.

Tariq pulled out of her mouth. "Switch," he said to Ophelia. "I want to fuck her while you let her taste you."

Ophelia stood, wiping her mouth with the back of her hand. "Yes, sir," she said with a playful smirk.

They repositioned—Ophelia straddling Morgan's face, Tariq moving between Morgan's legs. He was about to push inside when Morgan's hand came up to his chest.

"Condom," she said, slightly breathless.

"Right." Tariq reached over to the coffee table where someone—probably Prithya—had thoughtfully placed a few. He tore one open, rolled it on quickly.

Morgan watched, then nodded, spreading her legs wider.

He pushed inside my wife.

Morgan's moan was muffled by Ophelia's pussy as Tariq filled her. I watched his hips start to move, slow and deep at first, then building to a steady rhythm.

Ophelia's hands were in Morgan's hair, grinding down against her mouth. "Fuck, yes, just like that," she breathed. "Your tongue—oh god—"

Morgan's hands gripped Ophelia's thighs, holding her in place as she worked. I couldn't see exactly what Morgan was doing, but I could see the effect—Ophelia's back arching, her breasts bouncing as she rocked against Morgan's face.

Tariq's pace increased, his hands gripping Morgan's hips, pulling her onto him with each thrust. The couch creaked beneath them.

"She's so fucking tight," Tariq groaned.

Prithya's breathing had gotten heavier beside me. Her fingers moved faster between her legs. "Come on, Lia," she urged. "Let her make you come."

Ophelia's whole body was trembling now. "I'm close," she gasped. "I'm so close—Morgan, don't stop—"

Morgan didn't stop. If anything, she became more focused, more determined. Her hands tightened on Ophelia's thighs.

"Oh fuck, oh fuck, oh—" Ophelia's words dissolved into a cry as her orgasm hit. Her body went rigid, shaking, and then she collapsed forward, catching herself on the back of the couch, panting.

Morgan gasped for air as Ophelia lifted off her face. Her lips were wet, glazed with pleasure as Tariq continued to fuck her.

"Good girl," Tariq said. "Such a good girl."

Ophelia rolled off to the side, still catching her breath. Prithya couldn't stay still any longer. She stood from the loveseat and crossed to the couch.

She leaned in and kissed Tariq first, dragging him to her mouth and pushing her tongue deep. He groaned into her mouth, never breaking his rhythm inside Morgan.

When they broke apart, Tariq looked down at Morgan, then back at Prithya. “Kiss her,” he said. It wasn’t a suggestion.

Prithya’s eyes met Morgan’s. There was a question there—permission being asked between best friends.

Morgan nodded, breathless.

Prithya leaned down and kissed Morgan. It was different from watching Morgan kiss Ophelia—this was her best friend, someone she’d known since high school.

Morgan’s hand came up to cup Prithya's face, holding her there as they kissed. Tariq watched, still moving inside Morgan, his pace slowing to let them have this moment.

I couldn’t take my eyes off them. Morgan kissing Prithya while Tariq fucked her. My hand moved faster on my cock. My balls began to tighten.

This was my wife, now she was naked on a couch in London, being fucked by another man while kissing her best friend, having just made a different woman come with her mouth.

“You okay over there?” Ophelia asked from where she’d collapsed on the other end of the couch.

“Yeah,” I said.

Prithya pulled back from kissing Morgan, her hand trailing down to cup Morgan's breast. Morgan’s eyes found mine across the room, and even lost in pleasure, even with Tariq inside her, she was checking in with me.

I nodded. Smiled. Tried to convey everything I was feeling—the love, the lust, the gratitude that she was willing to do this with me. For me. For us.

She smiled back, then gasped as Tariq changed his angle, hitting something deep inside her.

“I’m close,” I heard myself say, almost surprised by my own voice.

“Come for us,” Prithya said, looking over at me. “Come watching your wife.”

Tariq’s pace increased, harder now, more urgent. “I’m close too,” he grunted. Prithya reached down between Morgan’s legs, her fingers finding her clit.

Morgan’s back arched. “Don’t stop,” she begged. “Please don’t—”

Morgan’s whole body tensed, her hands gripping Prithya’s arm, the couch cushion, anything she could hold onto. “I’m—oh god, I’m—”

“That’s it.” Tariq was fucking fast, slapping skin filling the room. “Come for me.”

Morgan cried out, her orgasm ripped through her. I could see it in every muscle, the way her legs shook, the way her mouth fell open.

Tariq thrust deep one more time and held there, his own climax hitting. “Fuck,” he breathed.

That did it. My orgasm hit hard. I came all over my hand, my stomach, my Oxford shirt.

For a moment, the room was silent except for heavy breathing.

Then Ophelia laughed, breaking the tension. “Well,” she said. “That was fucking incredible.”

Tariq pulled out carefully, disposing of the condom. Morgan lay there, her chest rising and falling rapidly, her body completely limp. Prithya stroked her hair gently.

Morgan’s eyes found mine again. “Nathan,” she said softly.

“I’m here,” I said. Or tried to say. My voice came out like a croak.

She reached out a hand for me. “Come here.”

I stood on shaky legs and crossed to her. She ran her hand up behind my head, along the back of my neck, and pulled me down for a kiss. Her lips were soft and tasted like Ophelia and whiskey and something uniquely Morgan.

“I love you,” she whispered against my mouth.

“I love you too,” I said.

We stayed like that for a moment, Morgan and me, foreheads pressed together, her hand on my cheek.

“You two need some time,” Prithya said gently. She was already helping Morgan sit up, grabbing a throw blanket from the back of the couch to wrap around her friend’s shoulders.

Morgan looked up at her gratefully. “Yeah. We do.”

Tariq didn’t bother getting dressed, his dick swinging free. Ophelia didn’t, either.

“We’ll be in our room,” Prithya said. She glanced at Ophelia. “All of us.”

Ophelia grinned. “Round two, then?”

“Hey, I need to get fucked!” Prithya said.

We all laughed. I helped Morgan stand, her legs still a bit shaky. She clutched the blanket around herself as we made our way down the hallway. Behind us, I heard quiet laughter, the sound of the three of them heading to the master bedroom.

I closed the door, and suddenly it was just us. Just Morgan and me and the small lamp by the side of our double bed.

She let the blanket fall, standing there naked in the dim light. “Hi,” she said softly.

“Hi,” I said back.

“That was—”

“Incredible,” I finished.

She smiled. “Yeah. Incredible.” She stepped closer, her hands going to my come-stained shirt. “But now I need *you*.”

We fell into bed together, all the messiness of the night washed away in the feel of her skin on mine, my cock buried inside of her. I could feel her

stretched again, could smell not just Tariq on her, but Ophelia and Prithya, but underneath it all, it was Morgan.

“I needed that,” she said after I finally managed to come. “I will *always* need that.”

“You looked pretty satisfied with the other three.”

Morgan didn’t laugh it off. She didn’t dismiss it. But she did stare at me thoughtfully, finally shaking her head. “Satisfied, yes, but not complete. You make me feel complete.”

“How sentimental of you,” I said.

“I’m being serious, Babe.”

“I know. But you didn’t have me before.”

“And things are different now. You... you ground me. And that makes everything else, all the wild sex, even better. Because I get to share it with you. This... reclamation sex... it’s not really for you, you know. Selfishly, it’s for me. It reminds me of what matters most.”

I kissed her softly. “Well, good. Because selfishly? I’m pretty into the reclamation sex, too.”

She giggled. “Of course you are.”

And with that, we drifted off to sleep.

The final full day of our trip and I was the first one to wake up for a change. Morgan was asleep at my side, breathing steadily. When I got up to use the bathroom in the hall, no one was up yet to make coffee or tea despite being a little after 8.

Did that mean that I was finally acclimated to this world? To this lifestyle?

“You’re being dramatic,” I said to myself. If a student had written that conclusion in a paper, I would have marked it as a logical fallacy.

But I *was* in a different place than I had been when we arrived. This fantasy had grown in me from the moment that she left for London the first time. It had evolved. It had outright changed over the years.

Now it was no longer just a fantasy. I’d watched Morgan fuck another man twice now, right before my eyes. I’d watched her suck his cock of her own desire—not for me, not for us, but for herself. It was intense and erotic and I wasn’t ready for it to end.

On vacation, we do all kinds of things that we wouldn’t normally do. We buy things we wouldn’t normally buy. We try new foods that we wouldn’t try back home. We open ourselves to experiences that are new just to try them. That’s what Morgan had chosen to do when she decided to study abroad. That’s what we’d done here.

When we went home tomorrow, did we just pack all of these experiences away, to one day look back on when we were grandparents in some nursing home thinking back on our more glorious days? As the Brits would say, is this a one-off?

“You’re up.” It was Ophelia slipping out of the master bedroom, her British accent incongruous with her resemblance to Morgan. “Your girl still sleeping?”

“Yeah.”

Ophelia wore a pair of black leggings and a hoodie, her hair gathered into a ponytail. She closed the distance, and with her makeup completely scrubbed, she looked less like Morgan than she had last night. Which made me keenly aware that this was a different woman, beautiful and confident, sauntering up to me.

“You two never rejoined.” She was close enough to reach out and touch my chest. “I was hoping that the two of you had a little chat so you could come back in and fuck me.”

“I...” I didn’t know what to say to that.

“Prithya had to get out her strapon, which was fun in its own way, but I do enjoy a real cock... or two.”

She was staring at my mouth like she was going to kiss it. In the end, though, she glanced up at me, smiled, and stepped away. “It was nice meeting you, Nathan. Tell Morgan that I’m always up for a repeat of the sister act if she’s ever in town. Your girl knows how to lick a pussy.”

Jesus, this woman.

“I... um... will.”

“Liar.” With a good natured laugh, she turned, retrieved her coat by the front door, and was gone.

The others emerged by the time I had the coffee brewing. Prithya was first, wearing a robe over a pair of loose PJ pants and a band t-shirt.

“Coffee. Brilliant,” were the first two words out. Followed quickly by, “How are you doing? Last night was quite intense.”

“You know? I’m great. Morgan and I reconnected after and it was.., great.”

“Great.”

We shared a laugh.

Morgan and Tariq joined us a few minutes later, drawn by the smell of brewing java and our quiet conversation. Like yesterday morning, things were surprisingly chill for a group who’d shared a casual hookup. I guess that was what made it casual.

“So what are the plans today?” Prithya asked us.

“None today,” Morgan said. “I was thinking about a train out to Salisbury and Stonehenge, but that’s a lot of travel for some rocks.”

“Really *old* rocks though,” Tariq pointed out.

“I’ve shown Nathan my favorite spots, so I thought maybe he picks today. We go somewhere new together.”

All eyes turned to me. “Well in that case, I’ve always wanted to check out the Imperial War Museum.”

“See what a nerd I married?” Morgan said, but she was clearly delighted. “Actually, I’ve heard really amazing things about it, too.”

And that’s what we did. Prithya and Tariq actually tagged along because neither of them had been there either.

The museum was huge, and like the British Museum, I realized that I could spend days here. I took a lot of photos for class, picked up a few brochures, read *everything*. The other three definitely grew bored at some point, but they accommodated me.

The last day of our trip was mild enough that we decided to walk across the Westminster Bridge, past Big Ben, and then along the Thames. Prithya wanted to take us out to a restaurant down there, but it was still early.

The sun was just setting as we crossed the bridge, lighting up the London sky in orange and red. The London Eye, that enormous Ferris Wheel, was silhouetted against the fading light. The lights of Parliament were just coming on. Even the bridge itself glowed.

Prithya and Tariq were ahead of us, giving us space to talk, to have this last moment together.

“So... how are we feeling?” Morgan asked, taking my hand in hers.

“I’m glad I came.”

“I am, too.”

“If I hadn’t, you think that something would have happened?” The question had been eating at me, but I didn’t realize that I even had it until it was out. “I mean, I did kind of give you the green light.”

“I honestly don’t know. I don’t think so, but there’s something about this place.”

I appreciated her honesty. “That would have been sexy too,” I said. “In another life, hearing about you getting caught up in timings.”

Morgan laughed. “That’s one way to put it.” She squeezed my hand. “But for the first time, I’m glad it worked out this way.”

“For the first time,” I repeated, looking at her.

She was studying me with a playful smile on her lips. “I think we both had fun these last few days. Some things don’t need to just be reserved for vacations.”

I liked how she phrased it. This felt as much like an “us” thing as it did a “her” or “me” thing, and yet it was both of those as well. I said, “I was thinking something similar this morning, actually. I’m not ready to stop exploring with you.”

“Then let’s keep going. We have a pretty great supporting cast.”

“Funny how that happened,” I said, thinking of Trip and Tracy, of the hotwives-nights-out. She had Cassidy to talk to. One day, maybe even Lorenzo could make an appearance.

The future was so full of possibility, but I wanted to focus on tonight.

“Which reminds me, this is our last night in London...” I began, leaving it open ended.

“It is.”

“We should make the most of it.”

“We should.” She looked at me mischievously. “Anything you had in mind?”

“Well, two days ago, we did my fantasy. And yesterday, we explored Tariq’s. What about you?”

“Isn’t that sweet. What if I said my fantasy was to fulfill your fantasy?”

“I’d say that sounds a lot like you, but would also accuse you of copping out.”

“Then let’s not do that,” she said with a laugh. “Okay then. First of all, these last two days were definitely, like, a major fantasy for me. To share that with you... to see the way you look at me when I’m with someone else... it’s fucking hot.”

I loved it when she cursed. It was a reminder that this sweet woman had a dirty side.

“But if you really want to know *my* fantasy—”

“I do.”

“Then maybe you don’t just watch.” She looked at me meaningfully. “I’ve been thinking about my... experience with Professor Whitmore and Lo, and you know what would make that whole thing even hotter? If it was you, not him.”

“So we’re going to track down the ethics professor after all?”

Morgan laughed. “Oh no. We don’t need him. We have someone better.” She looked forward, at our hosts, who’d stopped and were waiting for us.

My heart jumped. I imagined looking down at her as she sucked my cock and Tariq plowed her from behind.

“That’s *my* fantasy,” she said.

“Whatever the lady wants.”

DINNER WAS GREAT. I think. I remember that it was expensive. I remember Prithya treating us. I remember a toast to us coming to visit her, and the performance at the Royal Albert Hall, and to new experiences.

When the waiter asked if we wanted dessert, though, we all looked at each other and laughed. “No, we’ve got dessert at home,” Prithya said.

The looks that passed between the four of us left no doubt that we generally knew where the evening would go.

Back at the flat, Prithya poured us all a round of whiskey. We stood huddled in the kitchen, drinking, the tension heavy around us. We’d been tourists all day. No one was dressed to impress. Not like the last couple nights—Morgan in her jeans and cream-colored blouse, Tariq and I just as casual. Only Prithya carried the style in her flowing dress and calf-high boots.

Not that any of that mattered. The clothes weren’t going to stay on for long.

Morgan set her glass down, looking at me, then Tariq, then back at me. When she spoke, her voice was steady. “Last night in London, peeps.”

“Last night in London,” Prithya echoed. “Anything else you’d like to do while you’re here?”

Morgan chuckled at her friend as she pushed off of the counter top that she’d been leaning on and took my hand. “There is one other thing.” She slipped her other hand into Tariq’s, and pulled us towards the bedroom.

My heart hammered against my chest as we entered. I hadn’t been in there since the night before last. I expected it to be a mess, the bed tossed and the room smelling of sex. None of that was true. It was tidy, the sheets pulled taut, and the room smelled like Prithya.

Morgan pulled me in for a kiss, her arms going up around my neck as she pushed her tongue into my mouth. When she pulled out of the kiss, she remained close, staring up at me, nibbling on her lower lip.

Ready? she seemed to say.

I nodded.

Without stepping too far away, she turned and pulled Tariq into a kiss that was just as passionate. I was right there, as close as I was comfortable getting to another man locking lips with my wife. I heard the wet sounds of the kiss, saw the way their jaws worked as their tongues played. A flush crept up Morgan's neck.

Morgan broke the kiss with Tariq and turned back to me. Her cheeks were definitely flushed, and her lips slightly puffy from the kissing.

She stepped back and started to unbutton her blouse, wetting her lips as she watched her two men salivating over her.

Beneath, she wore a sexy black bra that Tariq couldn't take his eyes off of... until she undid the button of her jeans and shimmied out of those, too, revealing her matching thong.

For me, right there, it was the eye contact that charged the air between us—the way she and Tariq stared at each other, full of need, ready to play. He couldn't take more of the tease, pulling her back to him, his hands around her waist, and the two kissed again.

His hands sank lower, cupping her ass cheeks as she turned to me and leaned in to give me my own kiss.

"I need you both," she said huskily.

Before I could process that, she sank to her knees in front of us. My breath caught as she reached for my belt, then Tariq's. We helped her out, unzipping, unfastening, opening. Morgan grew impatient, yanking down Tariq's pants as I stepped out of mine.

Cocks freed, she wrapped a hand around each, looked up at me, and then took Tariq's into her mouth.

“Fuck,” I breathed, watching her stretch her lips around his girth and let it sink into her throat.

Tariq grunted beside me. “She’s... fucking good.”

Morgan stroked both of us in time with her bobbing head. When she switched to me, her mouth warmed from another man’s meat, it was *almost* too much. Almost. She stared up at me, smiling with her eyes, and swallowed me down while her hand kept working him.

I pulled off my shirt as Tariq did the same. Morgan approved, humming around my cock before pulling off with a wet pop and switching back to Tariq. She took him deep, gagging slightly, spit running down her chin. Her hand squeezed my shaft, signaling her awareness of the effect this had on me.

She went back and forth between us—sucking one while jerking the other, her technique sloppy and enthusiastic. Saliva dripped down both our cocks, made her hands slide easier. The wet sounds filled the room along with our groans.

But this was all warmup for the main attraction, and we both knew it. Tariq was ready to move it along. He pulled her up, and the two launched right into another kiss. Any hesitancy that may have been there before was gone.

When they broke apart, Morgan was breathing hard, her lips swollen. Tariq’s hand slid down her body, between her legs. This close, right up against her, I saw everything. Her eyes fluttered, her lips parted in a gasp, she leaned into him.

“Strip. Then get on the bed.”

Morgan obeyed, popping her bra off first. Her nipples were hard and puffy from arousal. She turned, tugging her thong over her hips as she crawled onto the bed, ass facing us, and looked back over her shoulder.

“Nathan,” she said, patting the spot beside her on the bed. “I want you in my mouth.”

My legs felt shaky as I moved to the head of the bed. Morgan's face was right there, level with my cock. She wrapped her hand around me and guided me to her lips once again.

Behind her, Prithya appeared with a condom. She tore it open and rolled it onto Tariq herself. She kissed him once, then smiled. "Go get her, baby."

Tariq positioned himself behind Morgan, one hand on her hip, the other guiding his cock to her entrance. I felt her tense slightly around me, her hand gripping my thigh.

Then he pushed inside.

Morgan's moan was muffled by my cock, but I felt it—the vibration, the way her whole body responded. Her eyes squeezed shut for a moment, then opened again, finding mine.

Tariq groaned, sinking deeper, letting her adjust to his size again.

"Oh, God, yes," Morgan moaned between slobbers on my dick. "Watch him, honey. Watch how he... *fucks me!*"

Tariq ramped up quickly, thrusting harder—hard enough to drive me deeper into Morgan's throat. She choked, but didn't back down from the challenge.

Prithya was there, too, on the bed. Her dress was gone, her dusky skin pressed against Tariq's as she whispered into his ear. "Fuck her, baby. Make my bestie scream."

Morgan responded. Her back arched as Tariq drove into her, his hands tight on her hips. This was so different from just watching. I was no longer the voyeur. I was a player, a participant. I was connected to her while another man *fucked the shit* out of her.

"That's it, baby," Tariq said, picking up his pace. "Take it."

Morgan moaned, louder. My balls tightened. This was *Morgan's* fantasy—to fuck two men at once, to fuck *me* with another man. And yet it was now becoming mine. I started to understand things from her perspective.

Prithya's hand snaked down between Morgan's legs, finding her clit. Morgan's whole body jerked at the contact, a strangled sound escaping around my cock.

"You're so wet," Prithya said. "You love having both of them, don't you?"

Morgan could only moan in response, her movements becoming more frantic. She was close—I could tell by the way her thighs trembled, the way her blowjob became sloppy.

Tariq must have felt it too. "That's it," he grunted, driving harder. "Do it."

Prithya's fingers worked faster, circling Morgan's clit. "Come on, bestie. Let go."

Morgan pulled off my cock completely, gasping for air. "Oh fuck, oh fuck, I'm—UHH!"

I cradled her head in my hands, watching her body ripple as the orgasm hit her hard. Tariq and Prithya kept fucking her through it, his hands on her hips, her fingers between her legs. It was only when Morgan was completely cooked, collapsing forward, that I realized that the other two were making out.

Tariq slipped out of Morgan as she gasped for breath. "Holy... shit." She looked up at me, hair plastered to her sweaty face, eyes glazed, and said, "I want you, honey. I need you inside me."

I didn't have to be asked twice. I moved behind her as Tariq and Prithya moved off to the side of us, lost in each other—Prithya's own reclamation.

Morgan flipped over onto her back, opening her legs as she accepted me into her arms. "Come here," she said, voice breathy.

She was soaked as I pushed inside of her, stretched, loose. Another man had been inside of her. Another man with a bigger dick, and that knowledge made me even harder. I leaned down and kissed her as my dick easily bottomed out in her wet sex.

She wrapped her arms around my shoulders and one leg snaked around my back, pulling me deeper with her heel. “Yes, baby. Fuck me. Fuck your hotwife.”

“Ohhh,” Prithya moaned beside us. She was in the same position that Morgan had just been in, on her knees, ass up, Tariq fucking her doggystyle. Only Prithya’s head was on the mattress, her dark hair spread about her.

“One more little gift for you, baby,” Morgan said to me. She gently pushed me up, giving her a bit of space. I was confused for all of a split second. Then she looked over at Prithya, watching her friend get pounded hard. “Hey there, bestie.”

Their eyes met. Morgan reached out, her hand finding Prithya’s face. Her face lit up, her pearly white teeth shining as she smiled, as their heads closed in, as their lips met. I’d already watched the two of them kiss last night, when Tariq had ordered them to.

But this was different. This was Morgan-initiated. She said it was for me, but I suspected that she wanted it just as much. Especially when the kiss quickly became desperate, both of them moaning into each other’s mouths while we fucked them.

It wasn’t a showy girl-on-girl kiss. It was real, and I had a front row seat to the action. Prithya’s hand came up to tangle in Morgan’s hair, holding her there, their tongues visible between kisses.

“Fuck,” Tariq groaned. I agreed with that sentiment. It was all almost too much. I slowed the pace of my fucking to just watch the two women make out.

Morgan pulled back from the kiss, gasping. “Nathan, I’m getting close again.”

“Me too,” I said.

“Give it to me.” She reached up and pulled me close. We kissed each other between our gasps and moans. I felt Prithya’s presence just beside me.

I could smell her perfume. We weren't alone in bed. This wasn't quiet reclamation. This was group sex.

"Oh, Morg!" I cried out, my balls tightening. I pumped into her one last time and emptied myself.

Her fingers tightened in my hair. When she opened her mouth, no sound came out. At first. She rocked back in the bed, lips parted, her grip on me so hard it hurt. And then—

"Fuuuuck!"

She was coming hard, exploding beneath me. She gripped me with both legs, her heels rutting into my lower back as her pussy milked my dick dry.

I was lost in a haze of euphoria so thick that I barely realized what was happening. The women were making out again, whispering between kisses, conspiring.

Morgan was nodding. Bodies were moving, shifting for one last hurrah.

I was spent, crawling up to the head of the bed as Prithya and Morgan sat up, arms and legs entwined. They were going at it without restraint, Morgan's long brown hair looked almost black, plastered to her neck and shoulders. Prithya's was equally as damp, her caramel-hued skin glistening.

Tariq was locked in on the sight of them. He was still hard, his dick wet as he stroked himself slowly. "I love how much Prithya gets into it with other girls," he said to me. "Looks like Morgan's just as into it."

Morgan broke the kiss and turned to me, looking sheepish. Prithya pressed herself to Morgan, tweaking her nipple and saying to Tariq, "I want you to fuck her while I go down on her."

Morgan didn't take her eyes from me as Prithya made her intentions clear. She just lifted a brow. *You want this?*

I gave her a nod. *Fuck yes I did.*

Morgan turned to Prithya and licked the side of her neck on her way to saying, "Why not sixty-nine?"

"Why not."

Prithya laid back on the bed, and I feasted my eyes on her naked body. I'd seen her in the moonlight on our wedding night, but she had been partially obscured by shadow and distance. I'd seen her the previous night, too, although then I'd been so distracted by Morgan and Ophelia and Tariq. Now, as she splayed herself out in front of my wife, just feet from me, I checked her out completely.

She was fucking hot as hell, a total fantasy: dark skin from her Indian heritage, toned curves, swollen nipples. She was still waxed bare, her pussy wet and blossoming as Morgan climbed over her.

I had the perfect angle to watch. Morgan glanced one last time at me, winked, and lowered her mouth to her friend's bald lips.

Prithya moaned in delight, wrapping her hands around Morgan's ass and lifting her head to return the favor.

Tariq didn't hesitate. He moved into position behind Morgan. He already had a fresh condom on, and didn't wait for an invitation before sinking back into Morgan from behind again. No problem with sloppy seconds for him.

Morgan gasped, lifting her head from between her friend's legs to moan. Prithya hooked a leg around her head and deftly pulled her back down. "Back to work, honey." Her voice was muffled from between Morgan's thighs.

She did as told, but didn't take her eyes off of me, those rich brown irises looking up through her lashes as her tongue lapped away at Prithya.

My cock began to stir back to life, watching this scene unfold before me. Morgan saw it. I wrapped my hand around my shaft and coaxed it harder.

"That's it," Tariq barked. "Suck my balls while I fuck your friend."

I couldn't see her exactly, obscured by Tariq's thighs, but I saw the shift, saw Prithya's hands come up to grab him as her head moved lower to tongue his shaved balls as he continued to thrust into Morgan.

Morgan was moaning into Prithya's pussy now, her whole body trembling. She gripped the sheets on either side of her and thrust her hips back into Tariq, into Prithya. "Come on, baby," Prithya urged, her voice muffled. "Come on my face. Let me taste you."

She was eating Morgan again, teasing her clit as Tariq nailed her. The sound of skin slapping on skin filled the room, mixing with the wet sounds of mouths and tongues and the desperate moans of all three of them.

I was hard again. So fucking hard, jerking off in time with their rhythm, with Morgan's cries ringing out above us.

"Fuck, oh fuck, ohfuck—"

Then she was coming. Prithya held her hips, keeping her mouth locked onto her, licking her through it as Tariq slowed his pounding. When she'd weathered it, when she finally collapsed forward onto Prithya gasping, she said, "That was intense, you two. You've done that before."

"Maybe." I didn't need to see Prithya's face to know that she was smiling.

"Your turn, Pri," Morgan said, shakily slipping off of her friend and onto her back. "You need to come."

Prithya sat up, her face glistening with Morgan's arousal. "God, yes I do."

"Tariq, head of the bed. Sit back on that," Morgan said, taking control.

He did as he was told, taking a position beside me. Prithya followed on her hands and knees, her tits swinging beneath her. She pulled his condom off and rose before him. When they kissed, I could feel the raw passion pass between them.

"Turn around, Pri. I want to see it all," Morgan said.

Prithya shifted, straddling her boyfriend, facing out, facing Morgan. She reached between her legs, grabbed hold of his dick, and sank onto it with a moan.

"Yes," she breathed with a moan. "As hot as women are, I love cock."

For an American like me, it was so hot hearing her say those words in her proper, so very *English* accent.

“How about both?” Morgan asked, crawling over to join them. She knelt before her friend, her body pressed against Prithya, sandwiching her between two bodies. She cupped her friend's face and pulled her into a deep kiss. I watched their tongues meet, watched Morgan's hands slide down to Prithya's breasts, squeezing and kneading.

Morgan's lips followed her hands, kissing along her collarbone, down the slope of her tits. She suckled her friend's erect nipples, hard enough to rip a cry from Prithya. Prithya's eyes were closed, her mouth parted as she kept on rolling her hips on her boyfriend's dick, faster now.

Morgan dropped lower, running the tip of her tongue along the script tattoo on her friend's ribcage. Lower still, teasing her belly bar. She looked up at her friend, leaned forward, and ran the flat of her tongue down Prithya's smooth mound and around her clit, where Tariq was stretching her.

“Oh, fuck!” Prithya gasped. “Morgan, yes!”

I watched it all, but knew that my role as voyeur was coming to an end. Morgan didn't want me just watching. That wasn't her fantasy, and I didn't need to be asked or told what to do next.

I pushed away from the headboard and moved into position behind my wife. She glanced back at me and nodded with approval. When I pushed inside of her—still slick from all the sex—she moaned against Prithya's pussy.

Now all four of us were connected. I fucked Morgan as Morgan ate Prithya as Prithya rode Tariq. The room filled with moans and gasps, the sound of skin on skin. It was Prithya who was loudest, who was closest. Her hands gripped Morgan's hair, holding her in place as she ground her pussy into my wife's face.

“Oh God, oh God, I’m going to... to...” Her words dissolved into a scream as her orgasm hit. Her whole body shook, her back arching. Morgan tried to keep up the cunnilingus, but it was all too much. Prithya begged off, rolling off of Tariq.

Morgan wasn’t done, and she suddenly had a fresh cock before her. She leaned in and wolfed down Tariq’s towering offering, taking him into her mouth with a heavy groan from the man. He must have been close. Somehow, he held on.

Me? Not so much. From behind her, my cock buried, watching her head bob as she sucked him was enough to trigger me. I tried to slow, but Morgan wasn’t having it. She slurped off of Tariq long enough to say, “Keep fucking.”

“I’m... I’m close,” I gasped.

She redoubled her efforts—on Tariq, on fucking back into me. I thrust deep, my orgasm slamming through me, and came hard. Morgan moaned around Tariq, but didn’t stop blowing him. He had her head in his hands now, taking full control as he fucked her mouth, faster, deeper. Within seconds, he tensed.

“Fuck, I’m—”

He came in Morgan’s mouth. She swallowed it all, taking everything he gave her, not stopping until he was completely spent.

Finally, she pulled off, wiping her mouth with the back of her hand. All four of us collapsed onto the bed, breathing hard, sweat-slicked and satisfied.

EPILOGUE

“So how was London?”

We’d been home for three days, but London already felt like a different lifetime ago, as vacations always did. I’d just gotten over my jetlag and was proud that it was 8pm and I wasn’t falling asleep.

I was on the back patio, sharing a beer with Trip. Rain pattered on the awning overhead. It was a mild evening, typical of Portland. Home. It was nice to be home.

“London was... an adventure.”

Trip knew that something had happened. He was perceptive like that, especially when it came to relationship dynamics. He’d seen me and Morgan together, how close we were, how we’d sometimes just look at each other, replaying all the crazy stuff that we’d done, and smile.

“So?” Trip asked.

“She’s officially a hotwife.” What a rush to even say that outloud. To another human being.

“Fucking knew it. Congrats, man. Con-fucking-grats.”

After the foursome, Morgan and I went back to our room. I’d come twice already. Morgan had come more than that. We were spent, and there was no way I was in any shape to do a proper reclamation. But we held

each other and talked again about what we'd done and what this could mean for the future.

"I still feel like it was all a dream," I said to Trip.

"Want to share details?"

"Uhh..." Did I? "It was with her best friend, Prithya's boyfriend."

"The hot Indian chick? Tell me you got to hook up with her."

I chuckled at Trip's crassness. "Yeah, that's Prithya. But no, I didn't hook up with her. That's not really my thing."

"Morgan get a little jelly?"

"A little, yeah, but it was more like... my fantasy is of her as a hotwife, not, like, us swinging."

"But swinging is pretty sweet," Trip said.

I glared at the man. It was nice to open up to someone, to have a confidante, but Trip sometimes had a hard time seeing things beyond his own experience.

He must have caught my look because he held up his hands. "Sorry, sorry." He took a pull from his beer. "Seriously though, man, that's amazing. It took Trace and I years before we played like that."

"We've kind of been on this journey for years, too, I guess you could say."

"That's true. How are you feeling now?"

"Other than like I had the wildest sex dream of my life?" I paused, considering it. I'd been considering it for the past three days. "Despite the fact that Morgan was with another guy..." I took a breath. "That's still such a rush to say."

"It's a rush to hear you say it, brother."

"Despite that, I've never felt so close to her. It's kind of counter-intuitive."

"Nah. It means that you two are doing it right."

I let that sink in, and it felt good.

At last, Trip asked, "So is this, like, a 'what happens in London stays in London' kind of thing?"

We'd talked about that, too. Neither of us wanted to put it all back into the box. But we also weren't ready to jump right back into it.

"I don't want this to define us," Morgan had said. And I agreed.

To Trip, back in the present, I said, "No, it's not like that. We're going to play it by ear."

"Not going to dive right into the lifestyle." Trip nodded. "Not what I would have done, which probably makes it the correct thing to do."

"You know, it was pretty wild to be there in London, where it all started for Morgan."

"You get more stories from her?"

"Oh yeah." I thought of Professor Whitmore, about her dressed up as a stewardess, about seeing Lorenzo's flat, where she'd lived for two months there at the end.

"Going to share any?"

I looked at him and shook my head. "You already know too much, my friend."

"Says you." Trip laughed.

"She told me that she was finally ready to share everything."

"I bet you're in for some stories. You ready for that? You ready to hear it all?"

I nodded slowly. "Yeah. I'm so ready."

Trip raised his beer. "Then to hot pasts and hotter futures."

I clinked my bottle against his, my mind already racing with possibilities.

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The Blonde in 3C



This one's the closest to an "origin story" as I've written. If you liked While We Were Apart, I'm pretty sure you'll like this one. It's self-contained and isn't quite the same level of slow burn, but it should hit all the right notes.

From neighbor to friend to wife to... hotwife?

Cooper always had a crush on Annika, the blonde in apartment 3C. She was friendly. She was pretty.

Best of all, she had loud sex with her boyfriend, Brett, that Cooper could hear through the floorboards. He never thought that one day, he would marry that sexy blonde.

But first impressions are hard to shake, and Cooper's first impression of his future bride was of an insatiable woman he could never fully satisfy. He was always waiting for the other shoe to drop, for a new man to take his place, for him to lose it all. A hotwife fantasy was born and it grew with their marriage.

The things that Annika did for love always surprised her, but that was just who she was. She gave all of her energy to a relationship. She'd done some wild things for her hedonistic former boyfriend, Brett. She was still trying to figure out Cooper.

When they attend Brett's wedding, Annika and Cooper are put to the test. Will Annika be tempted by the past? Will Cooper's repressed fantasy explode into the open?

[Find The Blonde in 3C online!](#)

Bull's Eye Series (5 books)



Paul Sharpe, self-avowed bachelor, works hard and plays harder—always looking for a new conquest. Blondes, brunettes, redheads, he enjoys them all as long as the pursuit is fun and they're up for a good time. He's fine being disposable. Life is simpler that way.

Until he meets a woman who opens his eyes to a whole new world—the world of hotwives and cuckolds and the games that they play. After that, he sees it everywhere. At bars, at clubs, at his company's gala, he sees men furtively watching other men hit on their wives.

Can he be the other man? Can he be the bull?

Follow Paul's epic journey over five books as he evolves from the bull to so much more.

[Bull's Eye 1: Discovering the Hotwife Fantasy](#)

[Bull's Eye 2: Exploring the Hotwife Fantasy](#)

[Bull's Eye 3: Enjoying the Hotwife Fantasy](#)

[Bull's Eye 4: Consequences of a Hotwife Fantasy](#)

[Bull's Eye 5: Beyond the Hotwife Fantasy](#)

These next two books are in another new and burgeoning sub-genre of hotwife erotica that's, I guess, hotwife thriller? I don't know, but I'm into it, and so I've written a few books (with more in the works).

In Too Deep



David hasn't seen his wife, Amanda, in two months—not since she went undercover on a dangerous, highly secretive case. He doesn't know where she is, what she's doing, or who she's pretending to be. He only knows he misses her—her laugh, her touch, her kiss.

Then one night, David finds himself in a strip club... and finds her on stage.

Seeing Amanda like this—seductive, confident, and far more uninhibited than he ever imagined—awakens a cocktail of emotions: confusion, desire, jealousy... and a craving for more. And then suddenly he's dragged into Amanda's dark and thrilling new world, where every move could shatter her cover—and their marriage.

Can they survive the lies, the danger, and the temptation? Or has Amanda already crossed a line that neither of them can undo?

Packed with explicit, pulse-pounding passion, intrigue, and a unique take on not just the hotwife genre, but the mystery-thriller genre, this is one story you won't forget.

***In Too Deep* is a two-part book series available [everywhere that you purchase your ebooks](#).**

Caught in the Act



Married seducers-for-hire, Logan and Abigail have built a lucrative business exposing cheating husbands—using charm, temptation, and each other. But their latest honey trap assignment takes them to the sun-soaked decadence of Valencia, Spain, where the line between roleplay and reality begins to blur.

Their client, the elegant and enigmatic Kristiana Vanderkamp, wants proof that her husband Elias is unfaithful. It should be routine. But as Abigail slips deeper into the game—and into Elias’s charms—Logan is forced to confront just how far he’s willing to go... and what it means to watch his wife become someone else’s fantasy.

In a world of lies, lust, and layered agendas, everyone has something to hide—and no one wants to get caught in the act...

[Buy it online](#)

Training to Love It Series (3 books)



Can a wife-watching fantasy be trained?

When Erin comes home from the gym and lets slip that her new personal trainer is a man, Tom doesn't know how to react. When he overhears Erin admitting that she's attracted to AJ, her trainer, he becomes even more confused. He wants to be supportive, but he feels jealous. He wants to be understanding, but he doesn't even understand his own feelings. Every time he thinks of Erin with

AJ, his heart begins to race. Every time she says his name, his breath catches in his chest.

AJ ends up pushing more than just his wife's physical limits. As Tom watches this newer, stronger, more assertive woman emerge with each training session, he realizes that this other man is pushing the limits of their marriage and their happy life. How far would they go for a fantasy? And whose fantasy is it? And what happens when things go too far?

Training to Love It series

ABOUT KENNY WRIGHT

Kenny has been publishing hotwife erotica for over ten years (and writing for much longer than that). He writes what he likes to read: steamy, explicit erotica that's just crazy enough to be true. He believes in a world where men read and appreciate erotica, and hope to contribute to it word by word.

More recently, he's started a community over on Patreon, testing out new story ideas and gathering feedback for upcoming releases. Come join the community and support more works like this one.

Find him online at www.kennywriter.com, on Patreon as KennyWriter, or follow him on Twitter at [@kennywriter](https://twitter.com/kennywriter), [Bluesky](#), and [Medium](#).

